



JESUS IN INDIA



Jesus in India

Jesus' Deliverance from the Cross & Journey to India

(Masih Hindustan Mein)

Hazrat Mirza Ghulam Ahmad

*The Promised Messiah and Mahdi^{as},
Founder of the Ahmadiyya Muslim Community*

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Jesus in India
English translation of *Masih Hindustan Mein*

Written by Hazrat Mirza Ghulam Ahmad
The Promised Messiah and Mahdi, may peace be on him,
Founder of the Ahmadiyya Muslim Community

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Hazrat Mirza Ghulam Ahmad of Qadian
The Promised Messiah & Mahdi^{as}

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Hazrat Mirza Ghulam Ahmad, may peace be on him, was born in 1835 in Qadian, India. From his early life, he dedicated himself to prayer and the study of the Holy Quran and other scriptures. He was deeply pained to observe the plight of Islam, which was being attacked from all directions. In order to defend Islam and present its teachings in their pristine purity, he wrote more than ninety books, thousands of letters, and participated in many religious debates. He argued that Islam is a living faith which can lead man to establish communion with God to achieve moral and spiritual perfection.

Hazrat Mirza Ghulam Ahmad^{as} started experiencing divine dreams, visions, and revelations at a young age. In 1889, under divine command, he started accepting initiation into the Ahmadiyya Muslim Community. Divine revelations continued to increase and God commanded him to announce that He had appointed him to be that very Reformer of the Latter Days as prophesied by various religions under different titles. He claimed to be that very Prophet who the Holy Prophet Muhammad^{sas}

said would be raised as the Promised Messiah and Mahdi. The Ahmadiyya Muslim Community is now established in more than 200 countries.

After his demise in 1908, the second manifestation of divine power was demonstrated, and the institution of *Khilafat* (successorship) was established to succeed him in fulfilment of the prophecies made in the Holy Quran, presented by the Holy Prophet Muhammad^{sas}, and in the Promised Messiah's^{as} book *Al-Wasiyyat*. Hazrat Mirza Masroor Ahmad^{aba} is the Fifth Successor to the Promised Messiah^{as} and the present head of the Ahmadiyya Muslim Community.

FOREWORD

Masih Hindustan Mein (Jesus in India) was written in Urdu by Hazrat Mirza Ghulam Ahmad (1835–1908), the Promised Messiah and Mahdi, in April 1899. Its general publication occurred on 20 November 1908 in Qadian, India. Initially, the author had intended to write ten chapters and a conclusion, but later decided that the four chapters would suffice.

The main thesis of the book, that the enemies of Jesus, peace be on him, had failed to bring about his death on the cross is forcefully established on the basis of evidence contained in the New Testament as well as historical and ancient medical records. The book makes the case that not only had Jesus survived the ordeal of the cross but that, after meeting, dining and spending a night with his disciples he had travelled in search of the ‘lost sheep of the House of Israel’. Finding them settled in Afghanistan and Kashmir, India he conveyed his message to them and they accepted him—just like the people of Jonas, peace be on him. This was all in complete fulfilment of the prophecy that Jesus himself had made prior to the events of the cross when he had stated, as

recorded in the New Testament: ‘An evil and adulterous generation seeketh after a sign; and there shall no sign be given to it, but the sign of the prophet Jonas: For as Jonas was three days and three nights in the whale’s belly; so shall the Son of man be three days and three nights in the heart of the earth.’ (Matthew 12:39–40)

In the present third edition, efforts have been made to make the translation closer to the original text. Formatting and layout of the book has been substantially improved. Footnotes, Glossary and Index have been updated as well. Further, the Appendix has been improved in support of the references quoted in the book.

We are grateful to all those who have contributed towards the book, namely, Waseem Ahmad Sayed, Bushra Shahid, Qadir Malik, Rizwan Ahmad, Abdul Wahab Mirza, and others. May Allah the Almighty bless them abundantly. I sincerely hope and pray that this book will be a source of enlightenment for all readers.

al-Haaj Munir-ud-Din Shams

Additional Wakeelut Tasneef

July, 2019

PUBLISHER'S NOTE

FROM THE EARLIER EDITION

Jesus in India is the English version of *Masih Hindustan Mein*, an Urdu treatise written by the Holy Founder of the worldwide Ahmadiyya Muslim Jama'at, Hazrat Mirza Ghulam Ahmad (1835–1908), the Promised Messiah and Mahdi. The main thesis expounded in this treatise is Jesus' deliverance from death on the Cross and his subsequent journey to India in quest of the lost tribes of Israel whom he had to gather into his fold as foretold by Jesus himself.

Starting his journey from Jerusalem and passing through Nasibus and Iran, Jesus is shown to have reached Afghanistan where he met the Jews who had settled there after their escape from the bonds of Nebuchadnezzar. From Afghanistan Jesus went to Kashmir where some Israelite tribes had also settled. He made this place his home and here he died and lies buried in Srinagar, Kashmir.

In this book, Hazrat Ahmad has solved another difficult problem which has for long confounded many a western writer,

namely the problem of the resemblance between Christian and Buddhistic teachings and also between the life of Jesus and that of Buddha, as recorded in their respective Scriptures. Some of these writers hold that Buddhistic teachings must somehow have reached Palestine and were incorporated by Jesus in his own sermons. But there is absolutely no historical evidence to support this theory. A Russian traveller named Nicolas Notovitch stayed for quite some time with Lamas in Tibet and had their religious chronicles translated for him. He is of the opinion that Jesus must have been to Tibet before the Crucifixion and gone back to Palestine after having imbibed Buddhistic teachings.

Rejecting both these views, Hazrat Ahmad proves that Jesus came to India only after the [attempted] crucifixion and not before, and that it was not he who borrowed Buddha's teachings but the Buddhists who seem to have reproduced the Gospels in their books. Jesus also visited Tibet during his travels in India in search of the lost tribes of Israel. He preached his message to Buddhist monks, some of whom were originally Jews. They were deeply impressed by Jesus' teachings and accepted him as the manifestation of the Buddha, the Promised Teacher. With faith in him as their Master, they incorporated his teachings into the teachings of the Buddha himself.

Masih Hindustan Mein, was—it still is—an epoch-making and cataclysmic book. It transformed the theological landscape of Judaism, Pauline Christianity and conventional Islam. The catalyst it introduced was that Jesus—a true prophet of God, was saved from death on the cross, lived long and lies buried in Srinagar Kashmir.

As stated in the Introduction and at the end, the book was to

be divided into two parts, the first to comprise as many as ten chapters plus an epilogue, and the second part to contain additional proofs of Jesus' journey to India and a comparative evaluation of the teachings of Islam and Christianity establishing the truth of Islam as well as of his own claim to be the Promised Messiah. It seems he couldn't find time for further research on this subject, but he made good his resolve by ushering in a spiritual rebirth of Islam in its pristine purity, founding the dynamic Ahmadiyya Muslim Jama'at worldwide and writing not one but more than eighty books concerning the truth of Islam, his own claim as the Promised Messiah and Mahdi and the life and death of Jesus.

Written in 1899, and partly serialized in *Review of Religions* in 1902 and 1903, the book itself was posthumously published on 20th November 1908. The first English translation, by the late Qazi Abdul Hamid, was published in 1944. On instructions from Hazrat Mirza Tahir Ahmad, Khalifatul-Masih IV, Imam of the worldwide Ahmadiyya Muslim Jama'at, the present edition has been thoroughly revised by Professor Muhammad Ali Chaudhry, Wakilut Tasnif, Rabwah.

As supporting evidence of the theses advanced in this book, relevant excerpts from different authors and researchers are given at the end as appendix. These excerpts do not form part of the original text which, in the course of translation, has been kept inviolate and even misprints, if any, have not been corrected. The correct version has, however, been given in footnotes only after permission by our august Imam, Hazrat Khalifatul-Masih IV. The author's footnotes are indicated by asterisks, while the translator's footnotes have been numbered 1,2,3, etc.

Since different editions of the Bible differ in the serial numbers

of verses, care has been taken to stick to the numbers quoted by the author. Biblical references have been quoted from the Authorized King James' Version, published by the Zondervan Corporation, Grand Rapids, Michigan 49530, USA.

The Publishers

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We owe a debt of deep gratitude to all those who helped in the preparation of this revised edition of *Jesus in India*, particularly to Maulana Bashir Ahmad Akhtar, Mr. Dhulqarnain and Raja Ataul-Mannan for proof reading and verifying references and helping in a variety of ways.

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Chaudhry Muhammad Ali

Wakilut Tasnif

Rabwah

Jesus in India

حمد و قیاس اور لا انتہا و لا متناہی سپاس
خداے رحیم و کریم ملک الجنۃ والناس
کہ گوہر ہے بہا و نسخہ کیسیا گم گشتگان کار بہمن
یعنی رسالہ

مسیح ہندوستان میں

سفتہ الماس قلم اعجاز و رسم حضرت مسیح المندمرزا علام احمد صاحب
آقا دیا نی علیہ الصلوٰۃ والسلام
در بارہ نجات مسیح ماصرعی از صلیب اور انکا سفر جانب ہندوستان
بتوفیق یزدانی و فضل ربانی

مطبع انوار احمدیہ مشین پریس قادیان ضلع گورداسپور میں
بانتہام شیخ یعقوب علی صاحب تراز ایڈیٹر و
مالک مطبع طبع ہو کر ۲۰ نومبر ۱۹۰۸ء کو
شائع ہوا

قیمت ۲ روپے

تعداد اشاعت ۷۰۰

*Praise unending and beyond any conceivable limit;
And thanks innumerable and beyond all limits;
For the Merciful and Gracious God
who is Master of all men, great and small;*

*That this priceless treasure, the Philosopher's Stone,
the Guide for those who have gone astray;
That is to say the Book:*

Jesus in India

*Threaded Pearls from the Miraculous Penned Writing of
Hazrat Masih of India, Mirza Ghulam Ahmad^{as} of Qadian,
may peace be on him.*

*Concerning the Escape of Jesus of the Christians from the
Cross, and his Journey to India.*

By the Grace and Favour of Allah

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on November 20, 1908 C.E. at
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of Sheikh Yaqub Ali Turab,
Editor and Owner

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PRICE THREE ANNA

Translation of the original title page for *Masih Hindustan Mein*.

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ¹
نُحْمَدُهُ، وَنُصَلِّي عَلَى رَسُولِهِ الْكَرِيمِ²

رَبَّنَا افْتَحْ بَيْنَنَا وَبَيْنَ قَوْمِنَا بِالْحَقِّ وَأَنْتَ خَيْرُ الْفَاتِحِينَ
*Our Lord! Decide between us and our people in truth; for
You are the One Who decides best.*

INTRODUCTION

I write this book with the desire that by adducing proofs from established facts, conclusive historical evidence of proven value, and ancient documents of other nations, I may dispel those wrong and dangerous concepts which have become disseminated among most Muslim and Christian sects regarding the earlier and the later life of Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him. That is to say, those notions whose terrifying consequences have not only hijacked and destroyed the concept of *Tauhid* [Oneness] of Allah the Almighty, but their insidious and poisonous influence has long been noticed in the moral condition of Muslims in this country.

-
1. In the name of Allah, the Gracious, the Merciful. [Publisher]
 2. We praise Allah and invoke His blessings upon His Noble Messenger. [Publisher]

It is by virtue of believing in such baseless myths and tales that the spiritual maladies of immorality, malice, callousness and indifference continue to spread among most Islamic sects. And their quality of human sympathy and pious virtues of mercy, justice, humility and hospitality are declining, day by day, to such an extent, as though now they are ready to bid farewell most hastily. Due to this callousness and immorality many Muslims appear as though perhaps only marginally different from wild beasts. A follower of Jainism¹ or an adherent of Buddhism is afraid of and refrains from killing even a mosquito or a flea. But alas! There are many among us Muslims who, even at the time of committing wanton murder, or wasting the life of an innocent person, do not have the least fear of that God Almighty Who has declared human life immensely valuable in comparison to all other animals on earth. What is the cause of so much callousness and lack of compassion and indifference? It is because from their very childhood, myths and false stories regarding a false concept of Jihad are drummed into their ears and instilled into their hearts. As a result, they gradually become morally dead and cease to realize the heinousness of such abominable deeds. On the contrary, a man who murders an unsuspecting person and brings ruin to his family, thinks that he has done a deed worthy of great merit and indeed made the most of an opportunity to win social acclaim among his people. And because no sermons are delivered in our country to put a stop to such evils, and if at all there are any such sermons, they have an aura of hypocrisy about them; so the ordinary people at large

1. Jainism is a religion of Indian origin which forbids harming any living creatures, whether humans, animals or insects. [Publisher]

have their convictions inclined towards these mischievous deeds. Hence, taking pity upon the plight of my people, I have already many times written books in Urdu, Persian and Arabic, in which I have elaborated that among the Muslims, the basic tenet of Jihad, and the issue of waiting for the arrival of a bloodthirsty Imam and of keeping malice for other nations, all these are mistakes of some short sighted clerics. Islam, on the contrary, does not allow the use of the sword in religion except in the case of defensive wars, or wars which are waged to punish a tyrant, or those which are meant to uphold freedom. The need of a defensive war arises only when the aggression of an adversary threatens one's life. These are the three kinds of Jihads permitted by the Shariah, beside these three forms of war no other form is allowed by Islam in support of religion. In short, I have distributed books related to this subject in this country and in Arabia, Syria and Khurasan, etc., at great cost. But now, by the grace of God Almighty, to remove these false and unfounded beliefs from the people's heart, I have found potent reasons and clear proofs and confirmed affirmations and historical evidence, the light of whose truth gives the tidings that, soon after their publication, there will come about an amazing change in the hearts of the Muslims against these beliefs. And it is hoped with great certainty that after comprehending these truths, sweet and refreshing springs of modesty, humility and compassion will gush forth from the hearts of the righteous sons of Islam. And their spiritual transformation having taken place will have a wholesome and benign impact on the nation at large. I am also sure that Christian scholars and all those who hunger and thirst after the truth, will benefit from this, my book. And, as I have just pointed out, the real object of this book is to correct the wrong

beliefs which have found their way into the creeds of the Muslims and the Christians. However, this requires some elaboration which is as follows.

It should be clearly known that most Muslims and Christians think that Jesus, may peace be on him, went to the heavens alive; and both these groups have continued to indeed presume for a long time that Jesus, may peace be on him, is still alive in the heavens and will again come down to the earth sometime in the latter days. The only difference in the views of these two contending groups of Muslims and Christians is that Christians believe that Jesus, may peace be on him, died on the cross, was resurrected, went to heaven in his earthly body, seated himself on the right hand of his Father and will return to the earth for judgment in the latter days. They further say that that very Jesus Christ is the God, Creator, and Master of the world and that there is none other beside him; he it is who, in the latter days, will descend to the earth in glory and majesty to pronounce reward and punishment. Then will every single such person, who has not believed in him or his mother as God, be caught and thrown into hell, where crying and grinding of teeth will be their lot. But the aforesaid sects of Muslims say that Jesus, may peace be on him, was never crucified, nor did he die on the cross. Instead, when the Jews arrested him for crucifixion, an angel of God took him to the heavens in his earthly body, and that he is still alive there, and his station is the second heaven where the prophet Yahya or John is also quartered. Muslims, moreover, believe that Jesus, may peace be on him, is an exalted prophet of God but not God, nor the Son of God. They also say that he will, in the latter days, descend to the earth, near the Minaret

at Damascus, or elsewhere, supported by two angels. And joining Imam Muhammad—the Mahdi, who will be a Fatamite and will already be there in this world—will kill all non-Muslims, and will not spare anyone except those who become Muslims at once. In short, the real object of the second coming of Jesus, the Messiah may peace be on him, to the earth, as stated by the Muslims known as Ahle-Sunnah and Ahle-Hadith, also called Wahaabis by the common people, is that quite like the *Mahadev*¹ of the Hindus, he will destroy the whole world; and that he will first threaten people to become Muslims and, if they persist in their disbelief, shall put them all to the sword. They also affirm that he has been kept alive in the heavens in his earthly body, so that when Muslim powers become weak, he will come down and kill the non-Muslims or coerce them on pain of death to become Muslims. The divines of the aforesaid Muslim sect say, particularly about the Christians, that when Jesus, may peace be on him, comes down from the heavens, he will break all the crosses in the world, indulge in all sorts of cruel deeds with the sword, and drown the earth in blood. And, as I have just stated, the Ahle-Hadith and others from among the Muslims gleefully proclaim that shortly before the descent of the Messiah, there will appear an Imam from among the descendants of Fatimah, whose name will be Muhammad, the Mahdi. And he it is in fact who will be the real Khalifah of the Time and the King by virtue of his being from among the Quraish. And since his real object will be to kill all non-Muslims except those who readily recite the *Kalimah* [the declaration of faith in Islam], Jesus, may

1. One of the three great Hindu gods. [Publisher]

peace be on him, will come down from the heavens to give him a helping hand in this task; and although Jesus, may peace be on him, is in his own right a Mahdi, indeed he is the greater Mahdi, but since it is essential that the Khalifah of the Time should be from among the Quraish, Jesus, may peace be on him, will not be the Khalifah. Instead, Muhammad, the Mahdi, would be the Khalifah of the Time. And they say that the two of them, together, will fill the earth with the blood of human beings, and will carry out so much bloodshed that it will be unprecedented in the history of the world from the beginning till the end. The moment they appear, they will start this bloody carnage, but they will neither preach nor plead, nor show any sign. They also say that although Jesus, may peace be on him, will be like an advisor or a helper to Imam Muhammad, the Mahdi, and although the reins of power will be in the hands of the Mahdi alone, Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, will continue to instigate and incite Hazrat Imam Muhammad, the Mahdi, to violence, as if he were trying to make up for the humane teaching he preached to the world before, i.e., not to resist evil, and on being struck on one cheek, to turn the other cheek also.

These are the Muslim and Christian beliefs regarding Jesus, may peace be on him. And although Christians are guilty of a grave error in calling a humble man God, yet some Muslims too, among whom are included the Ahle-Hadith, generally known as the Wahaabis, the beliefs that they entertain in their hearts regarding a bloodthirsty Mahdi and an equally bloodthirsty Promised Messiah are casting a most evil influence upon their moral condition. So much so that because of this evil influence neither can they live with other people in a climate of peace, trust, and good

will, nor can they live their lives as truly and completely obedient and loyal citizens under a non-Muslim government. Every reasonable person would understand that such a belief, namely, that non-Muslims should be subjected to so much coercion that they should either directly become Muslims or be put to death, is open to very serious objections. And the conscience of everyone easily realizes that it is highly objectionable to simply force a person to enter one's faith by compulsion and coercion, and by threatening to kill him, without him having the opportunity to understand the truth of that faith and becoming apprised of its moral teaching and beauties. Far from contributing to the growth of a religion, this would have the opposite effect by giving every opponent the opportunity to find fault with it. The ultimate result of such principles is that human sympathy would become totally lifted from the hearts and justice and compassion, which are weighty moral values characterising humanity, would become extinct, and on the contrary spite and ill will begin to flourish and only brutality remains, wiping out all high moral qualities totally. But it is only too obvious that such teachings cannot be from God, whose every punishment comes only after His message has been fully communicated.

It is worth pondering, would it be reasonable to simply kill a man if he does not accept a true faith because he is, as yet, ignorant and unaware of its truth and its noble and excellent message? Instead of answering his denial with the sword or the gun, such a man deserves compassion, and needs to be instructed gently and politely in the truth, beauty and the spiritual beneficence of that faith. Hence, the view of Jihad held in this age by these sects of Islam, and their belief that the time is near when there will arise a

bloodthirsty Mahdi named Imam Muhammad, that the Messiah will come down from the skies to lend him a helping hand, and that the two of them together will kill all non-Muslims if they deny Islam, is utterly opposed to moral sense. Is this belief not such as renders ineffective all good human qualities and morals, and give rise to the development of beastly passions. Those who hold such beliefs have to lead a life of hypocrisy with the people of every other nation, so much so that it becomes impossible for them to even give true loyalty to their alien rulers. They give expression to a false allegiance by way of deception. This is indeed why in this country of British India, some of the Ahle-Hadith sects mentioned above are living a kind of duplicitous life under the British Government. That is to say, in secret, they hold out hopes to the common people of the coming of the days of bloodshed and are awaiting a bloodthirsty Mahdi and Messiah, and preach accordingly; but when they present themselves before the rulers they sing their praises, and tell them that they are opposed to such ideas. But if they are really and sincerely opposed to such ideas, why is it that they do not give wide publicity of their opposition to these ideas in their writings, and why do they await the coming of the bloodthirsty Mahdi and Messiah so impatiently as if they were standing at the doorstep, eager to join him? In short, it is because of such beliefs that the moral condition of these types of clerics has suffered much deterioration and they are no longer qualified to teach peace and compassion. On the contrary, killing the people of other faiths for no rhyme or reason is considered to be a great obligation of religiosity. I would be very glad if any sect of the Ahle-Hadith is opposed to these wrong beliefs, but I cannot desist from mentioning with regret that among the sects

of the Ahle-Hadith there are also those closeted Wahaabis who believe in a bloodthirsty Mahdi and in the common concept of Jihad. They believe what is contrary to the right path, and, at some opportune time, they consider it highly virtuous to kill all people who profess other religions. Whereas such beliefs, killing others in the name of Islam, or believing in such prophecies that some bloodthirsty Mahdi or bloodthirsty Messiah will come into the world wishing to advance the cause of Islam by bloodshed and threats of bloodshed, are absolutely against the Holy Quran and the authentic *ahadith* [sayings of the Holy Prophet^{sas}]. Our Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, suffered great hardship in the Holy City of Mecca and thereafter at the hands of the disbelievers also. The thirteen years which he spent at Mecca were years of great affliction and suffering. Even to think of them brings tears to one's eyes. But he did not raise the sword against his enemies at that time, nor did he reply in kind to their abuse, until many of his disciples and close friends were mercilessly killed, and he too was himself subjected to all kinds of bodily suffering. He was poisoned many a time; and many types of schemes were hatched to murder him but in which the opponents remained unsuccessful. When, however, the time for God's vengeance came, it so happened that all the Meccan and tribal chiefs

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1. ☆ Some from among the Ahle-Hadith write in their books unjustly and with great impertinence that the birth of the Mahdi is imminent: that he will imprison the British rulers of India, and that at that time the Christian king will be arrested and brought before him. These books are still to be found in the homes of these Ahle-Hadith. *Iqtirābus-Sa'ah* is one of these books, whose author is a very well-known Ahle-Hadith scholar. This very account is written on page 64 of this book. (Author)

decided unanimously that this man, the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, should in any case be put to death. It was at that time that God, who is the Supporter of His loved ones and of the truthful and the righteous, informed him that nothing but evil was left in the town, that the people were bent upon murdering him and that he should leave the town at once. Then in response to divine command, he migrated to Medina. Even then, his enemies did not leave him alone; they pursued him, and tried by every means to annihilate Islam. When their savagery reached these limits, and their crime of killing innocent people had made them only too fit to be punished, Muslims were given the permission to fight in self-defence. And those people and their helpers did deserve punishment for killing many innocent persons and robbing them of their possessions, not in any fair fight or battle, but out of sheer mischief. But in spite of all this, at the time of victory of Mecca, our Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, pardoned them all. It is, therefore, utterly wrong and unfair to suppose that the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, or his companions ever fought to spread Islam, or forced anyone to join its fold.

It is also worth remembering that because at that time all nations were highly prejudiced against Islam, and thinking it to be a new religion and its followers only a tiny group, its opponents were occupied in all manner of schemes to destroy and annihilate it. And everyone was anxious to see to it that somehow these people should be wiped out at the earliest, or should become so torn apart as to pose no danger of any growth. This is why the Muslims had to encounter hostility at every step, and anyone

from any tribe who accepted Islam was either summarily killed by his tribe or lived in perpetual grave danger of losing his life. At this juncture, God Almighty took pity on Muslim converts, and imposed on the bigoted powers the penalty of becoming subjects of the Islamic state, thereby throwing open the doors of freedom for Islam. This was meant to remove the obstructions in the way of those who wished to accept the faith; it was God's mercy upon mankind, and did no one any harm.

It is evident, however, that non-Muslim rulers today do not interfere with the religious freedom of Muslims; they do not restrict the carrying out of religious rites; do not kill new converts to Islam from among their own people and do not put them into prison or torture them. Why then should Islam permit the use of the sword against them? For a fact, Islam has never advocated compulsion in religion. If you closely study the Holy Quran, books of *Ahadith* and historical records, and examine them and reflect upon them as far as possible, you will realize with certainty that the charge that Islam ever used force and wielded the sword to spread the faith is an utterly unfounded and shameless allegation. Such charges are levelled against Islam by people who have not been able to read the Quran, *Hadith* and the authentic chronicles in an objective and impartial spirit, and have made free use of slander and falsehood. I know the time is approaching fast when those who are hungry and thirsty for truth will come to know of the reality of these slanderous charges. How can we describe Islam as a religion of compulsion, when its Holy Book, the Holy Quran, unequivocally commands:

لَا إِكْرَاهَ فِي الدِّينِ¹ Meaning that, there is no compulsion in religion. This means that you are simply not allowed to convert people by force. Can we ever accuse the great Prophet [Muhammad, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him] of using force, while, for thirteen long years of his Meccan life, he continued day and night to exhort his companions to remain patient and not to confront evil? When mischief exceeded all limits, and everyone joined hands to try to obliterate Islam, God's wrath required that those who kill by the sword should be killed by the sword. Except for this, the Holy Quran does not at all approve of compulsion. Were it so, the companions of our Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, in moments of trial, would not have succeeded in proving their sincerity as true believers. While the loyalty of the companions of our Lord and Master, the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, is a matter upon which I hardly need to dwell, it is no secret that the examples of upholding the truth and loyalty displayed by them are unparalleled in the history of other nations. This band of the faithful did not waver in their loyalty and steadfastness even under the shadow of swords. The unrelenting steadfastness they exhibited in the company of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, is not humanly possible unless one's heart and whole being is lit up with the light of genuine belief. In short, there is no room for compulsion in Islam.

Wars in Islam fall under three categories:

1. Defensive War—war by way of self-protection;

1. *Surah al-Baqarah*, 2:257 [Publisher]

2. Punitive War—blood for blood;
3. War to Establish Freedom—to break the hold of those who kill converts to Islam.

Thus, since there is no guidance in Islam that anyone should be converted by force or by threat to one's life, it is simply absurd and pointless to await the appearance of any bloodthirsty Mahdi or bloodthirsty Messiah. This is so because it is impossible that, contrary to the teaching of the Holy Quran, some such person should appear who would convert people to Islam by the sword. Now, this was not something that defied comprehension or was too difficult to understand. Only the ignorant have been led to this belief because of selfishness. Most of our clerics happen to labour under the delusion that wars waged by the Mahdi will bring them great wealth, so much so, that they will not be able to handle it. And since these days, most of the *maulavis* [Muslim clerics] of this country are so poverty stricken, they are eagerly waiting for the Mahdi to appear, who, they think, will satisfy their baser appetites. Little wonder, therefore, if these people turn against anyone who does not believe in the appearance of such a Mahdi. Such a person is at once denounced as an apostate, and outside the pale of Islam. For these very reasons I too am an apostate in their eyes, since I do not believe in the coming of a bloodthirsty Mahdi and a bloodthirsty Messiah and I detest such absurd beliefs. But this is not the only reason why they denounce me as an apostate. Of course, I do not believe in the coming of an imaginary Messiah and Mahdi which they believe in. But there is also an added reason, which is that I have publicly proclaimed that God Almighty has revealed to me that the real Promised Messiah who

is also the Mahdi, tidings of whose appearance are to be found in the Bible and the Holy Quran and whose coming is also promised in the *ahadith* is none other than myself. However, I have come without swords and guns and God has commanded me that with meek and gentle humility and peace I should invite people to that God Who is True, Eternal and Immutable and is the Most Holy, All-Knowing, Ever-Merciful, and Just.

I, indeed, am the light of this age of darkness. The person who follows me will be saved from falling into the pits and ditches prepared by the Devil for those who walk in the dark. I have been sent by God to lead the world to the True God with peace and gentleness, and to re-establish the reign of moral values in Islam. God has also provided me with heavenly signs for the satisfaction of seekers after truth, and has shown His wonderful miracles in my support. He has disclosed to me secrets of the unseen and of the future which, according to the Holy Scriptures of God Almighty, are the real criteria for judging and identifying the true claimant to this divine office. He has vouchsafed to me pristine verities and Knowledge. That is why, the spirits which hate the truth and love darkness have become my enemies. But it was my desire to be kind and forgiving towards mankind, as far as it lay in my power. Hence, in this age the greatest sympathy one can show to the Christians is to draw their attention to the True God Who transcends the traumas of birth, death, pain and suffering. He created all primordial matter and particles in spherical shapes, and thus signed this inherent message in nature that, there is in His own Being, like in sphericity, Unity and Oneness. This is why from among the primary bodies no thing has been created triangular. That is to say, all

the things God created in the very beginning, like the earth, the heavens, the sun and the moon, and all stars, and the elements, all are spherical in shape; and their sphericity points to the Unity and Oneness of the Creator. Hence there can be no truer sympathy and truer love for the Christians than that they should be guided towards that God Whose handiwork absolves Him of the taint of trinity.

The one good service one could do to the Muslims would be to reform their moral condition. Efforts should be made to dispel the false hopes which they entertain in connection with the appearance of a bloodthirsty Mahdi and Messiah. Such expectations are entirely against the teachings of Islam. I have just said that the ideas of some of the present day Muslim clerics that there will appear a bloodthirsty Mahdi, who will spread Islam at the point of the sword, are contrary to the Quranic teachings and are only the result of wishful thinking. For a right minded and truth-loving Muslim to shed such beliefs, it should be enough that he study the Holy Quran closely, pause, consider and see that the Holy Word of God Almighty is very much against threatening to kill people if they fail to become Muslims. This one argument alone is sufficient to refute such false notions. Nevertheless, out of a feeling of sympathy, I have decided to refute the aforesaid misconceptions by clear and positive proofs from history and other sources. Hence, I shall prove in this book that Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, did not die on the cross, nor did he go up to the heavens; nor should the hope be entertained that he would ever again come down to the earth from the heavens. On the contrary, the fact of the matter is that he died at the age of 120 years

at Srinagar, Kashmir, where his tomb is still to be found in the Khanyar quarter. To prove this point, I have divided this enquiry into ten chapters and an epilogue, which are as follows:

1. First, those testimonies related to this matter that we have found from the Gospels.
2. Second, those testimonies related to this matter that we have found from the Holy Quran and the *ahadith*.
3. Third, those testimonies that we have found from the books of medicine.
4. Fourth, those testimonies that we have found from the books of history.
5. Fifth, those testimonies that we have found from oral traditions which have been handed down from generation to generation.
6. Sixth, those testimonies that we have found from miscellaneous circumstantial evidence.
7. Seventh, those testimonies that we have found from logical arguments.
8. Eighth, those testimonies that we have found from the fresh revelation I have received from God.

These constitute eight chapters. In chapter 9, a brief comparison will be carried out between the religion of Christianity and Islam, on the basis of their teachings and arguments in favour of the truth of Islam will be set out. In chapter 10, there will be a somewhat detailed account of the aims and objectives which I have been divinely commissioned to realize. This will include evidence to prove that I am the Promised Messiah and that I have been sent

by Allah. At the end, there will be an epilogue in which I will set forth some important guidelines.

I trust that those who read this book will do so carefully, and will not reject, out of prejudice, the truth contained in it. I should like to remind that this is not a cursory and passing investigation; the proofs contained in this book have been made available after a deep and searching inquiry. I pray to God Almighty that He may help me in this undertaking and lead me by His special revelation and inspiration to the perfect Light of truth, for all true knowledge and clear perception descend only from Him, and only with His leave can it guide human hearts to the truth. *Aameen, again, aameen!*

Humbly,
Mirza Ghulam Ahmad,
Qadian, 25th April 1899 C.E.

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ¹

CHAPTER ONE

It should be made clear that although Christians believe that Jesus, may peace be on him, was arrested and crucified, owing to the villainy of Judas Iscariot, and was later resurrected, and raised to heaven, a detailed study of the Gospel, however, disproves this belief altogether. It is written in Matthew chapter 12 verse 40 that:

For as Jonas was three days and three nights in the whale's belly; so shall the son of man be three days and three nights in the heart of the earth.

Now it is obvious that Jonah did not die in the belly of the whale; and at the most what happened was that he lost consciousness or went into a swoon. The holy books of God bear witness that Jonah, by the grace of God, remained in the belly of the whale alive, came out alive, and his people ultimately accepted him. If then Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, had died in the

1. In the name of Allah, the Gracious, the Merciful. [Publisher]

belly of the whale,¹ what resemblance could there be between the dead and the living, and vice versa? The truth is, that because Jesus, the Messiah, was a true prophet and he knew that God, who loved him, would save him from an accursed death. Therefore, on the basis of the divine revelation received by him, he had prophesied in the form of a parable, and positively intimated that he would not die on the cross, nor would life depart from him on the accursed wood; on the contrary, like the prophet Jonah, he would only fall into a state of swoon. In the parable, Jesus, the Messiah, had also hinted that he would come out of the bowels of the earth and meet his people and, like Jonah, would attain honour among his people. Thus this prophecy was also fulfilled; for Jesus, the Messiah, came out of the bowels of the earth and went to those of his peoples who lived in the eastern countries like Kashmir and Tibet. These were the ten tribes of the Israelites who 721 years^{☆2} before Jesus, the Messiah, had been taken captive and forced to leave Samaria by Shalmaneser, King of Assur. They eventually came to India and settled in various parts of the country. And it was essential that Jesus, the Messiah, make this journey, for the divine object underlying his mission was indeed to meet the lost tribes of Israel who had settled in different parts of India. This was because, in reality, these were the lost sheep of Israel who had renounced their ancestral faith after settling in these parts, and most of them had become Buddhists, and gradually started

1. This is a misprint in the original Urdu, the word مچھلی (whale) should have been زمین (earth). [J.D. Shams]

2. ☆ Besides these, more Jews were also exiled to eastern countries as a result of Babylonian misfortunes. (Author)

worshipping idols. Thus it is that Dr. Bernier, on the authority of a number of eminent scholars, states in his book, *Travels* that the people of Kashmir in reality are the Jews who had migrated to this country during the political turmoil in the days of the king of Assur.^{☆1} In any case, it was incumbent upon Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, to find out the whereabouts of these lost sheep, who had got mixed with the local people after coming to this country of India. I shall presently produce evidence to prove that Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, did in fact come to India and then, by stages, travelled to Kashmir, and discovered the lost sheep of Israel among Buddhists, who ultimately accepted him the very same way Jonah was accepted by the people of Jonah. And it was essential for this to happen, for Jesus, the Messiah, had said in the Gospel, by his own tongue, that he had been sent for the lost sheep of Israel.

Quite apart from this it was also necessary that he must needs have escaped death on the cross for it is stated in the Holy Book that whoever is hanged on the cross is accursed. The term 'accursed' has a connotation which it would be most cruel and unfair to apply to a chosen one of God like Jesus, the Messiah, for, according to the agreed view of all whose mother tongue is Arabic, *la'nat*, or curse, has reference to the state of one's heart. A man is said to be accursed when his heart, having actually been estranged from God, becomes black; when, deprived of divine mercy and of divine love, devoid absolutely of His knowledge, blind and deaf like Satan, he is saturated with the

1. ☆ See Volume II of *Travels** by the Frenchman Dr. Bernier. (Author)

*see Appendix extract 10. [Publisher]

poison of perversion; when there remains not a ray of divine love and knowledge in him; when the bonds of love and loyalty are broken, and, between him and God, mutual hatred and disdain and spite and hostility take root, so much so that God becomes his enemy and he becomes the enemy of God; and God becomes weary of him and he becomes weary of God; in short, he becomes an heir to every single attribute of Satan. That is the very reason why Satan is called the accursed. ☆¹

Now it is clear that the connotation of the word 'accursed' is so foul and unclean that it can in no way truly apply to a righteous person who entertains the love of God in his heart. It is a pity that the Christians did not ponder over the significance of *la'nat* - curse, at the time of inventing this belief; otherwise, it would not have been possible for them to have used such a bad word for a righteous man like Jesus, the Messiah. Can we possibly say that a time ever came upon Jesus, the Messiah, when his heart actually became estranged from God; denied His existence, became weary of Him and became His enemy? Can we ever imagine that Jesus, the Messiah, ever felt in his heart that he was alienated from God, that he was an enemy of God, and that he was totally lost in the darkness of unbelief and denial? Thus, if the heart of Jesus, the Messiah, was never overcome with such feelings and his heart remained always full of the light of Divine love and knowledge, then, O Learned People! This is indeed a time to ponder that how can we ever say that not one, but thousands of curses descended upon Jesus, the Messiah, with all their evil significance!

1. ☆ Vide the lexicons: *Lisān-ul-Arab*, *Şiḥaḥ Jauharī*, *Qāmūs*, *Muḥīṭ*, *Tājul-Arūs*, etc. (Author)

God forbid, this could never be. Thus how then can we say that he became, God forbid, accursed? What a pity, that once a man has expressed some opinion or taken his stand on a certain doctrine, he never wishes to abandon it, no matter what manner of evil of this belief may be exposed before him. It is praiseworthy indeed to entertain the hope of salvation if it is based on some authentic reality, but where is the sense in a desire for salvation which murders a truth and countenances the belief regarding a holy prophet and perfect man, that he passed through a state in which he was totally estranged from God Almighty, and instead of unreserved and single-minded submission, there appeared in him a strangeness and alienation, even enmity and hatred, and that darkness filled his heart in place of light?

It should be remembered also that such a thought is not only opposed to the dignity of prophethood and stature of the messengership of Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, but goes also against his claim to spiritual eminence, holiness, love, and knowledge of God, to which he gives repeated expression in the Gospels. Read the New Testament and see that Jesus, may peace be on him, claims clearly that, I am the Light of the world, that I am the Guide, that I have a relationship with God that is of a high grade of love, that I have been blessed with a pure birth from Him, and that I am the beloved son of God. How then, in spite of these inalienable, pure and holy ties, can the unholy attributes of a curse become truly applicable to the heart of Jesus, the Messiah. This could never be so. Thus, without a doubt, this much is established that Jesus, the Messiah, was not crucified, that is to say, he did not die on the cross, for his person did not deserve the stigma of death on the cross. And since he did not die on the

cross his heart was without a doubt safeguarded from the unholy condition of being accursed. And without a doubt from this it is also to be concluded that he did not physically go to heaven, because ascension to heaven was a constituent part of this whole scheme and a corollary of being crucified. Thus when it is proven that as he was neither accursed nor did he go to hell for three days, nor did he die [on the cross], thus the second part of the scheme, namely, that of ascension to heaven, also stands falsified. And even more proofs arise from the Gospels regarding this, which I proceed to set out below.

One of these is the following statement that issued forth from the mouth of Jesus, the Messiah:

But after I am risen again, I will go before you into Galilee.
(Matthew 26: 32)

From this verse it is very clear that Jesus, the Messiah, after he had come out of the sepulchre, went to Galilee and not to heaven. And these words of Jesus, the Messiah, that, 'After I am risen,' can not mean coming to life after having died; rather, since in the eyes of the Jews and the ordinary people, he had died on the cross, thus Jesus, the Messiah, used these words that were in accord with what their thoughts were going to be in the future. And indeed, if a man is put on the cross, with nails driven into his feet and hands, so much so that falling into a swoon from this pain he comes to look like a corpse; if such a man is saved from his ordeal and recovers his senses, it would hardly be an exaggeration on his part to say that he had come to life again. There is no doubt that after so much suffering, the escaping from death of Jesus, the Messiah,

was a miracle, it was no ordinary thing; but it would be wrong to say that Jesus, the Messiah, had actually died. It is true, that words to this effect are found in the Gospels, but this is only the kind of mistake which the Evangelists have also made in the recording of many other historical events. In the light of their research, commentators of the Gospels admit that the books of the New Testament can be divided into two parts:

1. One part is the religious teaching which the disciples received from Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him; this constitutes the essence of the Gospel.

2. And the second part are the historical events, like the genealogy of Jesus, and his being arrested and being beaten; and the existence at the time of Jesus, the Messiah, of a miraculous pond, etc. These are those matters that were recorded by the writers on their own authority. So these are not revelations but have been written down according to the writers' own perceptions. And at places, we find also gross exaggerations, for instance, it is stated at one place that if all the works done by Jesus, the Messiah, meaning the miracles he showed, were put into writing in books, the world would not be big enough to accommodate those books. What an extreme exaggeration.

Quite apart from this, it would be quite in keeping with common parlance to describe as death the traumatic shock suffered by Jesus, the Messiah. This kind of expression is found in almost all peoples. Whenever a man escapes from such a near-fatal experience, without any hesitation he is considered to have been given 'a new life.' And there is no artificiality associated with this type of an expression among the people of any nation or country.

After all these matters, one thing more worthy of attention

is that in the Gospel of Barnabas, which should also be available in the London library, it is also written that Jesus, the Messiah, was not put on the cross, nor did he die upon the cross. Here we can indeed draw the conclusion that although this book is not included in the Gospels and has been rejected without any decisive verdict, yet there is no doubt that it is an ancient book, and belongs to the same period in which the other Gospels were written. Do we not then have the right to view this aged, ancient book as a historical book of the Old Testament and according to the station of a historic text draw benefit from it? And can we not conclude, at the very least, from reading this book that at the time of Jesus, may peace be on him, when the event of the cross took place, people were not unanimous as to Jesus, the Messiah, having died on the cross? Then, apart from this, in the four Gospels themselves, there are present metaphors whereby it is said of a dead person that he is asleep and not dead. This being the case a person in a swoon being described as being dead is not too far from the realm of possibility. I have already mentioned, that a prophet never lies. Jesus, the Messiah, compared his three days' stay in the tomb to the three days Jonah spent in the belly of the whale. From this it can only be concluded that just as Jonah remained alive in the belly of the whale for three days, similarly, Jesus, the Messiah, must also have remained alive in the tomb for three days. And the Jewish tombs in those days were not like the present-day tombs; they were very spacious like a room and had an opening at one end covered with a big stone. I shall prove in due course and at the appropriate occasion that the tomb of Jesus, may peace be on him, which has been recently discovered in Srinagar, Kashmir, is

exactly similar to the one in which Jesus, the Messiah, was placed in a state of swoon.

In short, the verse I have just quoted shows that Jesus, the Messiah, after coming out of the tomb, went to Galilee. And it is written in the Gospel of Mark that after coming out of the tomb, he was seen travelling on the road to Galilee, and eventually he met those eleven disciples when they were eating their meal; and he showed them his hands and feet which bore wounds; and they thought that he was perhaps a spirit. Then he said to them: 'It is I myself; touch me and see for a spirit has no flesh and bones as I have.' Then he took a piece of broiled fish, and of an honeycomb and ate it before them. See Mark 16:14¹ and Luke 24:39–42.²

From these verses it can be learned with certainty that Jesus, the Messiah, never went to heaven; rather, coming out of the tomb he went to Galilee and appeared like human beings having the same ordinary body and ordinary customary clothes. If he had been resurrected after death, how was it that his spiritual

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1. 'Afterward he appeared unto the eleven as they sat at meat, and upbraided them with their unbelief and hardness of heart, because they believed not them which had seen him after he was risen.' Mark 16:14 [Publisher]
 2. 'And as they thus spake, Jesus himself stood in the midst of them, and saith unto them, Peace be unto you. But they were terrified and affrighted, and supposed that they had seen a spirit. And he said unto them, Why are ye troubled? and why do thoughts arise in your hearts? Behold my hands and my feet, that it is I myself: handle me, and see; for a spirit hath not flesh and bones, as ye see me have. And when he had thus spoken, he shewed them his hands and his feet. And while they yet believed not for joy, and wondered, he said unto them, Have ye here any meat? And they gave him a piece of a broiled fish, and of an honeycomb. And he took it, and did eat before them.' Luke 24:36–43 [Publisher]

body could still have borne the wounds inflicted upon him on the cross? What need had he to eat food? And if he required food then he must be in need of food even now!

Readers should not fall into the error of thinking that the Jewish cross was like the present day gallows, from which deliverance is almost an impossibility. Because in the cross of those days, no noose was secured around the neck of the victim, nor was a wooden plank pulled from under the victim to bring about the hanging. Instead, the victim was put on the cross, his hands and feet were nailed to it; and there was always the possibility that after he was put on the cross and duly nailed, he could still be taken down alive after a day or two, before his bones had been broken, in case it was decided to spare his life, the punishment already undergone being considered sufficient. If he was meant to be killed, he was kept on the cross, was denied food and water and left in this condition under the sun for three days or more, after which his bones were broken and he would at last expire under all these tortures. But the Grace and Mercy of God Almighty, saved Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, from such degree of agony which would have meant certain death. An ordinary perusal of the Gospels would reveal to you that neither did Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, remain on the cross for three days, nor did he have to suffer hunger or thirst for three days, and neither were his bones broken. On the contrary, he remained on the cross only for about two hours, and it was so arranged for him that, by the Grace and Mercy of God, he was placed on the cross in the latter part of the day, and that day was a Friday, and only a small part of the day remained, and the next day was the Sabbath, and the Jewish feast of Fasah. Now, according to Jewish custom,

it was unlawful and a cognizable offence to let anyone remain on the cross on the Sabbath, or the night before. Jews, like Muslims, followed the lunar calendar, according to which the day began with the sunset. Thus, on the one hand was this welcome circumstance which was born of earthly causes, and, on the other, heavenly causes developed due to God Almighty. When the sixth hour had struck, such a severe dust storm began to blow that it enveloped the world in darkness and persisted for at least three hours. See Mark 16:33.¹ The sixth hour was after twelve o'clock and was close to evening. Now, the Jews got worried at the deep darkness and feared lest the night of the Sabbath should overtake them and lest, having violated the sanctity of the Sabbath, they should be deservedly punished. Therefore, they hurriedly removed Jesus, the Messiah, and the two thieves also from their crosses. In addition to this, there was another heavenly intervention. When Pilate presided at his court, his wife sent word to him saying that he should have nothing to do with that just man (that is to say, he should not seek to have him killed): for she had suffered many things that night in a dream because of him. See Matthew 27:19.² So, this angel, who was shown to the wife of Pilate in her dream; from this we, and all fair-minded people, would certainly understand, that God Almighty had never intended for Jesus, the Messiah, to die on the cross. From the very beginning when the world came into

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1. This seem to be a scribe's error; the correct reference is Mark 15:33. [Publisher]
 2. When he was set down on the judgment seat, his wife sent unto him, saying, Have thou nothing to do with that just man: for I have suffered many things this day in a dream because of him (Matthew 27:19). [Publisher]

being till today, it has never happened that God Almighty should induce a person in a dream to act in a particular way to save some person, and yet that effort should fail to succeed. For example, it is written in Matthew that an angel of the Lord appeared to Joseph in a dream, saying:

Arise, and take the young child and his mother, and flee into Egypt, and be thou there until I bring thee word: for Herod will seek the young child to destroy him. (Matthew 2:13)

Now, can anyone say that it was possible for Jesus, the Messiah, to have been killed upon arriving in Egypt? In exactly the same way, it was a part of the plan from God Almighty that Pilate's wife was shown a dream regarding Jesus, the Messiah, and it was not possible that this plan could fail in its objective. Just as the possibility of Jesus, the Messiah, being put to death during the journey to Egypt was against the specific promise of God Almighty, so here too it is unthinkable that the angel of God Almighty, should appear to Pilate's wife and point out to her that if Jesus, the Messiah, died on the cross it would spell disaster for her, and yet the angel's appearance should go in vain, and Jesus, the Messiah, should be allowed to suffer death on the cross. Is there any example of this in the world? No, never. The pure conscience of every good man, when informed of the dream of Pilate's wife, will no doubt testify that for a fact it was the purpose of the dream to lay the foundation for rescuing Jesus, the Messiah. Everyone in the world is free, of course, to reject a self-evident reality, out of sheer prejudice for his creed, and not accept it, but on the basis of fairness we have

to accept that the dream of Pilate's wife is a weighty piece of evidence in support of the escape of Jesus, the Messiah, from the cross. And Matthew, the first and foremost Gospel, has recorded this testimony in writing. Although the evidence which I shall set out forcefully in this book at once invalidates the divinity of Jesus, the Messiah, and the doctrine of Atonement, yet honesty and love for truth should always require that in accepting the truth we pay no heed at all to people, family, and customary beliefs. Ever since his creation, man, because of his short-sightedness, has made gods out of thousands of objects, so much so, that even cats and snakes have been worshipped. But nevertheless, the wise among men, by the ability bestowed upon them by God, have always managed to keep away from such polytheistic beliefs.

And from among the testimonies found in the Gospels, which testify to Jesus, the Messiah, remaining safe from death on the cross, is the journey he undertook to a far-off place i.e. Galilee after coming out of the sepulchre. Thus, on Sunday morning, the first person he met was Mary Magdalene, who at once informed the disciples that Jesus, the Messiah, was alive, but they did not believe her. Then he was seen by two of the disciples who were walking in the countryside; and finally he appeared to all the eleven while they were at their meal and remonstrated with them for their callousness and lack of faith. See the Gospel of Mark 16:9–14. Again, when the disciples were going towards the hamlet called Emmaus, 3.75 *kose*¹ from Jerusalem, Jesus, the Messiah, joined them; and

1. Different scales are used to measure distance in different parts of the world. According to the measurement mentioned by the Promised Messiah in this book, one *kose* is equal to 1.625 miles. [Publisher]

when they reached the hamlet, Jesus, the Messiah, wanted to part company with them, but they insisted on his staying and spending the night together. He then dined with them, and they all spent the night with Jesus, the Messiah, in Emmaus. See Luke 24:13-31. Now, it is absolutely impossible and irrational to say that Jesus, the Messiah, ate and drank and slept and made a journey of about 70 *kose* to Galilee and performed all the functions of the physical body with a disembodied spirit—the spiritual form Jesus, the Messiah, is thought to have taken after death. And despite the fact that the accounts found in the Gospels have suffered much alteration due to the confluence of various thoughts; nevertheless the words, to whatever extent they are found clearly prove that Jesus the Messiah met his disciples in the same ordinary mortal physical body and undertook the long journey to Galilee on foot and showed his disciple his wounds and ate and spent the night with them. Further on we shall prove that he treated his wounds with an ointment.

Now, one has to consider, as to how it is possible that after a person has been invested a glorious and eternal frame, and exempted from the necessity of eating and drinking, is to sit on the right hand of God Almighty, and freed from all pain and deformity, he should still bear on his hands and feet fresh nail wounds which bleed and hurt, and an ointment has to be prepared to heal them? In other words, even after having an eternal body which should last forever without changing or deteriorating, Jesus, the Messiah, was still suffering from a number of travails. He even showed his flesh and bones to his disciples; he was also prone to hunger and thirst, or it would serve no purpose to eat and drink and to rest during his journey. Food and water are

indeed necessary for mortal bodies in this world, and their lack could prove fatal. Hence, there is no doubt that Jesus, the Messiah, did not die on the cross, and did not acquire a new spiritual body: rather, he was in a state of swoon which resembled death. And it so happened, by God Almighty's Grace, that the tomb in which he was placed was not like the tombs we have in this country; but rather it was a large and ventilated room with an opening. It was a custom with the Jews in those days to build large sepulchres with an access; they were kept ready in advance and when someone died, his body was placed therein. We find a clear testimony of this in the Gospels. Luke contains this statement:

Now upon the first day of the week, very early in the morning, they (that is to say, the women) came unto the sepulchre, bringing the spices which they had prepared, and certain others with them. And they found the stone rolled away from the sepulchre (ponder a little at this point). And they entered in, and found not the body of the Lord Jesus. (Luke 24:2-3)¹

Consider for a moment the words, 'they entered in.' Obviously, a human being can only enter a tomb which is like a room and has an opening. I shall state at its proper place in this book that the tomb of Jesus, may peace be on him, which has recently been discovered in Srinagar, Kashmir, also has an opening just like this

1. This seems to be a misprint in the first edition. The correct reference is Luke 24:1-3. [Publisher]

sepulchre. And this is a very grand secret by paying attention to which, researchers can arrive at a magnificent conclusion.

And from among the testimonies found in the Gospels are those words of Pilate, which are recorded in the Gospel of Mark, and they are:

And now when the even was come, because it was the preparation, that is, the day before the Sabbath, Joseph of Arimathaea, an honourable counsellor, which also waited for the kingdom of God, came, and went in boldly unto Pilate, and craved the body of Jesus. And Pilate marvelled if he were already dead. (Mark 16: 42-44)¹

From this we draw the conclusion that suspicion had risen at the very moment of crucifixion as to whether Jesus, the Messiah, had actually died, and note also that the suspicion was raised by a person who knew well enough how long it took for a person to die on the cross.

And from among the testimonies found in the Gospels is also the following statement that I write below:

The Jews, therefore, because it was the preparation, that the bodies should not remain upon the cross on the sabbath day (for that sabbath day was an high day,) besought Pilate that their legs might be broken, and that they might be taken away. Then came the soldiers, and brake the legs

1. This seem a misprint in the first edition. The correct reference is Mark 15:42-44. [Publisher]

of the first, and of the other which was crucified with him. But when they came to Jesus, and saw that he was dead already, they brake not his legs: But one of the soldiers with a spear pierced his side, and forthwith came there out blood and water. (John 19:31–34)

From these verses one learns clearly that in order to put an end to the life of a crucified person, it was the practice in those days to keep him on the cross for several days, and then to break his legs, but Jesus' legs were purposely not broken, and he was taken down alive from the cross, like the two thieves. That is also the reason why blood gushed out when his side was pierced, whereas the blood of a dead man is congealed. This also shows very clearly that there was some kind of an internal secret plan. Pilate was a God-fearing and good-hearted man; he could not openly show favour to Jesus, the Messiah, for fear of Caesar because the Jews condemned Jesus, the Messiah, as a rebel. All the same, Pilate was lucky to have beheld Jesus, the Messiah, but Caesar was not so fortunate. Pilate not only saw Jesus, the Messiah, but also showed him great favour. He did not at all desire that Jesus, the Messiah, should suffer crucifixion. It is clear from looking at the Gospels that Pilate resolved several times to let Jesus, the Messiah, go, but the Jews threatened that if he did so, he would be disloyal to Caesar because, according to them, he was a rebel who wanted to become king. (John 19:12)

Moreover, the dream which Pilate's wife saw, was also the prime mover to the effect that somehow or the other, Jesus, the Messiah, should be saved from crucifixion, and that it would otherwise spell disaster for them themselves. Since the Jews were a

mischievous people, and were quite ready to report him to Caesar, Pilate used a subterfuge to release Jesus, the Messiah. First, he ordered the crucifixion of Jesus, the Messiah, to take place in the expiring hours of a Friday, close to the night of Sabbath. Pilate was only too well aware that according to the Jewish law Jesus, the Messiah, could only be kept on the cross until that evening, as the Sabbath would then begin and it would be unlawful to keep the bodies on the cross. And this is precisely what transpired and Jesus, the Messiah, was taken down from the cross before the evening. It is unthinkable that the two thieves should be alive after two hours and Jesus, the Messiah, should be dead; this was rather part of the design not to allow the bones of Jesus, the Messiah, to be broken. To a person with some common sense, it is indeed a reasonable point to ponder that the two thieves were taken down alive from their crosses. Indeed, it was normal practice that people were taken down alive from the cross and died only when their bones were broken or they breathed their last because of hunger and thirst after staying on the cross for a few days. But Jesus, the Messiah, had to suffer none of these travails. Neither was he kept on the cross hungry and thirsty for so many days, nor were his bones broken. And by pronouncing that Jesus, the Messiah, had died the Jews were made oblivious of his state but the bones of the thieves were broken and their lives thus ended. It would be understandable if even one of the two thieves had died and there had been no need to break his bones.

Furthermore, Joseph, a close friend of Pilate's, who was a chief in those parts, and a secret disciple of Jesus, the Messiah, happened to arrive at this very moment. I presume that he too was summoned by Pilate. Jesus, the Messiah, was declared dead and

his body was placed in his custody. Since Joseph was a respected personality, the Jews could not quarrel with him. Thus, he took charge of Jesus, the Messiah, who had been declared dead whereas he was actually in a swoon. Following Pilate's instructions, he took Jesus to a room with an opening which was used as a grave according to the prevailing custom of the time, and was beyond the access of the Jews.

All this took place in the midst of the 14th century after the demise of the prophet Moses, and the Messiah was the divine reformer who was to revive the Jewish faith in that century. Although the Jews themselves were awaiting the Promised Messiah in the fourteenth century, and the prophecies of the earlier prophets testified to his coming, it is a pity that the unworthy clerics of the Jews did not recognize the person and the time and denounced their Promised Messiah as an imposter. Not content with this, they also called him an apostate and a heretic, pronounced a verdict of death against him, and dragged him to court. This shows that the fourteenth century has the inherent quality of making people's hearts callous, and causing religious clerics to become wholly inclined to worldliness, blind and averse to the truth. A comparison between the fourteenth century after Moses and the fourteenth century after the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him—who is the similitude of Moses, will show, first, that in both of these centuries there was a man who claimed to be the Promised Messiah, and that it was a true claim, made on the authority of God. We also know that the religious leaders of the two peoples declared both of them to be apostates, denounced them as unbelievers and Antichrists, and pronounced verdicts of death against both. They were both taken

to the courts; a Roman court in one case and a British court in the other. But in the end, they were both saved and the designs of both the Jewish and the Muslim clerics failed. God intended to raise great communities for both the Messiahs, and to defeat the designs of their enemies. In short, the fourteenth century after Moses and the fourteenth century after our Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, are both hard and trying and, in the long run, full of blessings for their respective Messiahs.

And from among the testimonies found in the Gospels, which testify to Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, remaining safe from death on the cross is the one narrated in Matthew 26:36–46. It relates that, having been informed by revelation of his impending arrest, Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, prayed to God all night, crying and prostrating. And it was necessary that prayers offered in such humility, for which Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, was given ample time, must have been accepted because God never turns down the prayer of a chosen one when he prays in distress. How then could the prayer of Jesus, the Messiah, have been turned down, which he offered all night long in a state of anguish and distress, particularly when Jesus, the Messiah, himself had announced that his Father in heaven listened to his prayers. How could we say that God listened to his prayers if this prayer offered in such distress was not accepted? From the Gospels it is also learnt that Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, was certain in his heart that this prayer of his had been accepted and that he was very much relying on this prayer of his. That is why when he was arrested and put on the cross, and found the circumstances apparently contrary to

his own expectations, he involuntarily cried out: '*Eli, Eli, lama sabachthani*,' that is to say, 'My God, my God, why hast Thou forsaken me?,'¹ Meaning, 'I did not ever expect that this would be my end and that I would die on the cross. I believed with certainty that You would listen to my prayers.' So, both these references of the Gospels show that Jesus, the Messiah, firmly believed with all his heart that his prayer would be accepted and that his night-long cries and supplications would not go to waste. In fact, he had himself taught his disciples, on behalf of God Almighty, that if they prayed, their prayers would be accepted. He had also related the parable of the judge who feared neither God nor man, which was intended to convey to the disciples that, without doubt, God Almighty did indeed listen to prayers. And although Jesus, the Messiah, had been apprised by God Almighty of the impending catastrophe that was to befall him, yet, like all righteous people, he nevertheless prayed to God Almighty, believing that there was nothing impossible for Him and that everything that happened or did not happen was subject to God's will. Now if the prayer of Jesus, the Messiah, himself was not accepted, God forbid, what an adverse effect this would have had on his disciples who had seen with their own eyes that the prayer of a great prophet like Jesus, the Messiah, addressed all night long with such burning passion, had not been accepted. Such an unfortunate example would have sorely tried their faith. God Almighty's mercy, therefore, required that this prayer must be accepted; and indeed the prayer that was offered at Gethsemane was accepted.

There is another point to remember in this connection. Just

1. See Matthew 27:46 [Publisher]

as there was a conspiracy to kill Jesus, the Messiah, for which purpose the chief priests and the scribes assembled at the house of the high priest called Caiphas and devised a plan to somehow kill Jesus, the Messiah, so was there a conspiracy to murder Moses, and, likewise, our Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, for which there was a secret consultation in Mecca at a place called Darul-Nadwa. But God Almighty saved both the great prophets from the evil consequences of these designs. The conspiracy against Jesus, the Messiah, lies, in point of time, between the two conspiracies; why then was he not saved, even though he had prayed far more than these two holy prophets. Why was the prayer of Jesus, the Messiah, not heard, when God hears the prayers of His beloved servants and frustrates the designs of the wicked? All righteous people know by experience that the prayer of the distressed and the afflicted is accepted. Indeed the hour of distress is the time for the righteous to show signs. I have had personal experience of this. Two years ago, a false charge of attempted murder was brought against me by Dr. Martyn Clark, a Christian, who was a resident of Amritsar, Punjab. The case was filed in the district court, Gurdaspur, and it was alleged that I had sent a person named Abdul Hameed to murder the said doctor. It so happened that I was opposed in this case by several scheming persons belonging to the three communities, Christian, Hindu, and Muslim, who joined hands and tried their level best to prove the charge of attempted murder. The Christians were against me because I was trying, and am still trying, to rescue humanity from the false notions which Christians entertain regarding Jesus; and this was the first taste of their ire that I experienced. The Hindus were displeased with me because I had made a

prophecy after receiving revelation from God regarding the death of Pundit Lekh Ram, with his consent, and the prophecy was fulfilled within the appointed time, which was indeed a terrible sign from God. Likewise, the Muslim clerics too were angry, because I was opposed to the idea of their bloodthirsty Mahdi and bloodthirsty Messiah coming and furthermore I was also opposed to the doctrine of Jihad as understood by them. So, some important personages of these three communities counselled together to somehow prove the charge of murder against me, so that I should either be hanged or imprisoned. They were thus unjust in the sight of God Almighty for harbouring such thoughts. And God had informed me of this before such secret plans had been hatched, and had given me the tidings of my ultimate acquittal. And these holy divine revelations were announced beforehand to hundreds of people; and when after the revelation, I prayed that: 'O my Lord! Repel this affliction from me,' it was then that I received the revelation that, 'I will repel it and acquit you from the charge brought against you in this trial.' This revelation was verbally communicated to many whose number was more than three hundred, many of whom are still alive. It so happened that my enemies produced false witnesses in the court, and very nearly 'proved' the case, witnesses of the three communities mentioned earlier having deposed against me. Then, it so happened, that the entire truth of the case was disclosed by God Almighty in a variety of ways to the magistrate before whom the case was pending. This magistrate was Captain W. Douglas, the Deputy Commissioner of Gurdaspur. Thus it became clear to him that the case was false. Then without caring the least for the doctor, who was also a missionary, his love for justice and fair mindedness compelled him to

dismiss the case. Thus what I had announced about my acquittal on the authority of divine revelation to hundreds of people and in public meetings, quite opposed to the most fearful situation that existed, turned out to be true. This served to fortify the faith of many people. This was not all. More charges of this kind and calumnies of a criminal character were preferred against me for the same kind of reasons as laid out above, and cases were taken to court, but before I could be summoned to court, God informed me through His revelation, of the origin and the end of each affair, and in every case howsoever alarming, I was given the glad tidings of acquittal in advance.

The point of this discourse is that without a doubt God Almighty accepts prayers, especially when those who rely on Him are facing oppression and knock on his door; He attends to their complaints, and helps them in wonderful ways. To this, I myself am a witness. So what was the cause and what was the reason why the prayer of Jesus, the Messiah, uttered in such anguish was not accepted? No, on the contrary, it was indeed accepted, and God did save him. God caused things to happen on earth and in heaven to rescue him. John, i.e. the Prophet Yahya, was not given reprieve by God to pray for his end had arrived, but Jesus, the Messiah, was given a whole night to pray, and he spent it in supplication, standing and prostrating before God, for God had willed that he should give expression to his distress and pray for his deliverance to Him for Whom nothing was impossible. So the Lord, in keeping with His eternal practice, heard his prayer. The Jews lied when they taunted Jesus, the Messiah, at the time of the crucifixion as to why God had not saved him despite his trust in Him? God frustrated all the designs of the Jews and saved His beloved Jesus,

the Messiah, from the cross and the attending curse. And the Jews had indeed failed.

And from among the testimonies found in the Gospels that have reached us are the following verses from the Gospel of Matthew that I write below:

That upon you may come all the righteous blood shed upon the earth, from the blood of righteous Abel unto the blood of Zacharias son of Barachias, whom ye slew between the temple and the altar. Verily I say unto you, All these things shall come upon this generation. (Matthew 24:35-36)¹

Now, if you think over these verses you will find that Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, clearly says that the killing of prophets by the Jews ceased with the prophet Zacharias, and that after that, the Jews will have no power to kill any prophet. This is a major prophecy from which the conclusion can be drawn clearly that Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, was not killed as a result of crucifixion; he was rather saved from the cross, dying ultimately a natural death. For if it had been true that Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, was also to suffer death at the hands of the Jews, like Zacharias, he would surely have hinted at it in these verses. And if it is argued that Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, was killed by the Jews but this was not a sin on the Jews' part, for his death was in the nature of an atonement, the

1. Chapter 24 is a scribe's error. In the King James Version, these verses are chapter 23:35-36. [Publishers]

contention is hardly tenable, for in John 19:11 Jesus, the Messiah, says very clearly that the Jews have been guilty of a great sin for having resolved to kill him; and likewise in many other places there is the unmistakable hint to this same thing. And it is clearly written that as a penalty for the crime of which they had been guilty against Jesus, the Messiah, they had become deserving of punishment in the sight of God Almighty. See the Gospel of Matthew 26:24.¹

And among the testimonies of the Gospels which have reached us, is this verse in the Gospel of Matthew which is written out herein below:

Verily I say unto you, There be some standing here, which shall not taste of death, till they see the Son of man coming in his kingdom. (Matthew 16:28)

Similarly there is this verse from the Gospel of John:

Jesus saith unto him, If I will that he (that is to say, the disciple John) tarry (meaning, in Jerusalem) till I come. (John 21:22)

This means that, 'If I will, John will not die till I come again'. From these verses it is proven with perfect clarity that Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, had made a promise that some people would still be alive when he returned; and among these, he had named John. So it was essential that this promise should

1. Gospel of Matthew [Publishers]

have been fulfilled. Accordingly, Christians also admit that for the prophecy to be fulfilled in accordance with the promise, it was inevitable that Jesus, the Messiah, should have come at a time when some of his disciples were still alive. This is also the basis of the clergymen's declaration that Jesus, the Messiah, had come to Jerusalem at the time of its destruction, as he had promised, and that John had seen him, as he had remained alive till that time. But it should be noted that Christians do not admit that Jesus, the Messiah, had really come down at that time, from heaven accompanied by the appointed signs; they rather say that he appeared to John in a kind of vision so that he might fulfil his prophecy contained in Matthew 16:38.¹ But I say that such coming does not fulfil the prophecy. It is a very poor attempt at interpretation and is meant to try and get away from objections with extreme artificiality. And this interpretation is so evidently untenable and wrong that it needs no refutation, for if Jesus, the Messiah, had to appear to anyone in a dream or a vision, a prophecy of this kind would simply become a laughing matter.^{☆2} Moreover, Jesus, the

1. This is a misprint in the first edition; the correct reference is 16:28. [Publisher]

2. ☆ I have seen in certain books interpretations of Matthew 26:24* by Muslim clerics which are more laboured than even the interpretations of Christians; they say that when Jesus, the Messiah, declared it to be a sign of his coming that some people of that generation would still be alive and that a disciple would also be alive when Jesus, the Messiah, would appear, it is necessary that that disciple should be living up till now, for Jesus, the Messiah, has not come yet; and they think that that disciple is hiding somewhere on some mountain, awaiting Jesus, the Messiah! (Author)

*This is a misprint in the first edition; the correct reference is Matthew 16:28. [Publisher]

Messiah, had also appeared to Paul long before this in the same manner. It appears that the prophecy contained in Matthew 16:28 has caused great panic among the padres and they have not been able to give it a rational meaning consistent with their own beliefs. It was difficult for them to say that Jesus, the Messiah, at the time of the destruction of Jerusalem, had descended from heaven in glory, and that, like the lightning which lights up the heavens, was seen by everybody; and also it was not easy for them to ignore this statement of the Gospel that, 'Some of those who are standing here will not taste death till they have seen the Son of man coming in his kingdom.' Therefore, as a result of a laboured interpretation they believed in the fulfilment of the prophecy in the form of a vision. But this is nevertheless not true; the righteous servants of God always appear in visions to the divinely elect, and for a vision it is not even necessary that they should appear only in a dream, they can be seen even when one is awake, and I myself have experienced such phenomena. I have seen visions in which I met Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, many a time, and I have also met some of the other prophets, while I was fully awake. I have also seen our Chief, Lord and Master, the Holy Prophet Muhammad, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, many a time in this condition, and I have talked with him. And I have seen him in such a clear state of being awake that sleep or drowsiness had nothing to do with it at all. I have also met some dead people at their graves or other places while I was awake, and have talked to them. I very well know that such a meeting with the dead in this state is possible, and that not only can we meet, we can also talk to them and even shake hands. Between this and the ordinary state of being awake there is no difference during such an experience;

a person feels that he is in this very world, has the same ears, eyes and tongue, but deeper reflection reveals a different universe. The world cannot understand this kind of wakefulness, for the world is living in a state of oblivion. This wakefulness is gotten from heaven; it is given to those who are endowed new senses of perception. This statement is indeed true and based on actual occurrences. Thus if this is how Jesus, the Messiah, appeared to John after the destruction of Jerusalem, though the latter might have seen him while fully awake, and though they might have had some conversation and a handshake between them, nevertheless, the incident has nothing to do with this prophecy. Such phenomena often take place in the world and even now, if I devote some attention to it, I can by the grace of God see Jesus, the Messiah, or some other holy prophet while I am awake. But such a meeting would certainly not fulfil the prophecy contained in Matthew 16:28.

What actually happened was that Jesus, the Messiah, knew that he would be saved from the cross and would migrate to another land, and that God would neither let him die nor take him away from this world as long as he had not seen the destruction of the Jews with his own eyes, and that he would not die unless and until the kingdom of heaven, vouchsafed to the godly, realized its aims and objectives. Thus Jesus made this prophecy to assure his disciples that they would presently see this sign of his that those who had raised the sword against him would be killed with the sword during his lifetime and in his very presence. Thus, if evidence is of any value, there is no greater evidence to convince the Christians than the fact that Jesus, the Messiah, himself prophesied with words uttered by his own tongue that some of them would still be alive when he returned.

Remember that the Gospels contain two kinds of prophecies about the coming of Jesus, the Messiah:

The first are those that relate to the promise of his coming in the latter days. So that promise means his coming in the spiritual sense, like the coming of Elijah before the coming of Jesus, the Messiah. So, like Elijah, he has already appeared in this, our age and it is I, the writer, a servant of humanity, who has appeared as the Promised Messiah, with the name of Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him. And Jesus, the Messiah, has told of my coming in the Gospels, so blessed is he who, for the honour of Jesus, the Messiah, considers my claim with justice and fairness, and saves himself from going astray.

The other kind of prophecies regarding the second coming of Jesus, the Messiah, mentioned in the Gospels constitute, in fact, evidence of his life which continued, enduring and restored, after the experience of the cross, by the sheer grace of God Almighty. It was in accordance with this prophecy that has just been mentioned that God saved his chosen servant from death on the cross.

The Christians are mistaken in mixing up these two contexts with each other. And it is for this very reason that they face great bewilderment and have to endure many difficulties. The verse in chapter 16 of Matthew is, therefore, a very important piece of evidence in support of Jesus, the Messiah, escaping from the cross.

And among the testimonies of the Gospels which have reached us, is also the following verse of the Gospel of Matthew:

And then shall appear the sign of the Son of man in heaven: and then shall all the tribes of the earth mourn,

and they shall see the Son of man coming in the clouds of heaven with power and great glory. (Matthew 24:30)

The true meaning of this verse is that Jesus, may peace be on him, says that a time will come when, from heaven, that is to say purely as a result of divine power, such knowledge and proofs and evidence will come into being as will invalidate the doctrines of his divinity, death on the cross, going up to heaven and coming back again; and that heaven will bear witness against the lies of those peoples, like, for example, the Jews, who denied his being a true prophet, and considered him to be accursed on account of his being put on the cross. And the fact that he did not suffer death on the cross and was, therefore, not accursed would become clearly established; then all the nations of the earth, who had exaggerated or detracted from his true station, would go into mourning and due to their error great shame and ignominy would be their lot. And in this same age, when this fact would become widely known, people would see Jesus, the Messiah, descending to the earth in a spiritual manner. This means that the Promised Messiah, who would come in the power and spirit of Jesus, the Messiah, would appear in these very days; with heavenly support and with such power and majesty accompanying him through God Almighty, and all his lustrous signs, that he would be easily recognised. When further explained, the verse means that God Almighty's will has so made the person of Jesus, may peace be on him, and such are the events of his life that they have caused some peoples to exaggerate, and others to downgrade his status. There are those who have placed him above the category of human beings, so much so that they say that he has not yet died and is sitting alive in heaven. Then there

are those who have gone one better and say that, having died on the cross and come back to life again, he has gone to heaven and become invested with all the powers of divinity and that he is God Himself. And the other people are the Jews who say that he was killed on the cross and therefore—God forbid—he is accursed for all times to come; that he is doomed to be the object of perpetual divine wrath. And that God is disgusted with him and looks upon him with revulsion and enmity; that he is a liar, an impostor and God forbid, a disbeliever, and an atheist; and that he is not from God. So these exaggerations and detractions were so unjust that it was but natural that God Almighty should exonerate His true prophet from these charges. The verse of the Gospel quoted above also points to this fact. The statement that all the nations of the earth would mourn and lament suggests that all those people to whom the term ‘nation’ applies would mourn on that day; they would beat their chests and cry, and great would be their mourning. The Christians should study this verse with some care and ponder that when the verse prophesies that all nations would mourn, how is it possible that the Christians would remain out of this mourning? Are they not a nation? Thus, in accordance with this verse, if they too are a part of those who shall mourn, why then are they not concerned about their salvation? The verse clearly says that when the sign of Jesus, the Messiah, appears in the heavens, all the nations inhabiting the earth will mourn. Thus the person who says that our people will not mourn denies Jesus, the Messiah. Only those who are yet a small minority cannot be the people hinted at in the prophecy, as they are not yet numerous enough to be described as a nation. These people are none but us. Ours is the only community which is outside the sense

and scope of this prophecy, for this community has yet only a few adherents to whom the term 'nation' cannot be applied. Jesus, the Messiah, on the authority of divine revelation, says that when a particular sign appears in the heavens all the people of the world who, on account of their numbers, deserve to be described as a nation will mourn; no one shall be excluded from this except those who are small in number and to whom the term nation cannot apply. Neither Christians, nor Muslims, nor Jews, nor any other denier, can keep out of the purview of this prophecy. Our community alone is outside its scope for God has only just sowed us like a seed. The word of a prophet can in no way prove false. And since the prophecy contains the unmistakable hint that every nation inhabiting the world will mourn so which of these people can claim to be outside its scope? Jesus, the Messiah, admits of no exception in this verse. But yes, that group which has not yet attained the size of a nation is in any case an exception, and that is our community. This prophecy has been very clearly fulfilled in this age, for the truth, which has now been revealed regarding Jesus, the Messiah, is undoubtedly the cause of mourning for all these nations, because it has exposed the error of their thinking. The tumult and uproar of the Christians over their manufacturing of a god turns into sighs of grief; the insistence of Muslims day in and day out that, "Jesus, the Messiah, has gone up to the skies alive," "has gone up to the skies alive," changes into weeping and wailing; and as for the Jews, they stand to lose everything.

Here it is also worth remembering that in the statement contained in the said verse, namely, that at that time all the nations of

the earth would mourn, the word ‘earth’ means *Bilaaad-e-Sham*¹ with which these three peoples are basically connected—Jews, because that is their place of origin and their place of worship; Christians, because Jesus, the Messiah, appeared in that place, and the first Christian peoples came into being in this very place; Muslims, because they are the heirs of this land to the Last Day. And if the word ‘earth’ is taken to embrace all lands, even then it presents no difficulty, for when the truth is laid bare every denier would be ashamed.

And from among the testimonies that have reached us through the Gospels, is this statement from the Gospel of Matthew that is written herein below:

And the graves were opened; and many bodies of the saints which slept arose, and came out of the graves after his resurrection (that is to say after the resurrection of Jesus, the Messiah) and went into the holy city, and appeared unto many. (Matthew 27:52)²

There is not the slightest doubt that this story that is mentioned in the Gospel that after the resurrection of Jesus, the Messiah, the people came out of the graves and appeared alive to many, is not the recounting of any historical incident that took place; for, had it been so, the Judgment Day would verily have manifested in this very world, and those matters that had been kept hidden from the

1. Syria and its neighbouring areas. [Publisher]

2. In the King James Version, these verses are Matthew 27:52–53. [Publisher]

world as a test of faith and sincerity would have been made apparent and evident to all. Faith would not have remained faith, and, in the sight of every believer and denier, the nature of the next world would have become an evident and open fact, like the existence of the moon, the sun, and the alternation of day and night. In that case, faith would no longer be that valuable and worthwhile thing, possessing which could give one hope of receiving a reward.

If the people and past prophets of Israel whose number reaches into the hundreds of thousands, had really been brought to life at the time of the crucifixion and had in fact come back to the city alive; and if this miracle, that hundreds of prophets and hundreds of thousands of saintly people were all brought to life at the same time, was really shown to prove the truth and divinity of Jesus, the Messiah, the Jews would have had an excellent opportunity to inquire of their prophets, saints, and other ancestors, whether Jesus, the Messiah, who claimed to be God was indeed God, or was he a liar! One can easily imagine that they could not have missed this welcome opportunity. They must have inquired as to what type of person this was, for the Jews were very keen to compare notes with the dead if they could be restored to life. Thus, when, hundreds of thousands of the dead were restored to life, and flocked to every street in the city in their thousands, how could the Jews have let go of such an opportunity? They must have inquired, not from one or two, but from thousands; and when the dead entered their respective houses there must have been great commotion all over the place, for many hundreds of thousands of them had been brought back to life. In every house there must have been great excitement, and everybody must have been questioning the dead as to whether the man Jesus, who called

himself the Messiah, was really God. But because the Jews, after the testimony of the dead, did not believe in Jesus, the Messiah, as we would expect them to do, nor did their hearts soften, rather if anything, they became confirmed in their hard-heartedness, it appears more than probable that the dead did not speak a single favourable word for him. They must have pronounced straight away that this man was making a false claim to Godhood, and was lying against God. That must have been why the Jews did not desist from mischief in spite of the fact that hundreds of thousands of men, indeed prophets and apostles had been restored to life. Having 'killed' Jesus, the Messiah, they attempted to kill all others. How can one believe that hundreds of thousands of saints who, right from the time of Adam up to the time of John the Baptist, had been resting in their graves in this holy land, should all be brought back to life; that they should all flock to the city to preach, and everyone of them should stand up and testify before thousands of people that Jesus, the Messiah, was really the Son of God—no, God Himself; that he alone should be worshipped; that the people should renounce their former beliefs, otherwise, they would go to hell, which these saints had witnessed for themselves! Yet, notwithstanding such excellent evidence and such eyewitness accounts which proceeded from the mouths of hundreds of thousands of dead saints, the Jews should not desist from their denial! My own conscience is certainly not prepared to accept this. Therefore, if hundreds of thousands of saints, prophets and apostles, etc., who were dead, had really come to life and had visited the city to give evidence, they must undoubtedly have given unfavourable evidence; they could never have borne witness to the divinity of Jesus, the Messiah. This must have been the reason why

the Jews became more firmly entrenched in their disbelief after listening to the evidence of the dead. Jesus, the Messiah, wanted them to believe in his divinity, but they, because of this evidence, denied that he was even a prophet.

In short, such beliefs have a highly deleterious and unhealthy effect, namely, to say that hundreds of thousands of dead persons, or any dead person before that time, had been brought back to life by Jesus, the Messiah; for the restoration to life of the dead did not serve any beneficent purpose. This is a part of human nature that if a person goes to visit a far-off country and comes back to his hometown after several years of absence, he is naturally keen to tell the people of his wonderful experiences of that country, and to relate to them the wondrous of wonderful stories of the land he has visited. He will not keep mum or remain tongue-tied when he meets his people after a long period of separation. No, at such a time, others also are keen to listen to him and question him about the far off places; and if perchance, there comes to these people some poor and lowly person, humble in appearance, who yet claims to be the king of the country of which the principal town has already been visited by these people and who says that he is superior in his kingly rank even to this and that king, the people are always wont to question such itinerants whether the man, going about in their country, is really the king of that land; to which question these travellers reply to the best of their knowledge. This being so, the bringing of the dead to life by Jesus, the Messiah, would have been, as I have stated before, worth believing in, if the evidence on which the dead must have been questioned, which was but natural, had led to some beneficial result. However, this was not at all the case. Therefore, along with the supposition

that the dead were brought back to life, one is compelled to suppose that the dead did not give evidence favourable to Jesus, the Messiah, which could lead one to believe in his truth. They rather gave evidence which added to the already existing confusion. Would that instead of human beings, mention had been made of bringing back to life some quadrupeds, for then much could have been kept hidden. For example, if it had been said that Jesus had brought back to life several thousand bullocks, it would have been 'reasonable' enough, and, if the question was asked as to what the evidence of these dead animals had led to, the answer would have been easy: how could the mute bullocks testify one way or the other? The dead, however, whom Jesus, the Messiah, brought back to life, were human beings. Suppose some of the Hindus were asked if ten or twenty of their dead ancestors were restored to life and brought back to this world and were asked to state which religion was the true religion, would they still have any doubt about the truth of that religion? They would never say no. Therefore, take it for a certainty that there is no man in the whole world who would persist in his disbelief and denial after such a disclosure. What a pity that in inventing such stories, the Sikhs of our country have fared better than the Christians. The Sikhs have given proof of their astuteness in the art of inventing stories; for they state that their Guru, Bawa Nanak, once restored a dead elephant to life. This 'miracle' is not open to the above objection, for the Sikhs can say: the elephant had no tongue to bear witness for or against Bawa Nanak. In short, the common people, endowed with little intellect, are pleased with such 'miracles', but the wise are embarrassed by the objections raised by others and are put to shame in whichever assembly such silly stories are related. Now,

as I bear the same feelings of love and sincerity towards Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, as do the Christians; rather, I have a stronger attachment to him, for Christians do not know the man whom they praise, but I know him whom I praise, for I have as good as seen him. Therefore, I now proceed to unveil the real nature of the reports contained in the Gospels that at the time of the crucifixion all dead saints had come back to life and returned to the city.

Let it, therefore, be clearly understood that accounts like these are of the nature of [visions] that were seen by some holy men after the crucifixion, in which they saw that the dead saints had been brought back to life and graced the city where they met the people. Just as dreams mentioned in divine scriptures are interpreted, for instance, Joseph's dream, this vision too had an interpretation of its own. The interpretation was that Jesus had not died on the cross and that God had rescued him. If the question is asked as to the rationale behind this interpretation, the answer is that experts in the art of interpretation testify to its validity and have borne witness to it on the basis of their experience. I quote below from *T'aṭīrul-Anām*, a time honoured authority on the art of interpretation of dreams.

من رأي أن الموتى و ثبوا من قبورهم و رجعوا إلى دورهم فإنه يطلق من في السجن
See the book *T'aṭīrul-Anām fī T'abīril-Manām*, by Quṭb-
uz-Zamān Sheikh 'Abdul Ghanī an-Nābulīsī, p. 289.

Translation: If someone has a dream or a vision that the dead have come out of their graves and have made for their homes, the interpretation is that a prisoner would be released from bondage, and that he would be rescued

from the hands of his persecutors. The context shows that this prisoner would be a great and prominent personage. Now, it should be noted how appropriately this interpretation applies to Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him. One can readily understand that the vision about the dead saints coming to life and returning to the city was meant to inform those with insight that Jesus, the Messiah, would be saved from death on the cross.

Likewise, the Gospels at a number of places clearly point out that Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, did not die on the cross and that he escaped and migrated to another land. I think what I have said so far should suffice for the fair minded to understand the true position.

It is possible that objections may arise in some minds that the Gospels also repeatedly point out that Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, died on the cross, and that after resurrection he rose to heaven. This kind of objection I have already briefly answered, but I think it appropriate to mention now also that after the crucifixion, Jesus, may peace be on him, met the disciples; he travelled up to Galilee; ate bread and meat; displayed the wounds on his body; stayed a night with the disciples at Emmaus; escaped secretly from Pilate's jurisdiction; emigrated from that place, as was the practice of prophets; and travelled under the shadow of fear. All these facts prove that he did not die on the cross; that he retained his mortal body together with all its needs and functions intact; and that he had undergone no visible change.

Furthermore, the Gospels do not contain any eyewitness

account of the ascent to heaven.^{☆1} Even if there had been such an account, it would have lacked credibility, for making mountains out of molehills and magnifying small things into big ones, seems to be a habit with the evangelists. For example, if one of them happens to remark that Jesus, the Messiah, is the Son of God, another sets about making him into a full-fledged God, the third invests him with power over the whole universe, and the fourth bluntly says that he is everything, and that there is no other God besides him. In short, exaggerations carry them too far. The vision in which the dead were seen to come out of their graves and make for the city is a case in point. One can notice that this vision had been given a literal interpretation, so far as to say that the dead had actually risen out of their graves, had come to the city of Jerusalem, and even visited their relatives. Consider how an entire crow has been fabricated from a single feather, and that single crow did not so remain, for from it were made to fly hundreds of thousands of crows! Where such exaggeration is employed, how can one arrive at the truth! It is also worth considering that these Gospels, which are called the Books of God, contain preposterous claims, such as that if all the works of Jesus, the Messiah, had been committed to writing, there would not be room enough in the whole world to accommodate them!² Can such exaggeration be the way of honesty and truth? If indeed the works of Jesus, the Messiah, were so limitless and exceeded all boundaries, how could they have been compressed into a meagre period of three

1. ☆ No one makes the statement that I bear witness to this and that my eyes have seen that he did bodily ascend to the heavens. (Author)

2. John 21:25 [Publisher]

years? Another defect that these Gospels suffer from is that some references they give of earlier books are wrong. They could not even write down the genealogy of Jesus, the Messiah, correctly. From the Gospels, it appears that these noble people were rather naive to the extent that some mistook Jesus, the Messiah, for a ghost. And from the earliest times these Gospels have been open to the charge that they have not been able to preserve the purity of their texts, particularly when there were many other books too which were compiled as Gospels. Thus there is no solid reason why all the statements of those books should be rejected, and why all that is contained in the Gospels, generally so-called, should be admitted as true. We do not think that the other Gospels could contain such unfounded exaggerations as are to be found in the present four Gospels. It is strange that while on the one hand, it is said in these books that Jesus, the Messiah, was a righteous person and that his character was without blemish, yet on the other hand, such charges are heaped upon him as are not at all befitting the station and eminence of a righteous person. For example, the Israelite prophets, in accordance with the teaching of the Torah, undoubtedly had hundreds of wives each at a time in order that they might thereby produce a whole generation of righteous people. But you will never have heard that any prophet had ever set such an example of permissiveness that he should allow a wanton and lascivious woman, a noted sinner of the city, to touch his body with her hands, to let her rub oil—her sin's earnings—on his head and to stroke his feet with her hair; that he allowed all this to be done by an unchaste young woman, and did not so much as tell her to stop it. One is saved from giving way to suspicion, which naturally arises on seeing such a spectacle, only by

the blessing of thinking good. Nevertheless, this example can be of no benefit to others. In short, these Gospels are full of material which shows that they have not preserved their original form, or that their writers were other than the disciples or their pupils. For example, can this statement from the Gospel of Matthew: 'And this is well known among the Jews till today'¹ be properly and correctly said to have been written by Matthew? Does it not show that the writer of this Gospel of Matthew was some other person, who lived at a time when Matthew had already died? Then, in this same Gospel of Matthew in Chapter 28, verses 12-13 it is written:

And when they were assembled with the elders, and had taken counsel, they gave large money unto the soldiers, Saying, 'Say ye, his disciples came by night and stole him away while we slept.

Notice how childish and meaningless these statements are. If it is meant by this that the Jews wanted to conceal the rising of Jesus, the Messiah, from the dead, and have, therefore, bribed the soldiers so that this great miracle should not become generally known, why was it that Jesus, the Messiah, whose duty it was to proclaim this miracle among the Jews, kept it a secret and forbade even others to disclose it? If it is said that he was afraid of being caught, I would say, that when the decree of God Almighty, had descended upon him once and for all, and he had, after suffering death, come to life again, assuming a glorious body, what fear did he now have of the Jews? Surely, the Jews could not now have any

1. Matthew 28:15 [Publisher]

power over him; he was now beyond and above mortal existence? One observes with regret that while, on the one hand, it is said that he was made to live again and assume a glorious body, that he met the disciples and went to Galilee and thence went to heaven, yet the fear of the Jews prevails over quite trivial things and, in spite of his glorious body, he fled secretly from the country, lest some Jews should discover him; he made a journey of 70 *koses* to Galilee in order to save his life and time and again asked the people not to mention this to others. Are these the signs and ways of a glorious body? No, the truth is that his body was neither new nor glorious, it was the same body with wounds on it, which had been saved from death; and as there was still the fear of the Jews, Jesus, the Messiah, took all the necessary precautions and left the country. All the things that are said contrary to this are, one and all, senseless and absurd; as that the Jews had bribed the soldiers to make them say that the disciples had stolen the corpse while they (the soldiers) were asleep. If the soldiers were asleep, they could very well have been asked how on earth they came to know in their sleep that the corpse of Jesus, the Messiah, had been stolen away. And from the mere fact of Jesus, the Messiah, not being in the sepulchre, can a sensible person conclude that he had gone up to heaven? Are there, in this world, no other causes, as a result of which, tombs might be found empty? It was the responsibility of Jesus, the Messiah, to provide proof of this; such that, on his way to heaven, he should have met a few hundred Jews, and also Pilate. Who was he afraid of in his glorious body? But he did not care to furnish his opponents with the slightest proof. On the contrary, he took fright and fled to Galilee. That is why we positively and certainly believe and accept that though it is true

that he left the sepulchre, which was a chamber with an opening, and though it is also true that he secretly met the disciples, yet it is not true at all that he was given any new and glorious body. It was the same body, and the same wounds, and there was the same fear in his heart lest the accursed Jews should arrest him again. Just study closely Matthew 28:7–10. In these verses it is clearly written that the women who were told by someone that Jesus, the Messiah, was alive and was going to Galilee, and who were also quietly told that they should inform the disciples, were no doubt pleased to hear this, but they departed with hearts full of fear. In other words, they were still afraid lest Jesus, the Messiah, might even now be caught by some wicked Jew. And in verse 9 it is said that while these women were on their way to inform the disciples, Jesus, the Messiah, met and greeted them with the greeting of peace. And in verse 10 it is said that Jesus, the Messiah, told them not to be afraid, that is to say do not be afraid of me being caught, but tell my brothers that they should go to Galilee; ^{☆1} that they would see me there, i.e., he could not stay here for fear of the enemies. In short, if Jesus, the Messiah, had really come to life after his death and had assumed a glorious body, it was up to him to furnish proof of this new kind of existence to the Jews. But we know that he did not discharge this duty of providing such proof.

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1. ☆ **Note:** Here, Jesus, the Messiah, did not console the women with the words that he had now risen with a new and glorious body and that no one could now lay his hands upon him. Instead, seeing the women weak and frail he consoled them casually, as men are wont to always console women. In short, he gave no proof of the glorious body; rather, he exhibited his flesh and bones and thus demonstrated that his was an ordinary mortal body. (Author)

It is absurd, therefore, to accuse the Jews of trying to suppress the proof of Jesus, the Messiah, coming back to life again. The fact is that Jesus, the Messiah, himself failed to provide the slightest proof of his restoration to life; rather, by his running and hiding, and by the fact of his taking food, and sleeping, and showing his wounds, he himself proved that he did not die on the cross.

CHAPTER TWO

Containing Evidence from the Holy Quran and Authentic *Abadith* which relates to Jesus, the Messiah, being Saved from the Cross

The thought may arise in everyone's mind concerning these arguments which I am now going to write in this Chapter, that on the face of it, to present these reasons to the Christians is devoid of any benefit, because they do not consider the Holy Quran and any Hadith to be binding upon them. But I have written them down only for this purpose that the Christians may become informed of a miracle of the Holy Quran and our Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him; and this reality may become apparent to them as to how those truths which have only now become known after centuries, had already been mentioned by the Holy Quran and our Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. I am now going to mention some of them in what follows. Allah, the Exalted, says in the Holy Quran:

وَمَا قَاتَلُوهُ وَمَا صَلَبُوهُ وَلَٰكِنْ شُبِّهَ لَهُمْ... الْآيَةُ... وَمَا قَاتَلُوهُ يُقِيْنًا¹ الْآيَةُ

1. *Sūrah an-Nisā'*, 4:158 [Publisher]

Meaning that, the Jews neither in reality murdered Jesus, the Messiah, nor did they kill him on the cross; but rather a suspicion developed in them as though Jesus has died on the cross; and they do not possess such proofs, on the basis of which, their hearts could be satisfied that Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, had certainly died on the cross.

In these verses Allah, the Exalted, says that though it is true that Jesus, the Messiah, was apparently placed on the cross, and that the intention was to kill him; yet it was merely a delusion for the Jews and Christians to suppose that Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, had actually died on the cross. On the contrary, God caused such things to happen due to which he was saved from dying on the cross. Justice demands that we now acknowledge the truth of what the Holy Quran had said that was quite opposed to the Jewish and Christian beliefs and in the end it was that very thing which proved to be true. And in this age, highly qualified research has proved that Jesus, the Messiah, was actually saved from death on the cross. A study of the literary records shows that the Jews were always unable to answer the question as to how Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, died within two or three hours of being put on the cross even when his bones had not been broken? This has led the Jews to invent another plea: that we had killed Jesus, the Messiah, by the sword, but the killing of Jesus, the Messiah, by the sword is not proven from the ancient history of the Jews. Glorious is Allah, the Exalted, that in order to save Jesus, the Messiah, darkness covered the land, and an earthquake took place. Pilate's wife saw a dream. The Sabbath night drew near during which it was not the practice to let a crucified body remain on the cross. Because of the terrible dream the heart

of magistrate became disposed towards the release of Jesus, the Messiah. All this was simultaneously brought about by God to save the life of Jesus, the Messiah. And Jesus, the Messiah, himself, was made to go into a swoon so that he might be taken for dead by everyone. And by showing a most terrifying sign like the earthquake, the Jews were afflicted with cowardice, fear and the apprehension of divine wrath. They were also afraid lest the corpses should remain on their crosses during the night of Sabbath. Then it also happened that seeing Jesus, the Messiah, in a swoon they thought that he was dead. It was a time of darkness and there was an earthquake and great bewilderment. They also became anxious about their homes and what their children must be passing through in the darkness and the earthquake. There was also this terror prevalent over their hearts that if this man was a liar and an apostate, as we had thought in our hearts, then why were such terrifying signs being manifested at the moment of his suffering, signs which they had never seen manifested before? The resulting restlessness in their hearts made them incapable of properly looking into whether Jesus, the Messiah, had died or what state was he in. But in reality all these things were part of a Divine design to save Jesus, the Messiah. This verse contains an indication to exactly this: وَلَكِنْ شُبِّهَ لَهُمْ that is to say, 'the Jews did not kill Jesus; but it was God who made them fall into the suspicion as if they had killed him.' It is these circumstances which encourage the righteous to place great trust in the Grace of God Almighty, and to believe that God can save His servants as He pleases.

And the Holy Quran also says the following in favour of Jesus, the Messiah:

وَجِيئًا فِي الدُّنْيَا وَالْآخِرَةِ وَمِنَ الْمُقَرَّبِينَ¹

The translation of this is that in this world and in the hereafter Jesus, the Messiah, will have a life in which he will be bestowed honour, that is to say, respect and stature, and eminence and greatness in the eyes of the ordinary people. Now it is evident that Jesus, the Messiah, was not honoured in any way in the land of Herod and Pilate. On the contrary, he suffered great humiliation. And the thought that he will be accorded honour and eminence upon returning to the world is a groundless delusion, which is not only opposed to the purport of the Books of God Almighty but is also repugnant and opposed to His eternal law of nature, and moreover is a matter lacking any proof. But the real and true statement is that when Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, having escaped from the clutches of that ill-fated people, graced the land of the Punjab with his presence, God Almighty blessed him with great honour and here he found those ten tribes of Israel who had been lost. It seems that most of the Children of Israel, upon arriving in this country, had adopted Buddhism and some had degenerated into idolatry of a very low kind. But with the coming here of Jesus, the Messiah, most of them returned to the right path, and since the teaching of Jesus, the Messiah, contained the exhortation to believe in the prophet who was to come, all the ten tribes who came to be known in this land as Afghans and Kashmiris ultimately became Muslims. In short, Jesus, the Messiah, was accorded great esteem and respect in this land. And recently a coin has been discovered in the Punjab, which bears the name of

1. *Sūrah Āl-e-‘Imrān*, 3:46 [Publisher]

Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, in Pali characters. This coin goes back to that very time which was the time of Jesus, the Messiah. From this it becomes certain that Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, was given regal honour and respect, and it is very likely that the coin must have been issued by a king who had come to believe in Jesus, the Messiah. Another discovered coin displays the figure of an Israelite male. It appears that this too is the figure of Jesus, the Messiah.

The Holy Quran also contains this verse which says that Jesus, the Messiah, was blessed by God wherever he went.¹ And these coins show that he received great blessings from God, and that he did not die until he was honoured like a king.

Similarly, the Holy Quran also contains this verse:

وَمُطَهِّرُكَ مِنَ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا²

Meaning that, 'O Jesus! I shall clear thee of these charges; and I shall prove thy innocence and shall clear thee of all accusations levelled against thee by the Jews and the Christians.' This was a great prophecy. The sum total of this is that the Jews alleged that Jesus, the Messiah, having been crucified, became accursed (God forbid), and thus the love of God continued to depart from his heart, that his heart, as the word 'curse' implies, became estranged and alienated from God, and fell into an endless storm of darkness, and began to love evil and oppose every virtue, and breaking

1. وَجَعَلْنَاهُ مَبْرُكًا إِنَّ مَا كُنْتُ — *Sūrah Maryam*, 19:32 [Publisher]

2. *Sūrah Āl-e-Imrān*, 3:56 [Publisher]

away from God became a subject in the Kingdom of Satan and there developed a real animosity between him and God! The same allegation of his being accursed, was applied to him by the Christians also, but they have, due to their ignorance, tried to combine two opposing things in one and the same place. On the one hand, they declared Jesus, the Messiah, to be the Son of God, and on the other, they also declare him to be accursed. And they admit themselves that one who is accursed is the son of Darkness and of Satan, or rather, he is Satan himself. So, these were the foul allegations made against Jesus, the Messiah. And the prophecy of the Holy Quran, *مُطَهَّرٌ* [I will clear thee (O' Jesus)] indicates that a time would come when God Almighty would clear Jesus, the Messiah, of these charges and this indeed is that time.

Although the testimony of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, has no doubt established the innocence of Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, in the eyes of intelligent people, for the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, and the Holy Quran have both testified that the charges brought against Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, are all unfounded. But this evidence was too subtle and theoretical in the eyes of the common man. Divine justice, therefore, desired that just as the crucifixion of Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, was a well known matter, and from among things manifest and tangible, so should his innocence and exoneration be demonstrated palpably and tangibly. And this is now exactly what has come to pass, that is to say, the innocence of Jesus, may peace be on him, has not only been proved in theory but also palpably. And hundreds of thousands of people have seen, with their own eyes, that the tomb of Jesus, the

Messiah, may peace be on him, is present in Srinagar,¹ Kashmir. And just as Jesus, the Messiah, was crucified at Golgotha, that is to say the site of the Skull, his tomb too has been found at the site of the Skull i.e. Srinagar. That the word *sri* [skull] should occur in the names of both the places is a strange coincidence indeed. The place where Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, was crucified was called Gilgit (Golgotha) or *sri*, and the place where in the latter part of the nineteenth century, the tomb of Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, has been discovered is also called *Gilgit*, or *Sri*. It appears that the place called Gilgit, which is located in the area of Kashmir, also suggests the term *Sri*. This town was probably founded in the time of Jesus, the Messiah, and as a local memorial to the crucifixion, it was named *Gilgit*, or *Sri*; similarly Lhasa, which means the ‘city of the one worshipped’; this is a Hebrew word, and Lhasa too was founded in the time of Jesus, the Messiah.

Reliable reports in the *ahadith* show that our Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, said that Jesus, the Messiah, lived to an age of one hundred and twenty-five (125). And all the sects of Islam accept that in Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, two such characteristics came together as are not to be found together in any other prophet:

1. The word ‘Srinagar’ comprises two Hindi words, *sri* (skull) and *nagar* (place), meaning ‘Place of a Skull’. The place where Jesus, the Messiah, was put on the cross, was also called ‘Place of a Skull’. See Matthew 27:33, Mark 15:22, Luke 23:33, John 19:17. [Publisher]

1. One was that he lived to the ripe old age of one hundred and twenty-five (125) years.
2. Second, that he travelled to many parts of the world and was therefore called the 'travelling prophet.'

Now it is evident that had he been raised to the skies at thirty-three (33), the report that he lived for one hundred and twenty-five (125) years could not be true, nor could he have managed to travel so widely in such a short lifespan of thirty-three years. Not only are these narrations found in the earliest and reliable collections of *ahadith*, but it is not possible to think of narrations that are more widely known and so consistently accepted among all the sects of Islam.

Kanzul-'Ummāl, which is a comprehensive collection of *Abadith*, contains this hadith, in volume 2, page 34, from Abu Huraira:

اوحى الله تعالى إلى عيسى ان يا عيسى انتقل من مكان إلى مكان لئلا تعرف
فتوزي^{☆1}

That is to say, Allah, the Exalted, sent revelation to Jesus, may peace be on him, that, 'O Jesus! Keep moving from one place to another,' i.e. go from one country to another so that upon recognising you someone should not cause you distress.

1. ☆ Vol. 2* (Author)

*See *Kanzul-'Umāl, al-Bābul-Awwal fil-Akhlāq, Faṣl Khaufil-Āqibah*. [Publisher]

And then, in the same book (volume 2, page 71) is found this hadith narrated by Jābir:

كان عيسى ابن مريم يسبح فاذا أمسى أكل بقل الصحرا ويشرب ماء
القرح^{☆1}

That is to say, Jesus, may peace be on him, continuously travelled from one country to another, wherever he happened to be at nightfall, he would partake of the vegetables of the jungle and drink pure water.

And then, in this same book, ‘Abdullah bin ‘Umar narrates the following words:

قال أحب شي إلى الله الغرباء قيل أي شي الغرباء قال الذين يفرون بدينهم
ويجتمعون إلى عيسى ابن مريم^{☆2}

That is to say, the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, said, ‘The people most beloved in the sight of God are those who are *ghareeb*.’ When asked, what was meant by the term *ghareeb*, he replied, ‘They are the people who, like Jesus, the Messiah, have to flee from their country to save their faith.’

1. ☆ Vol. 2, page 71* (Author)

*The word يشرب is a misprint. It should be شرب. See *Kanzul-‘Umāl, al-Bābul-Awwal fil-Akhlāq, Faṣṣiṣ-Ṣabr ‘Alā-anwā’il-Balāyā* [Publisher]

2. ☆ Vol. 6, page 51* (Author)

*See *Kanzul-‘Umāl, Kitābul-Fitan, Faṣṣiṣ fil-Waṣiyyati fil-Fitan*, printed at Daira-tul-Maarif Al-Nizamia Press, Hyderabad, India, 1313 Hijrah. [Publisher]

CHAPTER THREE

Evidence from Medical Literature

We have come across a piece of highly valuable evidence concerning the deliverance of Jesus, the Messiah, from the cross, whose authenticity just has to be accepted. It is a medical preparation known as the 'Ointment of Jesus' [*Marham-i-Isa*] and is found recorded in hundreds of medical books. Some of these books were compiled by Christians, some by Magians or even Jews, and some by Muslims. Most of them belong to very early times. Investigations show that in the beginning, based on oral tradition, the preparation came to be known by hundreds of thousands of people. Later this prescription was duly written down. First, in the days of Jesus, the Messiah, shortly after the crucifixion, a pharmacopoeia was compiled in Latin, which contained this prescription and in which it was stated that it had been prepared for the treatment of the wounds of Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him. Later, that work was translated into several other languages, until, in the time of Mamun-ar-Rasheed, it was translated into Arabic. And strange are the ways of divine providence, that

eminent physicians of all religions, Christians, Jews, Magians and Muslims, all have recorded this prescription in their books, and all have stated exactly the same thing concerning it, that it was prepared for Jesus, may peace be on him, by his disciples. A study of the various books in which the properties of the uncompounded medicines are written down it is learnt that this preparation is very useful for injuries sustained by blows or falls; for it immediately arrests the flow of blood that follows upon such injuries, and, as it contains 'myrrh,' the wound remains safe from becoming infected. And this ointment is also beneficial for the treatment of plague; and it is good for boils and ulcers of all kinds. It is, however, not clear whether the ointment was prepared by Jesus, may peace be on him, himself after he had undergone the trauma of the cross, as a result of divine revelation, or whether it was prepared after consultation with some physician. Some medicines in it are like a sovereign remedy especially 'myrrh' which is also mentioned in the Torah. In any case, the wounds of Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, healed up in a few days by the use of this ointment. Within three days he recovered sufficiently to be able to march seventy *koses* on foot from Jerusalem to Galilee. Hence, regarding the efficacy of this preparation, it is enough to say that while Jesus, the Messiah, healed others, this preparation healed Jesus, the Messiah! The books which record this fact number more than one thousand. It would take long to mention them all. Moreover, as the prescription is a famous one among the physicians practising Greek medicine, I need not mention the titles of all these books; but I shall set down below the names of a few books which are available here.

List of those books of medicine that mention Marham-i-Isa and also, that it was prepared for Jesus i.e. for treating the wounds of his body.

- *Qānūn*, Shaikh-ur-Ra'īs Bū-Alī Sinā, vol. III, p. 133.
- *Sharh-ul-Qānūn*, 'Allāmah Quṭb-ud-Dīn Shīrāzī, vol. III.
- *Kāmiluṣ-Ṣinā'ah*, 'Alī bin-al-'Abbās al-Majūsī, vol. II, p. 602.
- *Kitāb Majmū'ah al-Baqā'i*, Maḥmūd Muḥammad Ismā'il, Mukhṭib of Khāqān, known as father of Muḥammad Baqā Khān, vol. II, p. 497.
- *Kitāb Tadhkirah Ulul-Albāb*, Shaikh Dāwūd aḍ-Ḍarīr al-Anṭākī, p. 303.
- Roman *Qarābādīn* a book concerning Skin Diseases, compiled about the time of Jesus, the Messiah, and translated in the reign of Māmūn ar-Rashīd into Arabic.
- *Kitāb 'Umdatul-Muḥtāj*, Ahmad Bin Ḥasan ar-Rashīdī the physician. In this book, the Ointment of Jesus and other preparations have been noted from a hundred, perhaps more than a hundred books, all these books were written in the French language.
- *Kitāb Qarābādīn*, in Persian, Ḥakīm Muḥammad Akbar Arzānī—Skin Diseases.
- *Kitāb Shifā-ul-Asqām*, vol. II, p. 230.
- *Kitāb Mir'āt-ush-Shifā*, Ḥakīm Naththu Shāh (manuscript) under Skin Diseases.
- *Dhakhīra-i-Khawarzam-i-Shāhī* under Skin Diseases.
- *Sharḥ Qānūn Gilānī*, vol. III

- *Sharḥ Qānūn Qarshi*, vol. III
- *Qarābādīn*, 'Alwī Khān under Skin Diseases.
- *Kitāb Ṭlāj-ul-Amrād*, Ḥakīm Muḥammad Sharīf Khān, p. 893.
- Greek *Qarābādīn* under Skin Diseases.
- *Tuḥfat-ul-Mu'minīn*, on the margin of *Makhzanul-Adwiyah*, p. 713.
- *Kitāb Muḥīṭ fiṭ-Ṭibb*, p. 367
- *Kitāb Iksīr-i-A'zam*, vol. IV, Ḥakīm Muḥammad A'zam Khān, alias Nāzim-i-Jahān, p. 331.
- *Kitāb Qarābādīn-i-Ma'sūmī*, Li-Ma'sūm bin Karīm-ud-Dīn ash-Shustarī Shīrāzī.
- *Kitāb 'Ujālah Nāfi'ah*, Muḥammad Sharīf Dehlawī, p. 410.
- *Kitāb Ṭibb-i-Shibrī*, otherwise known as Lwāmi' 'Shibriyyah Sayyid Husain Shibr Kāzimī, p. 471.
- *Kitāb Makhzan-i-Sulaimānī*, translation of *Iksīr-i-Arabī*, p. 599, Muḥammad Shams-ud-Dīn of Bahawalpur.
- *Shifā-ul-Amrād*, translated by Maulānā al-Ḥakīm Muḥammad Nūr Karīm, p. 282.
- *Kitāb-uṭ-Ṭibb Dārā Shakuhī*, Nūr-ud-Dīn Muḥammad 'Abd-ul-Ḥakīm, 'Ainul-Mulk ash-Shīrāzī, p. 360
- *Kitāb Minhāj-ud-Dukkān bi-Dastūr-ul-Ā'yan fī A'māl wa Tarkīb-un-Nāfi'ah lil-Abdān*, by Aflāṭūn-i-Zamānah and Ra'īs-i-Awānah Abul-Minā ibn Abī Naṣr-il-'Aṭṭār al-Isrā'īlī al-Harūnī (i.e. Jewish), p. 86.
- *Kitāb Zubdat-uṭ-Ṭibb*, Sayyidul-Imām Abū Ibrāhīm Ismā'īl bin Ḥasan-ul-Ḥusainī al-Jurjānī, p. 182.
- *Ṭibb-i-Akbar*, Muḥammad Akbar Arzānī, p. 242.

- *Kitāb Mīzān-ut-Tibb*, Muḥammad Akbar Arzānī, p. 152.
- *Sadīdī*, by Ra'īs-ul-Mutakallimīn Imām-ul Muhaqqiqīn as-Sadīd-ul-Kādhūrīnī, vol. II, p. 283.
- *Kitāb Hāwī Kabīr*, Ibn Zakariyyā under Skin Diseases.
- *Qarābādīn*, Ibn Tilmīdh under Skin Diseases.
- *Qarābādīn*, Ibn Abī Ṣādiq under Skin Diseases.

These are those books that I have mentioned here by way of example. The learned, and especially physicians are not unaware of the fact that in an earlier age, most of these books were used as text books at important Islamic centres of learning where students from Europe also used to study them. And it is a fact, and there is not the slightest exaggeration about it, that in every century there have been tens of millions of people who have been acquainted with these books and hundreds of thousands have studied them intensively from end to end. We can assert with all the emphasis at our command, that not a single person from among the scholars of Europe and Asia has been ignorant of the names of at least some of the books listed above. When Hispania and Kasmonu and Satlirnem^{☆1} were seats of learning, Bu-Ali Sina's [Avicenna's] *Qānūn*, a great medical classic in which there is set out the prescription of Marham-i-Isa and other books like *Shifā* and *Ishārāt* and *Bisharāt*, on science, astronomy, and philosophy, were eagerly studied by the Europeans. Likewise, the original works of scholars like Abu Nasr Faaraa bi, Abu Raihaan, Israaeel, Thabit bin Qurrah and Hunain bin Is'haq, and Ishaq etc., and their translations of

1. ☆ *Hispania* i.e. Andalusia; *Kasmonu* i.e. Kastamonu; *Satrlirnem* i.e. Santarem. (Author)

Greek classics were also used as text books. Most certainly translations of their works are still extant in Europe today. As Muslim rulers were keen patrons of medicine, they got the most excellent Greek books translated and *Khilafat* [successorship] remained vested for a long time in kings who happened to desire the expansion of knowledge more than the territorial extension of their dominions, that was why they not only had Greek books translated into Arabic but also invited learned Pundits from India, and got them to translate medical and other books, rewarding them handsomely. One of the greatest debts that seekers of true knowledge owe to them, therefore, is that they got Latin and Greek medical classics translated into Arabic, which contained a mention of the 'Ointment of Jesus,' and which displays and records, almost as an epitaph, the fact that the ointment had been prepared for the treatment of the injuries of Jesus, may peace be on him. When the scholars of Islamic era, such as Thabit bin Qurrah and Hunain bin Is'haaq who, apart from medicine, other natural sciences, philosophy, etc., were also well versed in Greek, translated the *Qarābādīn* [Pharmacopoeia], which contains details about Marham-i-Isa, they were wise enough to retain the Greek term *Shalikha*,¹ which means 'twelve,' without translating it into Arabic, as a reminder that the book was a translation from Greek. That is why the term *Shalikha* still figures in almost all the books.

It is also worth noting that though old coins are very useful

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1. According to *Qānūn* of Avicenna (*Al-Qānūn fī at-Ṭibb*, by Abu Ali Ibn-e-Sina vol. 3 chapter 4 on ointments), the Ointment of Jesus has also been known as *Marham Dashlikha*, *Marhamul-Hawariyyin*, and *Marham-ur-Rusul*, and contains twelve ingredients corresponding to the twelve disciples. [Publisher]

in solving the great secrets of history, ancient books, which have been known to millions of people throughout the centuries, and have been taught as text books at important seats of learning and are still being used, are a thousand times more valuable than coins and inscriptions. For, in the case of coins and inscriptions, the possibility of fraud is always there. But the classics which, ever since their compilation, have been known to millions of people and have been preserved and guarded by all nations and are still being guarded, constitute a much more valuable piece of evidence than coins and inscriptions. Can anyone possibly name a coin or inscription which has attained such fame as the *Qānūn* of Bu-Ali Sina [Avicenna]? In short, the Ointment of Jesus [*Marham-i-Isa*—constitutes a testimony of the highest order for seekers after truth. If this testimony is to be rejected, then all historical proofs of the world would lose credibility. Although the number of such books containing a mention of *Marham-i-Isa* is about one thousand or perhaps a little more, and these books and their authors are known to tens of millions of people, anyone who does not accept this manifest, bright and forceful proof must be an enemy of all historical evidence. Can one ignore with impunity such a strong piece of evidence and can one doubt such incontrovertible testimony which has encompassed all Europe and Asia and which is the result of the combined testimony of famous Jewish, Christian, Magian and Muslim philosophers?

Now, therefore, O Erudite souls! Hasten to accept this great testimony. And O Possessors of Just Dispositions! Ponder a little on this matter. Is such a brilliant proof not worthy that it be pondered over? Is it proper for us not to seek light from this sun of truth?

The suggestion that Jesus, may peace be on him, might well have sustained some injuries before being commissioned as a Prophet or at some time later during his ministry, and not as the result of crucifixion, is nothing but an absurd and meaningless tale. It is simply absurd to say that his hands and feet might have been injured through some other cause, that he might have fallen from a roof, and the ointment might have been prepared for the treatment of the injuries he had thus suffered. It is absurd because before he was commissioned as a Prophet there were no disciples and the accounts of the ointment speak of disciples. The term *Shalikha*, which is Greek for twelve, is still there in these books even till today. Before being commissioned as a Prophet, moreover, Jesus, the Messiah, was not considered important enough for the events of his life to be recorded. His ministry lasted only three-and-a-half years, and during this time no historical record can be cited as proof of there having occurred any accident or injury, to Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, except for the trauma of the cross. And if someone thinks that perhaps such injuries could have been sustained by Jesus, may peace be on him, in some other way, then the onus of proof lies with him, for the event of the cross, to which we have referred, is a proved and established historical fact; neither the Jews nor the Christians deny it. The idea that Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, received his injuries through some other cause is also not supported by the annals of any nation. To entertain such an idea is, therefore, tantamount to deliberately abandon the path of truth. The evidence we have produced cannot be rejected on the basis of such meaningless objections.

These manuscripts are in existence even today and for my part,

I too possess an antique hand-written manuscript of *Qānūn* by Bu-Ali Sina belonging to that age. Therefore, it would be highly unfair, indeed it would amount to an outright slaughter of the truth to throw away so brilliant a proof. Think over this again and again, and ponder deeply, why are these books still present in the age old libraries of the Jews, the Magians, the Christians, Arabs, Persians, Greeks, Romans, Germans and the French and other European and Asian countries. And is it proper to just turn away from a proof, whose lustre dazzles denial? If these books had been compiled only by Muslims, and if they had been in the hands of the followers of Islam alone, there might have been those who could have jumped to the conclusion that Muslims had forged these facts and recorded them in their books with a view to attacking the Christian creed. But, in addition to the reasons which I shall give shortly, this impression is baseless, because the Muslims could never be guilty of a forgery of this kind; for, like Christians, Muslims also believe that after the crucifixion, Jesus, the Messiah, ascended to heaven right away. Indeed, Muslims do not even believe that Jesus, may peace be on him, was ever put on the cross or that he received any injuries as a result of crucifixion. How then could they knowingly forge a statement contradicting their own belief? Apart from this, Islam was not even in existence at the time when these books on medicine, in Latin and Greek, were compiled and made current among tens of millions of people. These books contained the prescription of the 'Ointment of Jesus' as well as the explanation that this ointment was prepared for Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, by his disciples. In the context of religion, those people—Jews, Christians, Muslims and Magians—were all enemies, to one another. Therefore, the fact

that they have mentioned this ointment in their books, regardless of their respective beliefs, proves beyond any doubt that the preparation of the ointment was too well known a fact to be denied by any community or nation. True, not until the time came, that was the appointed time for the coming of the Promised Messiah, up till that time it did not occur to any of these people to make use of the historical importance of this ointment which was recorded in hundreds of books and was known to tens of millions of people of different nationalities. We have nothing to say here except to acknowledge that God willed it so, and it had been predestined by Him, that this sharp and shining weapon and this crucial and decisive evidence which was meant to destroy the creed of the cross would come to light at the hands of the Promised Messiah. The Holy Prophet^{sas} had prophesied that the faith of the cross shall neither decline nor shall its progress slow down until the Promised Messiah would appear in the world. It was at his hands that the 'breaking of the cross' was to be brought about. The point which was meant to be underlined by this prophecy was that in the time of the Promised Messiah, God would create conditions which would lay bare the truth about the crucifixion. The creed of the cross would come to an end and complete its life span, not through war or violence, but exclusively through heavenly causes, that would manifest themselves in the world in the form of scientific discernment and reason. This indeed is the meaning of the hadith reported in *Sahih Bukhari* and other books. It was essential, therefore, that heaven should not have allowed to become manifest these incontrovertible proofs and conclusive evidence until the coming of the Promised Messiah. And this is what came to pass. And as of now, with the appearance of the Promised One,

the eyes of everyone shall open and thinking people shall begin to ponder, for the Messiah of God has come; it is now incumbent that minds become illumined; hearts begin to respond; pens come alive; and the people gird up their loins. And now every fortunate one shall be given insight; and every rightly guided person shall be granted wisdom, for, whatever shines in heaven must of necessity illuminate the earth. Blessed is he who partakes of a portion from this light. And how fortunate indeed is the person who gains something from this heavenly light. As can be observed, fruit ripens at its appointed time, similarly, heavenly light also descends at its appointed time. None can make it descend before it comes down of its own accord; nor can anyone stop it from descending when it does descend. It is of course necessary that there be controversy and conflict but truth will prevail in the end, for this is not the work of man; nor has the son of man the power to do it; it is indeed from God who causes the seasons to change, alternates the days of prosperity and misfortune, and converts night into day and day into night. He brings about darkness but desires light. He even lets polytheistic beliefs [*shirk*] to spread, but His love is reserved for His Oneness [*Tauhid*]. He does not desire that His Glory be accorded to anyone else. From the time of creation of man, and until he disappears from the world, the divine law of nature has indeed been that He always supports His *Tauhid* or Oneness. All the prophets sent by Him came only so that by eradicating the worship of man, and of other creatures, they may establish the worship of God in the world. Their duty was to make the essence of لا إله إلا الله [‘There is no one worthy of worship except Allah’] shine in the earth as it shines in heaven. The greatest of them, therefore, is he who highlighted this formula with

the greatest brilliance; who first exposed the impotence of false gods and proved their insignificance on grounds of knowledge and power, and then, when he had proved everything, he left as a symbol of his decisive victory the testament لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ مُحَمَّدٌ رَّسُولُ اللَّهِ [‘There is no one worthy of worship except Allah; Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah’]. He did not pronounce لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ as an unproven assertion. No, he first proved it, and exposed the errors of false belief and then drawing the attention of the people said, ‘Look, there is no God besides Him who has demolished all your might and shattered all your arrogance.’ Thus it was that to serve as a reminder for ever, of this established truth, he taught this blessed *Kalimah*—or credo: لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ مُحَمَّدٌ رَّسُولُ اللَّهِ.

CHAPTER FOUR

Evidence found in Historical Records

Since this chapter contains different kinds of evidence, I have, for the sake of clarity, divided it into various sections, as follows:

Section One

Evidence from Islamic Literature that Establishes the Extensive Journeys of Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him



On page 130–135 of *Rauzatüŝ-Şafâ*, a well-known book of history in the Persian language, we find an account which, briefly translated, reads as follows:

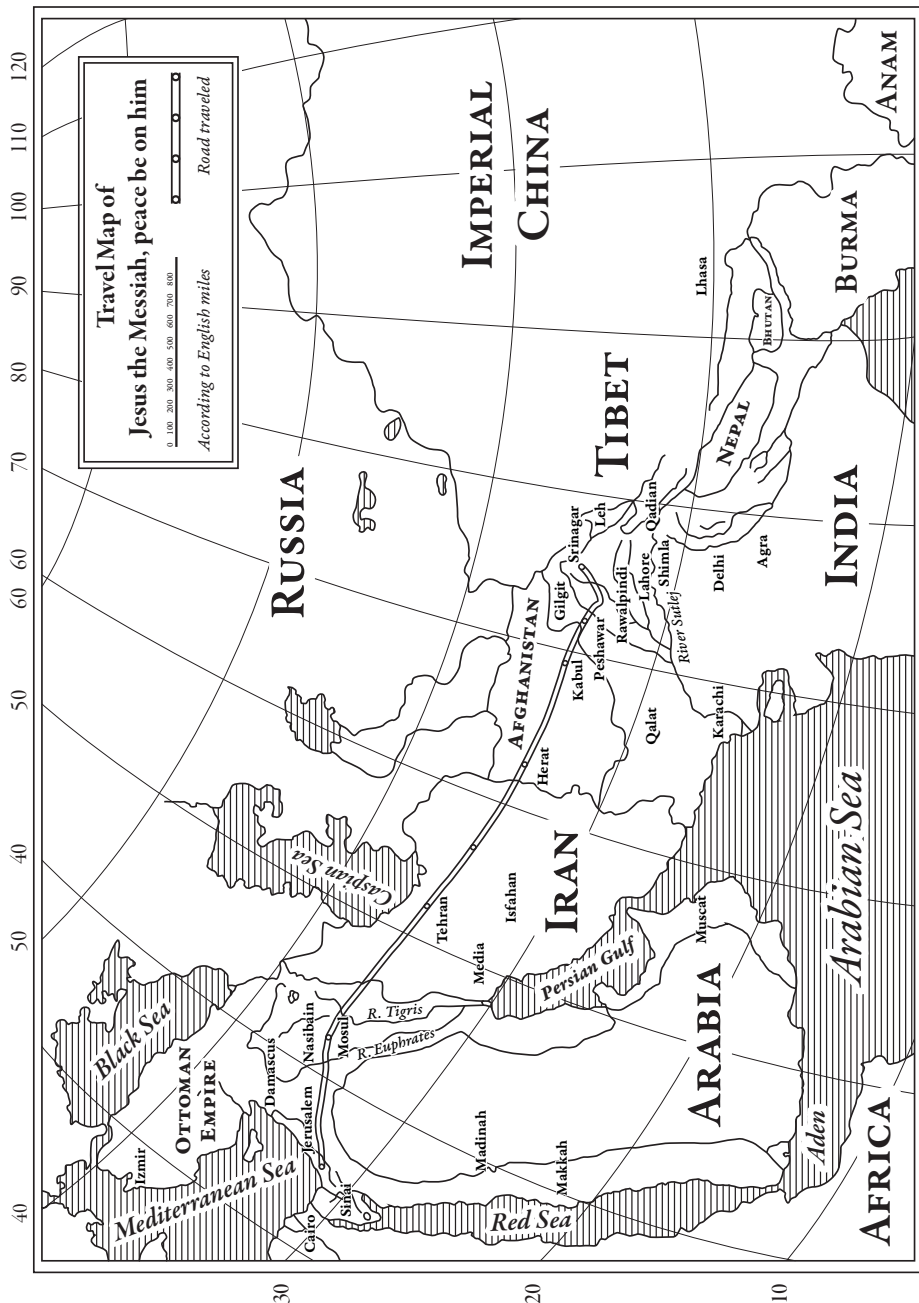
Jesus, may peace be on him, was named the Messiah because he was a great traveller. He wore a woollen scarf over his

head, and a woollen cloak on his person. Carrying a staff in his hand, he used to wander from country to country and city to city. He slept wherever the night found him. He ate vegetables of the jungle and drank the water of the jungle, and travelled on foot. Once, his companions, in one of his travels, bought a horse for him; he rode the horse for one day, but as he could not make any provision for feeding it, he returned it. Journeying from his country, he arrived at Nasibain, which lay at a distance of several hundred *koses* from his home. He was accompanied by a few of his disciples whom he sent into the city to preach. In this city, however, false and unfounded rumours were current about Jesus, may peace be on him, and his mother. The governor of the city, therefore, arrested the disciples and summoned Jesus, may peace be on him. He miraculously healed some people who were sick and showed many other miracles. As a result, the king of the territory of Nasibain, with all his armies and his people, became his follower. The incident about the 'coming down of food' mentioned in the Holy Quran also took place during his travels.

This, in brief, is the report given in *Rauzatus-Safā*. The author of the book, however, has also ascribed many an absurd and irrational miracle to Jesus, may peace be on him, which I regret to leave aside, and keeping my account free from falsehood and senseless exaggerations, I turn to the real point at issue which leads to the conclusion that Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, in the

course of his travels, had arrived at Nasibain. Nasibain is a place between Mosul and Syria which, in English maps, has been shown as Nasibus. If one travels from Syria towards Persia, one would pass through Nasibain, and it is at a distance of nearly 450 koses¹ from Jerusalem. Mosul is nearly 48 miles from Nasibain and 500 miles from Jerusalem. The frontier of Persia lies at a distance of a mere 100 miles from Mosul. This means that Nasibain is 150 miles from the frontier of Persia. The eastern frontier of Persia touches the town of Herat in Afghanistan. Herat lies on the western frontier of Afghanistan in the direction of the Persian territory and is about 900 miles from the western boundary of Persia. From Herat up to the Khyber Pass, the distance measures about 500 miles. See the following map.

1. This is a misprint in the first edition. It should be 450 miles not *koses*.
[Publisher]



This is a map of those countries and towns through which Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, passed on his way to Kashmir. His purpose for undertaking this travelling and journeying was so that first, he could meet those Israelites whom King Shalmaneser, had taken as captives to Media.^{☆1}

It should be noted that in the maps published by the Christians, Media is shown towards the south of the Sea of Khizar [Azov], where today we find Persia. This means that Media was at the very least a part of the land which today is called Persia. And the eastern frontier of Persia is adjacent to Afghanistan; and to its south is the sea, and to its west is the Turkish Empire. In any case, if the report in the *Rauzat-Ṣafā* is relied upon, it appears that, by travelling to Nasibain, Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, intended to go to Afghanistan through Persia, and to invite to the Truth the lost tribes of Jews who had come to be known as Afghans.^{☆2} The word 'Afghan' appears to be of Hebrew origin; it

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1. ☆ **Note:** There is a letter in the 14th section of the first chapter of the history in Greek of the 'Creed of Eusebeus,' translated by a Londoner, Heinmer by name, in 1650 A.D., which shows that a King, Abgerus by name, invited Jesus, from the land beyond the Euphrates, to his court. The letter sent by Abgerus to Jesus, and the reply to it, are full of fabrications and exaggerations. This much, however, seems to be true, that the King having been apprised of the cruelties of the Jews invited Jesus to his court to give him refuge. The King thought that he was a true Prophet. (Author)
 2. ☆ In the Torah there was a promise to the Children of Israel, that if they believed in the last prophet, they would, in the latter days, after passing through much suffering, have their own sovereign kings and rulers. That promise was fulfilled by the ten tribes of Israel adopting Islam. That is why there have been great kings among Afghans as well as among Kashmiris. (Author)

is a derivative which means 'brave.' It appears that at the height of their victories, they adopted this name for themselves.

In short, Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, came to the Punjab after passing through Afghanistan, with the ultimate intention of going to Kashmir after exploring the Punjab and Hindustan. It should be noted that Chitral and a strip of the Punjab separate Kashmir from Afghanistan. If one travels from Afghanistan to Kashmir, through the Punjab, one has to journey over a distance of eighty *koses* or about 130 miles, and via Chitral it would be a hundred *koses*.¹

Jesus, the Messiah, however, wisely took the route through Afghanistan, so that the lost tribes of Israel, known as Afghans, might profit from his presence. The eastern frontier of Kashmir touches Tibet, so after coming to Kashmir, he could easily go into Tibet. Having come to the Punjab, he had no difficulty in wandering through the important places of Hindustan before going to Kashmir and Tibet. It is, therefore, quite possible, as some old historical records of this country bear out, that Jesus, the Messiah, may have been to Nepal, Benares, and other places. He then must have gone to Kashmir through Jammu or Rawalpindi. As he belonged to a cold country, it is certain that he stayed in these parts only through the winter, and, by the end of March or the beginning of April, must have set out for Kashmir. As Kashmir resembles Shaam,² he must have taken up permanent residence in this land. It is also possible that he may have stayed for some time in Afghanistan and it is not improbable that he may even have married there. Since one of the tribes of Afghans is known as Isa

1. 163 miles approximately. [Publisher]

2. Syria and its neighbouring areas. [Publisher]

Khel,¹ it would not be surprising if they were descendants of Jesus. It is to be regretted, however, that the history of Afghanistan is in a confused state. It is, therefore, difficult to arrive at anything definite by studying their tribal chronicles. There is no doubt, however, that the Afghans are Israelites, like the Kashmiris. Those who have taken a contrary view in their writings have been misled in the extreme; they do not seem to have studied the matter closely. The Afghans admit that they are the descendants of Qais and that Qais belongs to the house of Israel. It is, however, not necessary to elaborate the point here. I have already dealt with this question at length in one of my books. Here, I am describing the journey of Jesus, the Messiah, through Nasibain, Afghanistan, the Punjab and on to Kashmir and Tibet. It was on account of this long journey that he was named 'the travelling prophet,' or even 'the Chief of Travellers.' A Muslim savant, Arif Billah Abi Bakr Muhammad bin Muhammad Ibn-ul-Walid Al-Fahri Al-Tar-tooshi Al-Maaliki, who is renowned for his learning, states about Jesus, the Messiah, on page 6 of his book *Sirājul-Mulūk*, published by the Khairiyah Press of Egypt in 1306 A.H.:

أَيْنَ عِيسَى رُوحُ اللَّهِ وَكَلِمَتُهُ رَأْسُ الزَّاهِدِينَ وَإِمَامُ السَّائِحِينَ

Meaning, 'Where is Isa [Messiah], the *Rūḥullāh*, and the *Kalimatullāh*,² who was the Leader of the Righteous, and Chief of Travellers?'

This means that he had died, and that even a great man like

1. After the name of Jesus (Isa). [Publisher]

2. See Glossary for a detailed explanation by the Promised Messiah^{as} of the terms *Rūḥullāh* [the Spirit of Allah] and *Kalimatullāh* [the Word of Allah']. [Publisher]

him had departed from this world. It should be noted that this learned authority calls Jesus, the Messiah, not merely 'a traveller' but 'the chief of travellers'.

Likewise, on page 431 of *Lisānul-'Arab* it is stated:

قِيلَ سُمِّيَ عِيسَى بِمَسِيحٍ لِأَنَّهُ كَانَ سَائِحًا فِي الْأَرْضِ لَا يَسْتَقِرُّ

Meaning that, Jesus was named 'Messiah,' because he continually travelled about, and did not stay at one place.

The same is recorded in *Tājul-'Arūs Sharah Qāmus*. Therein it is also stated that a 'messiah' is one who is annointed with goodness and blessings, that is to say his very nature is endowed goodness and blessings, so much so that even his touch causes goodness and blessings to come into being. And that this name was given to Jesus, and Allah, the Exalted, gives it to whomsoever He pleases. And opposed to him is that other 'messiah' who has been touched with evil and accursedness, that is to say his nature is innately evil and accursed so much so that his mere touch results in evil, accursedness, and waywardness. This name, Messiah, was therefore given to *Masih-e-Dajjal* [the Antichrist] and to all those who are like him.

And the two names, Messiah the Traveller and Messiah the Blessed, are not antagonistic to each other. The first meaning does not invalidate the second. For, it is also the practice of God Almighty to bestow a name upon someone and mean many things by it, all of which hold true concerning that person. In short, Jesus, may peace be on him, being a traveller is so well established by Islamic history that if all the references were copied from

those books, I think they would run into a huge tome. What I have stated, therefore, should suffice.

Section Two

Evidence from Buddhist History Records

Let it be clear that Buddhist Scriptures have made available to us various kinds of evidence, which, when taken as a whole, show conclusively and certainly that Jesus, may peace be on him, must have visited the Punjab, Kashmir, and other places. I shall set down this evidence herein below, so that all impartial readers may first study it, and then, by arranging it as a connected account in their minds, arrive at the aforesaid conclusion on their own. Here is the evidence.

First: the titles given to the Buddha are similar to the titles given to Jesus, the Messiah. Likewise, the events of the life of Buddha resemble those of the life of Jesus, the Messiah. The reference here, however, is to the Buddhism of the areas within the boundaries of Tibet, like Leh, Lhasa, Gilgit and Hams, about which it is proved that they were places that had been visited by Jesus, the Messiah. With reference to the similarity of titles, it is enough to point out, that if, for example, Jesus, may peace be on him, calls himself the Light in his teachings, so has Gautama been called the Buddha in the Buddhist literature which in Sanskrit means 'Light.' And Jesus, may peace be on him, has also been called the Teacher in the Gospels, so has the Buddha been called Saasta or the Teacher. Similarly, Jesus, the Messiah, has been called Blessed

in the Gospels, so has the Buddha been named Sugt—meaning, the Blessed. Similarly, Jesus, the Messiah, has been called Prince, so has the Buddha been called Prince. And Jesus, the Messiah, has also been described in the Gospels as one who fulfils the object of his coming, so has the Buddha been called in Buddhist Scriptures Siddhartha—one who fulfils the object of his coming. And Jesus, the Messiah, has also been called by the Gospels the refuge of the tired and the weary, so has the Buddha in Buddhist Scriptures been called *Asarn Sarn*—meaning, the one who gives refuge to those without refuge. And Jesus, the Messiah, has also been called King in the Gospels, though he said that his was the kingdom of Heaven, so also has the Buddha been called the King.

The proof of similarity of events is that just as it is written in the Gospels that Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, was tempted by the devil and the devil said to him that if you will fall down and worship me all the riches and kingdoms of the world will become yours, so was Buddha tempted when the Devil said to him that he would give him the pomp and splendour of kings if he abandoned the austerity of his living and returned home. But, just as Jesus, the Messiah, did not obey the Devil, so, it is written, the Buddha too did not obey him.¹ See Buddhism by T. W. Rhys Davids and Buddhism by Sir Monier Williams.^{☆2}

This shows that the same titles which Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, ascribes to himself in the Gospels, have been ascribed to the Buddha in Buddhist Scriptures which were

1. See Appendix, extracts 1,2,3,4,5 [Publisher]

2. ☆ See also *Chinese Buddhism*, by Edkins, *Buddha* by Oldenberg translated by W. Hoey; *Life of Buddha* translated by Rockhill. (Author)

compiled much later; and just as Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, was tempted by the Devil, so do these books claim that the Buddha was also tempted by the Devil; rather, the account of the temptation of the Buddha, as stated in these books, is even greater. It is recorded that when the Devil offered him the temptation of wealth and kingly honour, the Buddha felt inclined to return home. He, nevertheless, did not succumb to the temptation. But the same Devil met him again one night, bringing with him all his progeny, and tried to frighten him by assuming frightfully grotesque shapes. To the Buddha, these Devils appeared like snakes which were emitting fire from their mouths. The snakes began to throw poison and fire at him but the poison turned into flowers and the fire would form a halo around the Buddha.

The Devil, not having succeeded in this way, called upon sixteen of his daughters, and asked them to reveal their beauty to the Buddha who remained totally unmoved; and the Devil was baulked in his designs. He adopted a variety of other means, but was helpless against the steadfastness of the Buddha, who continued to rise higher and higher to different stages of spiritual eminence, and, after a long night, that is, after severe and protracted trials, he overcame his enemy, the Devil. The Light of True Knowledge dawned upon him and, with the break of day, as soon as his trials were over, he came to know all. The day this great battle ended was the day of the birth of Buddhism. Gautama was thirty-five years old at the time when he was called the Buddha¹ or the Light, and the Tree under which he was sitting at the time came to be known as the Tree of Light. Now, if you read the Gospels, you

1. See Appendix, extract 2 [Publisher]

will find how closely the temptation of the Buddha resembles the temptation of Jesus, the Messiah, to the extent that the Buddha's age at the time was nearly the same as that of Jesus, the Messiah. As it appears from Buddhist literature, the Devil did not appear to the Buddha in a corporeal and personified form. It was only a vision seen by the Buddha alone and the talk of the Devil was a satanic inspiration. The Devil, as he appeared to him, suggested to the Buddha that he should abandon his course and follow him and that if he did so, he would give him all the wealth of the world. Likewise, Christian scholars believe that the Devil who appeared to Jesus, may peace be on him, did not come to him in any corporeal form, like a human being, before the very eyes of the Jews, traversing the streets in his physical body and talking to Jesus, the Messiah, so as to be audible to those present. On the contrary, this meeting was also of the nature of a vision seen only by Jesus, the Messiah. The talk too was a kind of inspiration. That is to say, as is the Devil's old wont, he put his evil intentions into the heart of Jesus, the Messiah, which the heart of Jesus, the Messiah, did not accept, and, like the Buddha, rejected all the Devil's temptations.

The question now arises as to why there was so much resemblance between the Buddha and Jesus, the Messiah. The Aryas in this connection say that Jesus, the Messiah, God forbid, became acquainted with Buddhism in the course of his journeys in India, and having acquired knowledge of the facts of Buddha's life, incorporated them in the Gospel on return to his native country; that Jesus, the Messiah, composed his moral precepts by plagiarizing the moral teaching of the Buddha, and that just as the Buddha called himself the Light and Knowledge and adopted other titles, so did Jesus, the Messiah, assume all such titles, so much so, that,

even the long story of the Temptation of the Buddha was appropriated by him. This, however, is an error on the part of the Aryas and their dishonesty. It is quite untrue that Jesus, the Messiah, came to India before the event of the cross, and indeed no need had arisen to undertake such a journey at that time. The need for it arose only after the Jews of Judea had rejected Jesus, the Messiah, and in their own thinking, had crucified him. Jesus, the Messiah, had, however, been saved by a subtle divine intervention. It was then that he felt he had done his duty in conveying the message to the Jews of that country, and that they did not deserve further compassion; their hearts having become so hardened due to their evil actions that they were no longer deemed worthy of accepting the truth. Then, on being informed by God Almighty that the ten tribes of the Jews had migrated towards India, Jesus, the Messiah, set out for those regions. As some of the Jews had accepted Buddhism, there was no alternative for this true prophet but to turn his attention to the followers of Buddhism. As the Buddhist priests of that country were waiting for the 'Messiah Buddha' to appear, they hailed Jesus, the Messiah, as the Buddha considering all the signs like his titles, his moral teachings like 'love thine enemy,' and 'do not resist evil,' and the Buddha's prophecy about fair skin. It is also possible that some of the titles and teachings and facts of the life of Jesus, the Messiah, may, consciously or unconsciously, have at that time been ascribed to the Buddha; for the early Indians never had any scruples about recording history objectively. And the events of Buddha's life had not been recorded till the time of Jesus, the Messiah. Buddhist priests, therefore, had ample room to ascribe to the Buddha anything they wished. It is quite likely, therefore, that when they came to know of the facts of

the life of Jesus, the Messiah, and his moral teaching, they mixed them up with many of their own innovations and ascribed them to the Buddha. ☆¹ Presently I shall prove that the part of the moral teaching of Buddhism which resembles that of the Gospels, and these titles like 'Light,' etc. which are attributed to the Buddha as they are to Jesus, the Messiah, and the Satanic temptations, are all details which were incorporated into the Buddhist literature only after Jesus, the Messiah, came to this country after the dispersion caused by the events of the crucifixion.

And then there is yet another resemblance between the Buddha and Jesus, the Messiah. Buddhist chronicles show that the Buddha during the temptation was fasting and that he kept forty fasts. Readers of the Gospels know that Jesus, the Messiah, also observed forty fasts.

And as I have just mentioned, there is so much similarity between the moral teachings of Buddha and Jesus, the Messiah, that everyone who is acquainted with both the teachings will be amazed. For example, it is written in the Gospels that, do not resist evil, and love your enemies, and live in poverty, and shun pride, falsehood and greed; and this exactly is the teaching of the Buddha. Rather the Buddhist teaching lays greater stress and emphasis on it, so much so that the killing even of ants and insects has been considered a sin. The great teaching put forth by

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1. ☆ **Note:** We cannot deny that the Buddhist faith, from ancient times, has contained a large portion of moral teaching; but at the same time we maintain that that part which is exactly the teaching of the Gospels—the parables and other reproductions from the Bible—was undoubtedly added to the Buddhist books at the time that Jesus, the Messiah, arrived in this country. (Author)

the Buddha is to show sympathy and compassion to the whole world, and seek the welfare of the whole of humanity and of all the animals, and develop mutual unity and love. The very same is the teaching of the Gospels. And again, just as Jesus, the Messiah sent his disciples to different countries, journeying to one himself, so are these things found in the biographies of the Buddha. Thus, in *Buddhism* by Sir Monier Williams¹ it is written that the Buddha sent his disciples out into the world to preach, addressing them thus: 'Go forth and wander everywhere, out of compassion for the world and for the welfare of gods and men. Go forth, one by one, in different directions. Proclaim a life of perfect restraint, chastity, and celibacy.' And he said that, 'I will go also to preach this doctrine.' Accordingly, the Buddha went to Benares and worked a number of miracles in that area. He delivered an impressive sermon on a hill just as Jesus, the Messiah, had delivered his sermon on the mount. And then in this same book it is written that the Buddha preached mostly in parables; and he used to explain spiritual phenomena in material terms.

Now it should be pondered that this moral teaching and this mode of preaching—that is to say, stating things in parables—was the method of Jesus, may peace be on him. When we look at the other circumstantial evidence, and consider this mode of preaching and this moral teaching, it immediately comes to mind that all this is a copy of the teachings of Jesus, the Messiah. Given that he came to India and he preached extensively; during those days, the followers of the Buddhist faith met him, and finding him to be a holy and blessed man, they recorded these things in their

1. *See Appendix, extract 2.* [Publisher]

books and in fact declared him to be the Buddha, for it is part of human nature to try to acquire a good thing wherever one can find it. People try to record and remember any excellent remark made by anyone they meet. It is, therefore, quite likely that the followers of the Buddhist Faith have reproduced the entire picture of the Gospels in their books, so much so that, for example, as Jesus, the Messiah, kept forty fasts so did the Buddha; and as Jesus, the Messiah, was tried by Satan so too was Buddha tested in the same way. And just as Jesus, the Messiah, was without father so was Buddha also; and just as Jesus, the Messiah, laid forth moral teachings, the same was done by Buddha too. And just as Jesus, the Messiah, said that I am the Light, so did the Buddha say exactly the same. And just as Jesus, the Messiah, called himself the Teacher, and his companions disciples, so did the Buddha. And just as Matthew, chapter 10, verses 8 and 9, state: 'Provide neither gold, nor silver, nor brass in your purses,' so did the Buddha command his disciples¹. Just as the Gospels encourage celibacy, so does the teaching of the Buddha. Just as there was an earthquake after Jesus, the Messiah, was put on the cross, so it is recorded, there was an earthquake after the death of the Buddha.^{☆2} All these points of resemblance arise from the basic fact of the visit of Jesus, the Messiah, to India. It was indeed a blessing for the followers of the Buddhist faith that he stayed among them for quite some time and they came to have a good knowledge of the facts of his life

1. See Appendix, extract 2. [Publisher]

2. ☆ Buddhists also have a tradition similar to the Lord's Supper of the Christians.* (Author)

*See Appendix, extract 1,2,3,4. [Publisher]

and of his noble teachings. It was, therefore, inevitable that a great part of his teachings and ceremonial rites should find way into Buddhist records and practice because Jesus, the Messiah, was held in great esteem by the Buddhists who had even pronounced him to be the Buddha. That is why they recorded his sayings in their books and ascribed them to Gautama Buddha.

It is a most amazing event to see the Buddha make his disciples understand, in exactly the same way as Jesus, the Messiah, in parables, especially those parables that are contained in the Gospels. In one of these parables the Buddha says:

As the peasant sows the seed but cannot say the grain shall swell today or germinate tomorrow, so also is it with the disciple. That is to say, he can not express any opinion as to whether he will grow and develop well or will be like the grain which is sown in rocky soil and dries up.

Look, this is exactly that same parable which is still there, up till now, in the Gospels. Then again, the Buddha, gives another example that, 'When a herd of deer prospers in a forest, a man comes who deceptively opens for them that path which would lead to their death, that is to say he tries to lead them to a path which will ultimately ensnare them and bring them to their death. And another man comes who opens a safe path to them, that is to say he sows a field so they may eat therefrom, and he brings to them a canal so that they may drink therefrom and thrive; such is the case with men who live in prosperity, the devil comes and opens the eightfold path of evil, so that they may perish. Then comes the

Perfect Man and opens the eightfold path of truth, certainty, and peace, so that they may be saved.'

The Buddha also taught that righteousness is that safe treasure which no one can steal. It is such a treasure as accompanies man even after death; it is such a treasure from the capital of which all Knowledge and all Excellence develops.

Now look, this is exactly the teaching of the Gospels. And these are found in the ancient Buddhist books which belong to the period which is not much different from the time of Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him; in fact it is the very same period. Again, on page 135 of this same book, Buddha is reported to have said that he is so irreproachable that no one can point out a single blot on his character.¹ This too has a close resemblance to a saying of Jesus, the Messiah. In the book Buddhism, on page 45, it is written:

The moral teaching of the Buddha has a striking resemblance with the Christian moral teaching.

I agree with this, and I also agree that both teachings tell us: Do not love the world; do not love wealth; do not commit enmity against your enemies; do not commit evil and unholy deeds; prevail against evil through virtue; treat others in the manner that you wish to be treated by them. This is such striking resemblance between the teachings of the Gospels and the teaching of the Buddha that it is unnecessary to go into any more detail.

Books of the Buddhist faith also show that Gautama Buddha

1. See Appendix, extract 2. [Publisher]

prophesied the coming of one more Buddha who was to come who would be named *Metteyya*. This prophecy is contained in *Laggavatti Suttanta*,¹ a Buddhist record to which reference is made on page 142 of Oldenberg's book. The prophecy reads thus:

He will be the leader of a band of disciples numbering hundreds of thousands, as I am now the leader of bands of disciples, numbering hundreds.²

Here it is worth remembering that the Hebrew word, *Mashiha*, is spoken in the Pali language as, *Metteyya*. It is a matter of common knowledge that when a word is transferred from one language to another, it very often undergoes a phonetic change. An English word, too, when imported into another language, undergoes change: for example, Max Muller, in a list given on page 318 of Volume 11 of *Sacred Books of the East*, says: the *th* of the English alphabet becomes *s* in Persian or Arabic. Keeping these changes in view, one can readily understand that the word Messiah became *Metteyya* in the Pali language, which means that the future *Metteyya* prophesied by the Buddha is in reality the Messiah and no one else. This view is supported by the strong evidence of Buddha's own prophecy that the Faith he had founded would not endure in the world for more than five hundred years; that at the time of the decline of the faith and its teachings, the *Metteyya* would come to this land and re-establish these moral teachings in the world. Now we find that Jesus, the Messiah, appeared five hundred years after the Buddha, and that just as the Buddha had fixed the time

1. According to Oldenberg it is spelled Cakka-vatti Suttanta. See Appendix, extract 5. [Publisher]

2. See Appendix, extract 5. [Publisher]

frame for the decline of his Faith, Buddhism did indeed deteriorate into a state of decadence as foretold. It was then that, having escaped from the cross, Jesus, the Messiah, travelled to those parts, where the Buddhists recognised him readily and treated him with great reverence. And there is no doubt whatsoever that the moral teaching and spiritual exercises that had been established by the Buddha, were given a new life in the world through the teachings of Jesus, the Messiah. Christian historians admit that the Sermon on the Mount as reported in the Gospels and the rest of his moral teachings are the same as those preached to the world by the Buddha five hundred years before. They also state that the Buddha not only taught moral precepts, he also taught other very great truths. In their view, the title of 'the Light of Asia' applied to the Buddha is highly appropriate. Now, in accordance with the prophecy of the Buddha, Jesus, the Messiah, appeared five hundred years after him, and as admitted by most Christian scholars, his teaching was exactly the same as the teaching of the Buddha. There is no doubt, therefore, that he appeared in the 'colours' of the Buddha. In Oldenberg's book, on the authority of *Lakkavatti Suttatta*,¹ it is stated that the followers of the Buddha, looking forward to his future coming, were sustained by the hope that as disciples of the *Metteyya*, they would have the bliss of salvation. They were certain that the *Metteyya* would come and that they would attain salvation through him, for, the words in which the Buddha had held out the hope for the coming of the *Metteyya* positively showed that his disciples would meet and acknowledge

1. According to Oldenberg it is spelled Cakka-vatti Suttanta. See Appendix, extract 5. [Publisher]

him. The statement of the above-mentioned book further reinforces the conviction that for the guidance of those people God had created two appropriate circumstances: Firstly, by virtue of the title *Asif*, mentioned in Genesis 3:10,¹ which means 'one who gathers together a people', it was inevitable that Jesus, the Messiah, should visit the land to which the Jews had migrated and settled; secondly, in accordance with the prophecy of the Buddha, it was necessary that the followers of the Buddha should meet him and profit from him spiritually. Considering both these points together, it looks almost certain that Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, must have visited Tibet. The fact that Christian teaching and ritual have so deeply influenced Tibetan Buddhism necessitates the belief that Jesus, the Messiah, must have met the Tibetan people also. Moreover, the fact that the zealous followers of Buddhism, as stated in Buddhist records, had always eagerly expected to meet him, cries out aloud that this desire on their part had become the prelude to the visit of Jesus, the Messiah, to this country. In the face of both these facts, an impartial person has no need to search through Buddhist records to discover for himself the statement that Jesus, the Messiah, did in fact come to Tibet. For, in accordance with the prophecy of the Buddha, the desire for the Buddha's second advent being so strong, the prophecy itself must have attracted Jesus, the Messiah, to Tibet. And it must be remembered that the word *Metteyya* which is so frequently mentioned in Buddhist books, undoubtedly means 'Messiah.' On page 14 of the book, Tibet, Tartary, Mongolia, by H. T. Prinsep, it

1. The sense of the quotation is correct but it seems there is a misprint in the first edition. Please read 49:10 instead of 3:10. [Publisher]

is stated concerning *Metteya* Buddha, which in reality is Messiah, that the first Christian missionaries, having heard and seen at first hand conditions obtaining in Tibet, came to the conclusion that in the ancient books of the Lamas there were to be found traces of the Christian religion. Again, on the same page, it is stated that there is no doubt that these ancient authorities believed that the disciples of Jesus, the Messiah, were still alive when the Christian teaching reached this place. On page 171 it is stated that there is not the slightest doubt that at that time everybody was eagerly waiting for the great Saviour to appear. Tacitus says that it was not only the Jews who were responsible for this belief, but Buddhism itself had laid the foundation for it, i.e., it prophesied the coming of the *Metteya* in this country. Furthermore, the author of this English work says in a note: The books *Pitakattayan* and *Attha-Katha* contain the clear prophecy concerning the appearance of yet another Buddha, whose advent would take place a thousand years after the time of Gautama or *Sakhiya Muni*. Gautama himself states, that I am the 25th Buddha and *Bagwa Metteyya* is yet to come, that is to say, after me, in this country, will come one whose name will be *Metteyya* and he will be fair-skinned. The English author goes on to say that the word *Metteyya* has a striking resemblance to Messiah.¹ In short, Gautama Buddha clearly states in this prophecy that a Messiah was going to come in his country, among his people and among those who believe in him. This was indeed the reason why the followers of Buddhism had all the time been waiting for the Messiah to appear in their country. And the Buddha, in his prophecy, concerning the Buddha who

1. See Appendix, extract 6 [Publisher]

was to come had named him *Bagwa Metteyya* because *Bagwa* in Sanskrit means ‘white,’ and Jesus, the Messiah, being an inhabitant of the Syrian territory, was, ‘bagwa’ i.e. fair-skinned. The people of the land where this prophecy was announced, i.e., the country of Magadh, in which was located Rajagriha, were dark-skinned. Gautama Buddha himself was dark skinned. Thus, Buddha had narrated to his followers two conclusive signs regarding the Buddha who was to come.

One was that he would be *Bagwa* or fair skinned. And second that he would be *Metteyya*, that is to say, he would be a traveller, and that he would come from a foreign land. People, therefore, constantly looked out for these signs till they actually saw Jesus, the Messiah. Every Buddhist must necessarily profess the belief that five hundred years after the Buddha, the *Bagwa Metteyya* did, in fact, appear in their land.^{☆1} It should not be surprising, therefore, if, in support of this belief, books of the Buddhist faith should mention the coming of the *Metteyya*—the *Masiha*—to their land, and of the fulfilment of Buddha’s prophecy. And even if it were supposed that there is no such mention, even then, because on the basis of divine revelation, the Buddha had communicated to his disciples the tidings that the *Bagwa Metteyya* would come to their land, no Buddhist who was cognizant of this prophecy could deny the coming to this land of the *Bagwa Metteyya*, whose other name was *Masiha*; because the non-fulfilment of the prophecy would mean the falsity of the faith itself. If such a prophecy, for whose fulfilment a time frame had also been fixed, and which Gautama Buddha had communicated to his disciples again and

1. ☆ The period of a thousand or five thousand years is incorrect. (Author)

again, had not been fulfilled at its appointed time, the followers of Buddha would have begun to doubt the truth of Gautama and it would have been written down in the books that this prophecy had not been fulfilled.

Another argument in support of the fulfilment of this prophecy is that books belonging to the seventh century of the Christian era have been discovered in Tibet, in which the word *Mashih* is present, that is to say the name of Jesus, may peace be on him, is written as *Mi-Shi-Hu*. The compiler of the list which contained the word *Mi-Shi-Hu* is a Buddhist. Vide, 'A Record of the Buddhist Religion' by I. Tsing, translated by G. Takakusu. G. Takakusu is a Japanese who has translated I. Tsing's book, and I. Tsing is a Chinese traveller. On the margin and in the appendix to the book, Takakusu states that an ancient book contains the name *Mi-Shi-Hu*¹ (*Masih*) and this book belongs approximately to the seventh century..... It was recently translated by the Japanese, G. Takakusu,^{☆2} published by Clarendon Press, Oxford. The book in any case contains the word *Mashih* which shows with certainty that this word was not imported by the Buddhists from outside; rather, it was taken from the prophecy of the Buddha which they sometimes wrote as *Mashih* and sometimes as *Bagwa Metteyya*.

And from among the testimonies which we have found in the religious books of the Buddhists, there is one recorded by Sir Monier Williams, on page 45 of his book *Buddhism*. He says that the sixth disciple of the Buddha was a man named 'Yasa.'³ This

1. See Appendix, extract 7 [Publisher]

2. ☆ See pages 169 and 223 of the book. (Author)

3. See Appendix, extract 2. [Publisher]

word seems to be an abbreviation of the word Yasu. As Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, was born five hundred years after the death of the Buddha, sometime in the sixth century, he was called the sixth disciple. It should be noted that Professor Max Muller, on page 517 of the October 1894 issue of his periodical *The Nineteenth Century*, supports the aforesaid statement and says that established and renowned writers have pointed out many a time that Jesus, the Messiah, was influenced by the principles of Buddhism and that attempts are being made even today to discover some historical route along which the principles of the Buddha's faith could be proved to have reached Palestine in the days of Jesus, the Messiah.¹ This observation by Max Muller corroborates the Buddhist records in which it is claimed in as many words that Yasa was the disciple of the Buddha. When Christians of such repute as Professor Max Muller admit that the principles of Buddhism had certainly influenced Jesus, the Messiah, it would not be far wrong to say that this would amount to his being a disciple of the Buddha. Nevertheless, we consider the use of such a title in respect of Jesus, the Messiah, disrespectful and impertinent. The statement found in the Buddhist literature that Yasu was the disciple of the Buddha, is only an example of the age-old habit of Buddhist priests to designate a great personage appearing at a later date as if he were the disciple of his prototype. Apart from this, as has been pointed out, there being great resemblance between the teachings of Jesus, the Messiah, and those of the Buddha, it would not be wrong to speak of their relationship as that of the master and the disciple, though such thinking is

1. See Appendix, extract 8. [Publisher]

very irreverent. Nevertheless, we do not approve of the way the European investigators are eager to prove that the teachings of Buddhism had reached Palestine in the days of Jesus, the Messiah. It is, indeed, regrettable that when the name and mention of Jesus, the Messiah, are found in the ancient books of Buddhism, these investigators should adopt the dubious course of trying to find traces of Buddha's faith in Palestine. Why do they not search for the blessed footprints of Jesus, the Messiah, in the mountains of Nepal, Tibet, and Kashmir? I know, however, that these researchers could never be expected to uncover the truth which was lying hidden under a thousand veils of darkness; it was for God to do it. He watched from on high that man-worship was running rampant the world over, and worship of the cross and the fictional sacrifice of a human being had alienated the hearts of tens of millions of people from the true God. It was then that His sense of Honour and care for what is sacred, holy and inviolable, made Him send into the world His servant, in the spirit of Jesus, the Messiah, of Nazareth, to demolish the creed of the cross. And he did come as the Promised Messiah in accordance with the prophecies of old. Then at long last came the time for the breaking of the cross, that is to say, the time when the error of the creed of the cross was to be manifested with perfect clarity quite like splitting one piece of wood into two. Thus, heaven has now thrown open the way for the demolition of the cross, so let every seeker after truth now get up and search. True, [the belief in] the physical ascension to heaven of Jesus, the Messiah, was a mistake but there was still a mystery within it. And that was that the reality of the life of the Messiah, that had been forgotten and lost, as a corpse is eaten up by the earth and is no more; that reality had an

existence of its own in heaven, and was present in heaven like a physical human being. And it was essential that that reality should again descend in the latter days. Thus that Messianic reality has now descended in the form of a physical human being and it has broken the cross. And the evil habits of deception and worship of falsehood - which our Holy Prophet had likened unto the swine, in a hadith about the cross—have been torn into pieces by the breaking of the cross just as a swine is cut down by a sword. It is wrong to interpret this hadith to mean that the Promised Messiah would kill the infidels and physically break crosses. In reality, the breaking of the cross means that at that time, the God of Heaven and Earth would manifest such a hidden reality as would, all of a sudden, result in the breaking up of the entire structure of the cross. And by the killing of swine is not meant the killing of men, or of swine, but the killing of swinish habits, that is to say, to persist in falsehood and promote it incessantly, which is like the eating of excrement. Thus, just as a dead swine cannot eat filth, so, the time is fast approaching—in fact, it has already come—when those possessing evil habits would be prevented from such gorging on filth. Muslim clerics, the *Ulama*, have been grossly mistaken in the interpretation of this prophecy of the Holy Prophet. The true meanings of the breaking of the cross and of the killing of the swine are the ones we have mentioned. It is indeed also written that religious wars would come to an end in the time of the Promised Messiah, and such bright truths will be manifested from the heaven as would display a brilliant distinction between the truth and falsehood. Do not think, therefore, that I have come to wield the sword. No, I have come to put all swords back into their sheaths. The world has grappled much in the dark, many

attacked their sincere well-wishers and caused pain to the hearts of their compassionate friends, and wounded their dear ones. But now darkness shall not remain. The night is gone and the day has dawned. And blessed is he who no longer remains deprived!!

And from among the testimonies which we have found in Buddhist books is the testimony mentioned on page 419 of the book, 'Buddhism' by Oldenberg. It is recorded on the authority of the book named Mahavagga (page 54 section 1) that a man called Rahulta¹ was a successor to the Buddha. This Rahulta has been described not only as his devoted disciple, but also as his son. Here I make the claim that this Rahulta which appears in the books of Buddhism is simply a corruption of the name, 'Ruhullah,' which is one of the titles of Jesus, may peace be on him. And the story that Rahulta was the son of the Buddha, whom he abandoned in his infancy, and went to some other land; that furthermore, intending to part company forever, he fled to some other land leaving his wife asleep without informing her or saying farewell; this story appears altogether absurd and derogatory and contradictory to the high station of the Buddha. It portrays him as a cruel-natured and hard-hearted man who had no compassion for his helpless wife and left her asleep and slunk away like a thief without saying a word of consolation to her. He altogether ignored the duties he owed to her as a husband, neither divorcing her nor asking her permission to proceed on an endless journey, wounded her heart by disappearing so suddenly and did not care to send her even a single letter and took no pity on his child who grew up to manhood in his absence. A man such as this who had no respect even

1. Also known as Rahula. *See* Appendix, extract 5. [Publisher]

for the morals he taught his disciples could never be righteous? Conscience refuses to accept this story, just as it refuses to accept the story of the Gospels that once Jesus, the Messiah, failed to show regard for his mother, that he did not attend to her when she called on him and uttered words which were disrespectful.

So although the two stories about hurting the feelings of a wife and a mother have a mutual resemblance, yet we cannot ascribe such stories as do not size up to the lowest level of moral conduct either to Jesus, the Messiah, or to Gautama Buddha. If the Buddha did not love his wife, had he no pity on a helpless woman and her suffering child either? It is so serious a lapse of moral conduct that I am shocked even to think of this story which is hundreds of years old and belongs to the dead past. Why at all should he have behaved like this? To be a bad man, it is enough to be callous towards one's wife, unless she no longer remains virtuous and obedient, or becomes faithless, malevolent, and a threat to one's life. We cannot, therefore, ascribe such offensive behaviour to the Buddha, which goes against his own teachings. All this shows that the story is false. In point of fact, 'Rahulta' means Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, whose other name is Ruhullah. The word *Ruhullah* in Hebrew comes close to *Rahulta*, and *Rahulta*, or, *Ruhullah*, has been described as a disciple of the Buddha because, as I have already stated, Jesus, the Messiah, came after the Buddha and brought a teaching similar to that of the Buddha. That is why the followers of the Buddhist faith declared that the Buddha was the source of the teachings of Jesus, the Messiah, and that Jesus, the Messiah, was one of his disciples. It should also not be surprising if the Buddha, on the basis of revelation from God Almighty, should have declared Jesus, the

Messiah, to be his 'son.' Another important piece of circumstantial evidence in this regard is that in the same book it is recorded that when the infant Rahulta was separated from his mother, a woman whose name was Magdaliyana, and who was a follower of the Buddha acted as the intermediary. It may be noted that the name Magdaliyana is in reality a corrupt form of the name Magdalena, a female follower of Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, mentioned in the Gospels.

All this evidence, which has been briefly given, should lead an unbiased mind to the conclusion that Jesus, may peace be on him, must certainly have visited this country. Regardless of all these certain and sure grounds, no intelligent person can afford to disregard the similarity to be found between the teachings and the ceremonial rites of Buddhism and those of Christianity, especially in Tibet. This resemblance is so close and striking that most Christian researchers believe that Buddhism is the Christianity of the East, and Christianity the Buddhism of the West.¹ Look how amazing it is that just as Jesus, the Messiah, said, 'I am the Light and I am the Way,' so said the very same Buddha. The Gospels call Jesus, the Messiah, the Saviour, the Buddha too calls himself the Saviour—see *Lalta Wasatra*. And in the Gospels, the birth of Jesus, the Messiah, is said to have happened without a father. Similarly it is written in the life events of the Buddha that he too was in reality born without a father,² although apparently, just as Jesus, the Messiah, had a foster father Joseph, so had the Buddha a foster father. Similarly, it is stated that a star appeared at the time

1. See Appendix, extract 9. [Publisher]

2. See Appendix, extract 3. [Publisher]

of the Buddha's birth. Also there is the story of Solomon ordering the cutting of the child in two halves and giving each half to the two women; an exactly similar episode is to be found in the Buddha's Jataka.¹ From all this it can be understood that in addition to showing that Jesus, the Messiah, did come to this country, the Jews who had also migrated to this land had also established close ties with Buddhism.

And the account of the Creation of the world written in the books of Buddhism is also very similar to the one given in the Torah. And just as it appears from the Torah that man enjoys a degree of superiority over woman, so is a male devotee in the religion of the Buddha considered superior to a female devotee. The Buddha did, however, believe in the transmigration of souls, but his view of transmigration is not opposed to the teaching of the Gospels. According to the Buddha, transmigration is of three kinds:

(1) First being that, the resolute courage and conduct of a dying man demand, as an outcome, that another body be born. (2) Second is the category which the Tibetans believe in their own Lamas, that is to say, that some part of the spirit of some Buddha or *Buddhsattva* transmigrates into the present day Lamas, meaning that his power, disposition and spiritual qualities are transferred into the present day Lama and his spirit begins to animate the recipient. (3) The third category of transmigration is that in this very life man goes through various types of births until on account of his personal qualities he becomes an authentic human

1. Stories of the Buddha's former births found in Buddhist literature.
[Publisher]

being. A time may come upon man when he is, figuratively speaking, a bull; and then, when he grows in greed and somewhat in mischief, so he becomes a dog; the first existence dies giving place to the second, corresponding to the quality of the actions of the first. But all these 'metamorphoses,' take place in this very life. Thus this creed is also not opposed to the teachings of the Gospels.

And I have already stated that the Buddha also believes in the existence of the Devil; similarly he also believes in heaven and hell, and angels and he believes also in the Day of Judgment. And this allegation that the Buddha did not believe in God, is a pure fabrication. However, he did not believe in Vedanta¹ and in the corporeal gods that had been fabricated in the Hindu religion. And yes, he was an acute critic of the Vedas, and did not accept the existing Vedas to be accurate; he thought it to be a corrupted altered and modified book. He considered his birth in the period during which he was a Hindu and a follower of the Vedas, to have been an evil birth. For example, he hints that he remained for a certain period, a monkey also, again for a time an elephant, and then he became a deer, and a dog, and became four times a snake, and then became also a sparrow, a frog, twice a fish, ten times a lion, four times a fowl, twice a pig, and once a hare. When he was a hare he used to teach the monkeys, the jackals, and the water dogs. Again, he says that he was once a ghost, once a woman, and once a dancing Devil. All these hints are meant to point to phases of his life as were full of cowardice, effeminacy, impurity, savagery, beastliness, profligacy, gluttony, and superstition. It appears that in point of fact, his confessions pertain to the time when he was a

1. The Vedic concept and philosophy of the Divine. [Publisher]

follower of the Vedas, for, after rejecting the Vedas he never gives any hint of such things, that thereafter any part of the evil life remained within him. On the contrary, he made very great claims thereafter and said that he had become a manifestation of God and had attained Nirvana.¹ The Buddha has also stated that when man leaves the world accompanied by hellish deeds he is thrown into hell. And the sentinels of hell drag him to the king of hell, whose name is Yamah, and the condemned one is asked whether or not he had seen the following Five Messengers who had been sent to warn him. And they are the following: the period of childhood, the period of old age, disease, being punished during one's life as evidence of the punishment in the hereafter, corpses of the dead which remind us of the transitory nature of the world.

The condemned one replies that, 'Sir, due to my own stupidity I did not ponder at all over any of these things.' Thereupon the guardians of hell will drag him to the place of torment and secure him with chains of iron which would have been made so hot by fire as to have become red like the fire itself. The Buddha, moreover, says that hell has several zones where sinners of different categories will be cast. In short, all these teachings cry out aloud that the Buddhist religion gained something from the blessed personal example and influence of Jesus, the Messiah. I do not wish to elaborate this point further, and close this section here, because the prophecy about the coming of Jesus, the Messiah, to this country has been so clearly spelled out in Buddhist literature that no one

1. According to Buddhist teaching, Nirvana is the state of perfect bliss attained when the soul is freed from all suffering and absorbed into the supreme spirit. [Publisher]

can deny it. And then, apart from this, we see that the parables and the moral teachings of the Gospels are positively to be found in Buddhist books compiled in the time of Jesus, the Messiah. These two points, when considered together, leave no doubt whatsoever that definitely Jesus, the Messiah, came to this country. Thus, the evidence which we wanted to find in the books of the Buddhist faith has, thanks be to God, been discovered in full.

Section Three

Evidence from those books which Prove that the Journeying to Punjab and its Neighbouring Territories, of Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, was Indispensable

Because the question naturally arises as to why Jesus the Messiah, may peace be on him, should have come to this country after his escape from the cross, and what need could have induced him to take on such a long journey, so it seems necessary to give a detailed answer to this question. And though I have written on this a little already, I feel it necessary to include a full discussion of this question here.

Let it be clearly known, therefore, that it was extremely necessary, by reason of his office as divine messenger, for Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, to have journeyed to the Punjab and its neighbourhood. This was so because the ten tribes of Israel, who in the Gospels have been called the lost sheep of Israel, had migrated to this country - a fact which no historian denies. It

was necessary, therefore, that Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, should have journeyed to this country and, after locating the whereabouts of the lost sheep, should have conveyed to them the message that God Almighty had vouchsafed to him. And until he had not done this, the purpose for which he had been sent by God Almighty would have remained without result and unfulfilled. His mission was to preach to the lost sheep of Israel. Thus, for him to just pass away from the world without going after the lost sheep, and searching for them, and teaching them the way to salvation, would have been quite like the case of a man who had been commanded by a king to go to a desert tribe to dig a well and supply them with water from that well, but this man goes instead to some other place where he spends three or four years, and returns without having taken even a single steps to search for the concerned tribe. So did such a man act in compliance with the command of the king? Not in the least. On the contrary, for the sake of his own comfort, the man showed no concern for that tribe.

If, however, it is asked, how and why it should be supposed that the ten tribes of Israel had come to this country, the answer is that the supporting evidence of this thesis is so strong and incontrovertible that even a dullard will not deny it. It is only too well known that people like the Afghans and the old inhabitants of Kashmir are in fact of Israelite origin. For example, the people of Alai Kohistan which is at a distance of two or three days' journey from the district of Hazara, have called themselves Beni Israel from time immemorial. Similarly, there is another hilly tract in this region known as Kala Dhaka, whose inhabitants also take pride in being of Israelite origin. Then in the Hazara district itself, there is

a tribe which claims to belong to the house of Israel. Similarly, the inhabitants of the mountain range between Chilas and Kabul also call themselves Israelites. Dr. Bernier's view about the people of Kashmir, which is based on the authority of some English scholars, and is expressed in the second part of his book *Travels*¹ in Kashmir, is only too true. According to him, the Kashmiri people are the descendants of Israel; their dress, their facial features and some of their rituals conclusively point to the fact that they are undoubtedly of Israelite origin.² An Englishman, Forster by name, writes in his book that during his stay in Kashmir he felt as if he was living amidst a tribe of the Jews.³ H. W. Bellew C.S.I. in his book *The Races of Afghanistan*, published by Thacker Spink & Co. Calcutta, states that the Afghans came from Syria. Nebuchadnezzar took them prisoner and settled them in Persia and Media, from whence at some later date they moved to the East and settled in the Ghor hills, where they were known as Beni Israel. In proof of this there is the prophecy of the Prophet Idris [Enoch], which says that the ten tribes of Israel who were taken prisoner, escaped from captivity and took refuge in the territory called Arsarah which appears to be another name of the area known as Hazara today, part of the region being called Ghor. In *Tabaqāt-i-Nāsrī*, there is an account of the conquest of Afghanistan by Genghis Khan. It is stated that in the times of the Shabnisi dynasty there lived a tribe known as Beni Israel, some of whom were big businessmen and good traders. In 622 A.D., which is the year in which Muhammad, that is to

1. Dr. Bernier's *Travels in the Mogul Empire*. [Publisher]

2. See Appendix, extract 10. [Publisher]

3. See Appendix, extract 11. [Publisher]

say Our Master, the Seal of the Prophets, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, announced his claim to being a Messenger from Allah, these people were to be found in the eastern part of Herat. A Quraish chief Khalid bin Walid brought to them the tidings of the Prophet's Coming with a view to bringing them under the banner of the Divine Messenger (peace and blessings of Allah be upon him). Five or six chiefs were elected to accompany him, of whom the principal chief was Qais, whose other name was Kish. After accepting Islam, these people fought bravely for the cause of Islam and made many conquests. The Holy Prophet (may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him) gave them many gifts on their return journey, blessed them, and prophesied that they would attain great power and ascendancy. The Holy Prophet (may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him) also prophesied that the chiefs of this tribe would always be known as Maliks. He gave Qais the name of 'Abdul Rashid and conferred upon him the title *Pahtaan*. Afghan writers say that this is a Syriac word which means a rudder. As the newly converted Qais was, like the rudder of a ship, a guide to his tribe, he was awarded the title *Pahtaan*.

At what period the Afghans of Ghor moved forward and settled in the Kandahar country, which is now their home, is not known. This happened probably in the first century of the Islamic calendar. The Afghans maintain that Qais married the daughter of Khalid bin Walid, by whom he had three sons whose names were Saraban, Patan, and Gurgasht. Saraban had two sons, called Sacharj Yun, and Karsh Yun and it is their descendants indeed who are today known as the Afghans or Beni-Israel. The people

of Asia-Minor, and Muslim historians of the West, call Afghans *Sulaimanis*.¹

In *The Cyclopaedia of India, Eastern and Southern Asia*, by Edward Balfour, Vol. III,² it is stated that the Jewish people are spread all over the central, southern, and eastern regions of Asia. In early times these people were settled in large numbers in China; they had a synagogue at Yih Chu (the headquarters of the district of Shu). Dr. Wolf, who wandered for a long time in search of the ten lost tribes of Beni Israel, is of the opinion that if Afghans are the progeny of Jacob, they belong to the tribes of Yahuda and Bin Yamin. Another report proves that the Jews were exiled to Tartary; they were found in large numbers in the territories round about Bukhara, Merv and Khiva. Prester John, Emperor of Tartary, in his letter to Alexis Comminus, the Emperor of Constantinople, writing about his dominions, says that beyond the river Amu there are the ten tribes of Israel who, though they claim to be under their own king, are in reality his subjects and vassals. Dr Moore's researches show that the Tartar tribe named Chosan is of Jewish origin and that among them are to be found traces of the ancient Jewish faith up to this day. For example, they still practise the rite of circumcision. The Afghans have a tradition that they are the ten lost tribes of Israel. After the sack of Jerusalem, the king Nebuchadnezzar took them prisoner and settled them in Ghor, near Bamiyan. Before the arrival of Khalid bin Walid they had consistently held fast to the Jewish faith.

In appearance, the Afghans resemble the Jews in all respects.

1. See Appendix, extract 12. [Publisher]

2. It should be volume I, third edition. [Publisher]

Like them, the younger brother marries the widow of the elder brother. A French traveller, Ferrier by name, who passed through Herat, states that Israelites are found in large numbers in that territory, and that they have full liberty in the practice of their religion.¹ The Rabbi Bin Yamin of Toledo, Spain ventured out in search of the lost tribes in the twelfth century A.D. He states that these Jews are settled in China, Iran and Tibet. Josephus, who wrote the ancient history of the Jews in 93 A.D., in the course of his account of the Jews who escaped from bondage along with the Prophet Ezra, states in his eleventh book that the ten tribes were settled beyond the Euphrates even at that time, and that their numbers were uncountable.² (By 'beyond the Euphrates' he meant Persia and the eastern territories.) St. Jerome who lived in the fifth century A.D., writing about Prophet Hosea says in the margin, in support of his thesis, that since that day the ten tribes (of the Israelites) have been under king Parthya or Paras, and have not been released from bondage. In the first volume of the same book, it is stated that Count Björn Stjerna testifies on page 233–34 of his book that the Afghans admit that Nebuchadnezzar, after the destruction of the Temple at Jerusalem, exiled them to the territory of Bamiyan (which is adjacent to Ghor, in Afghanistan).

On page 166 of the book, *A Narrative of a Visit to Ghuzni, Kabul and Afghanistan* by G. T. Vigne, F.G.S. (1840), it is stated that one Mullah Khuda Dad quoted in his presence from a book called *Majma'ul-Ansāb*, that the eldest son of Jacob was Judas, whose son was Usrak; Usrak's son was Aknur; Aknur's son was

1. See Appendix, extract 13,14,15. [Publisher]

2. See Appendix, extract 16. [Publisher]

Maalib; Maalib's Farlai; Farlai's Qais, Qais' Talut; Talut's Armea, and Armea's son was Afghan whose descendants are the Afghan people and after whom the latter are named. Afghan, a contemporary of Nebuchadnezzar, was known as a descendant of Israel, and had forty sons. In the 34th generation of his genealogical tree, after some 2000 years, was born Qais who lived in the time of Muhammad (Messenger of Allah, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him). His descendants multiplied down to 64 generations.¹ Afghan's eldest son, Salm, migrated from his Syrian home and settled in Ghor Mashkoh, near Herat, and his descendants spread into Afghanistan.²

In *A Cyclopaedia of Geography* by James Bryce, F.G.S. (London, 1856), on page 11, it is stated that the Afghans trace their genealogy to Saul, the Israelite King, and call themselves the descendants of Israel. Alexander Burns says that the Afghans state that they are of Jewish origin; that the King of Babel captured them and settled them in the territory of Ghor which lies to the north-west of Kabul; that up to 622 A.D. they continued to hold on to the Jewish faith, but that Khalid bin Abdullah (Abdullah has been written mistakenly instead of Walid) married the daughter of a chief of this tribe and made them accept Islam in that year.³

On page 39 of Col. G. B. Malleeson's book *History of Afghanistan* (London 1878), it is stated that Abdullah Khan of Herat, the French traveller named Ferrier, and Sir William Jones (a recognised Orientalist), agree that the Afghan people are

1. It should be read as 66. [Publisher]

2. See Appendix, extract 17. [Publisher]

3. See Appendix, extract 18. [Publisher]

descended from the Beni-Israel, and that they are the descendants of the ten lost tribes.¹ The book *History of the Afghans*, by G. P. Ferrier,² translated by Capt. William Jesse, and published in London (1858), records on page 1 that the majority of oriental historians are of the opinion that the Afghan people are the descendants of the ten tribes of Israel and that the Afghans too hold the same opinion. The same historian says on page 4 of this book, that Afghans possess evidence in support of this that they present as follows, that: When Nadir Shah arrived at Peshawar, with intention of conquering India, he was presented a Bible written in Hebrew by the chiefs of the Yoosoofzyes tribe as well as several other articles preserved by their families for the performance of religious rites of their old faith. There were also Jews in Nadir Shah's camp, who, on seeing the articles, readily recognised them.

Again, the same historian states on page 4 of his book that in his opinion the view of Abdullah Khan of Herat is highly reliable. Briefly stated this view is as follows: Malek Thalut (Saul) had two sons, Afghan and Djalut. Afghan was the patriarch of these people. After the reigns of David and Solomon, the Israelite tribes started fighting one another. As a result, each tribe became separated from the other. This state of affairs continued up to the time of Nebuchadnezzar who invaded and killed 70,000 Jews. He sacked the city, and took the remaining Jews with him to Babel as prisoners. After this catastrophe, the children of Afghan fled in fear from

1. See Appendix, extract 19. [Publisher]

2. This should be J.P. Ferrier (Joseph Pierre Ferrier). In Urdu *J* (ج) was written as *G* (ج) because, at the time of the author, not much distinction was made between ج and گ. [Publisher]

Judea to Arabia and remained there for a long time. But as water and land were scarce, and man and beast suffered great hardship, they decided to migrate to India. A party of Abdalees remained in Arabia, and during the Khilafat of (Hazrat) Abu Bakr one of their chiefs established matrimonial relationship with Khalid bin Walid.... When Iran fell to Arabia, these people migrated from Arabia and settled in the Iranian provinces of Fars and Kirman. They stayed there till Genghis Khan's invasion. As the Abdalees were helpless against the atrocities of Genghis Khan, they left for India via Makran, Sindh and Multan. But here too they couldn't find peace. They eventually arrived at Koh Sulaiman and settled there. The other members of the Abdali tribe also joined them. They consisted of 24 tribes, all descendants of Afghan who had three sons, Tsera-Bend (Saraban), Arkash (Argoutch) and Karlen (Batan). They had eight sons each who multiplied into twenty-four tribes, each tribe was named after each son. The names of the sons and the tribes are as follows:¹

1. See Appendix, extract 20. [Publisher]

“SONS OF TSERA- BEND.	NAMES OF THE TRIBES.	SONS OF ARGOUTCH.	NAMES OF THE TRIBES.
Abdal	Abdalees.	Ghildj	Ghildjzyes.
Yoosoof	Yoosoofzyes.	Kauker	Kaukerees.
Baboor	Baboorees.	Djumourian	Djumourianees
Wezir	Wezirees.	Storian	Storianees.
Lohooan	Lohooanees.	Pen	Penees.
Beritch	Beritchees.	Kass	Kassees.
Khooguian	Khooguianees.	Takan	Takanees.
Chiran	Chiranees.	Nassar	Nassarees.

“SONS OF KERLEN.	NAMES OF THE TRIBES.	SONS OF KERLEN.	NAMES OF THE TRIBES.
Khattak	Khattakees.	Zaz	Zazees.
Soor	Soorees.	Bab	Babees.
Afreed	Afreedees.	Benguech	Benguechees.
Toor	Toorees.	Lendeh-poor	Lendeh-poorees.

THE END

The book, *Makhzan-i-Afghani*^{☆1} by Khawaja Nimatullah of Herat, was written in 1018 Hijrah during the reign of the Emperor Jahangir, and was translated and published by Prof. Bernhard Doran of Kharkov University in 1836 in London. It contains the following statements in the chapters mentioned below:

In chapter 1 there is the history of Jacob Israel with whom starts the genealogy of this nation (Afghans).

In chapter II there is the history of King Talut, that is to say, the genealogy of the Afghans is traced to Talut.

On pages 22 and 23 it is stated that Talut had two sons, Berkhia and Ermiah. Berkhia had a son, Asif and Ermiah's Afghan and on page 24 it is stated that Afghan had twenty-four² sons and no one among the Israelites could compare in numbers with the descendants of Afghan. On page 65³ it is stated that Bokhtnasser⁴ occupied the whole of Sham [Syria], etc., exiled the Israelite tribes and forced them to settle in the mountainous regions of Ghor, Ghazneen, Kabul, Qandahar and Koh Firoz, where the descendants of Asif and Afghan particularly took up their abode.

The third chapter contains the statement that when Bokhtnasser expelled the Israelites from Syria, some tribes who

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1. ☆ See page 3 of Preface by the author. This book is a summary of authentic chronicles like *Tārīkh-e-Tibri*, *Majma'ul-'Ansāb*, *Gazidah Jahān-Kushāi*, *Maṭla'ul-Anwār* and *M'adan-e-Akbar*. (Author)
 2. It should be read as 'forty', as is stated in extract 21 of the Appendix. [Publisher]
 3. This is a misprint, to be read as page 25. See Appendix, extract 21. [Publisher]
 4. Nebuchadnezzar [Publisher]

were the descendants of Asif and Afghan took refuge in Arabia. The Arabs used to address them as Beni Israel and Beni Afghan.¹

On pages 37 and 38 of the same book, on the authority of the author of *Majma'ul-Ansāb*, and that of Mestoufi, the author of *Tārīkh Gazīdah*, it is stated that in the lifetime of the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, Khalid bin Walid invited the Afghans to Islam, who, after Bokhtnasser's invasion, had taken up residence in the Ghor territory. The Afghan chiefs under the leadership of Qais, who was Talut's descendant in the 37th generation, came to pay their homage to the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. Qais was named Abdul Rashid by the Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him (Here the genealogy of Abdul Rashid Qais is traced back to Talut—Saul). The Holy Prophet, may peace and blessings of Allah be upon him, also conferred the title of Pathan on the chiefs which means 'ship's rudder'. After some time the chiefs returned to their territory and began to preach Islam.

In the same book *Makhzan-i-Afghani* on page 63, it is recorded that Farid-ud-Din Ahmad makes the following statement concerning the titles Beni Afghanah or Beni Afghan, in his book *Risalah Ansaab-i-Afghaniyyah*: After Nebuchadnezzar, the Magian, had subjugated the Israelites, conquered the Syrian territories and sacked Jerusalem, he took the Israelites prisoners and exiled them as slaves. He took away with him several of their tribes who followed the Mosaic Law, and ordered them to renounce their ancestral faith and to worship him instead of God, which they refused to do. Consequently, Nebuchadnezzar put to

1. Meaning the children of Israel and the children of Afghan. [Publisher]

death two thousand of the most intelligent and the wisest from among them and ordered the rest to leave his kingdom and Syria. Some of them left Nebuchadnezzar's territory under a chief and went away to the Ghor hills. Their descendants settled down in that place, multiplied at a fast rate, and people began to designate them as Beni Israel, Beni Asif and Beni Afghan.

On page 64, the same author says that reliable records like *Tārikh-i-Afghani*, *Tārikh-i-Ghori*, etc., contain the assertion that the Afghans are mostly Beni Israel and some of them are of Coptic origin. Moreover, Abul Fazl also states that some Afghans regard themselves as of Egyptian origin, the reason given by them being that when the Beni Israel returned to Egypt from Jerusalem, this tribe, namely, the Afghans migrated to India. On page 64 Farid-ud-Din Ahmad writes about the title 'Afghan' that some writers are on record having said that after exile (from Syria) they used always to 'bewail and cry' in remembrance of their home. That is why they were named Afghans.¹ Sir John Malcolm is also of the same opinion; vide *History of Persia*, vol. 1, p. 101.

On page 63, is given Mahabat Khan's statement that: 'As they are the followers and relations of Solomon, they are, therefore, styled Sulaimanis by the Arabs.'

On page 65, it is written that investigations of almost all oriental historians show that the Afghan people's own view is that they are of Jewish origin. Some of the present day historians have adopted the same view and probably regard it as true... and this custom that the Afghans adopt the Jewish names is without a

1. Meaning that the title 'Afghan' is a combination of two Persian words *aah* (lament) and *faghan* (cry of pain). [Publisher]

doubt due to the fact that the Afghans have become Muslims. (However, this contention of the translator Bernard Dorn is not sustained by evidence. In north western and western Punjab, there are tribes of Hindu origin who have become Muslims but whose names are not after the names of the Jewish people, which clearly shows that by becoming Muslim people do not necessarily adopt Jewish names.)

That in features the Afghans have a surprising resemblance to the Jews, is a fact which is admitted even by such scholars as do not at all subscribe to the Afghan claim that they are of Jewish origin. This is the only proof strong enough to establish that the Afghan are of Jewish origin. Sir John Malcolm's remarks in this connection are as follows:

Although the Afghans' right to this proud (Jewish) descent is very doubtful, it is evident from their personal appearance and many of their customs that they (the Afghans) are a distinct race from the Persians, Tartars and Indians and this alone seems to give some credibility to the Afghan claim which is otherwise contradicted by many strong facts, and of which no direct proof has been produced. If similarity of features between one people and another can point to anything, the Kashmiris with their Jewish features would certainly be found to be of Jewish origin. This has been mentioned not only by Bernier but also by Forster, and possibly by other scholars....

Although Forster does not accept Bernier's opinion,

he concedes that when he was among the Kashmiris he thought he was living amidst a Jewish people.¹

Under the word 'Cashmere', on page 250 of A. K. Johnston's Dictionary of Geography, there is this statement:

The natives are of a tall robust frame of body, with manly features—the women full-formed and handsome, with aquiline nose and features, resembling the Jewish.²

The *Civil & Military Gazette* (23 November 1898, p. 4) under the heading *Sawati and Afridi* (peoples), reproduces a very valuable and interesting paper presented to the Anthropological section of the British Association at one of its recent meetings, which will be read at its winter session before the Committee on Anthropological Research. The *Gazette* says:

The original Pathan or Paktan inhabitants of these western gates of India are recognised in very early history, many of the tribes being mentioned by Herodotus and the historians of Alexander. In mediaeval times, the rough uncultivated wilderness of mountains they held, was called Roh, and its inhabitants Rohillas, and there can be little doubt that most of these early Rohilla or Pathan tribes were in their places long before the overlying Afghan tribes were thought of. All Afghans whatsoever

1. See Appendix, extract 21. [Publisher]

2. See Appendix, extract 22. [Publisher]

now counted as Pathans, because they all speak the Pathan language, Pushto, they acknowledge no direct kinship, claiming themselves to be Beni Israel, the descendants of those tribes who were carried captive to Babylon by Nebuchadnezzar. All of them have, however, adopted the Pushto tongue, and all recognise the same Pathan code of common civil observances called Paktanwali, which is, in many of its provisions, curiously suggestive both of the old Mosaic dispensation and of ancient observances of the Rajput races.

Thus the Pathans, with whom we have lately been so largely concerned, may be divided into two great communities, i.e. tribes and clans such as Waziris, Afridis, Orakzais, etc. who are of Indian origin, and those who are Afghans, who claim to be Semitic and who represent the dominant race throughout our frontier; and it seems at least to be possible that the Paktanwali, which is an unwritten code and which is acknowledged by them all alike, may be of very mixed origin indeed. We may find in it Mosaic ordinances grafted on to Rajput traditions and modified by Moslem custom. The Afghans, who call themselves Duranis and who have done so ever since the foundation of the Durani Empire about a century and a half ago, say that they trace their descent from the Israelitish tribes through an ancestor named Kish (Qais), to whom the prophet Mohomet gave the name Pathan (which is Syriac for a rudder), because he was to steer his people into the currents of Islam.... It is difficult to account for the universal prevalence of Israelitish names amongst

Afghans without admitting some early connection with the Israelitish nation. Still more difficult is it to account for certain observances, such for instance as the keeping of the Feast of the Passover (which, by the Yusufzai branch of the Afghan race, is at most curiously well imitated) or for the persistence with which the least educated Afghans maintain this tradition, without some original basis of truth for it. Bellew thinks that this Israelitish connection may be a real one, but he points out that one at least of the three main branches of the Afghan family traditionally sprung from Kish (Qais), is called by the name Sarabaur, which is but the Pushto form of the ancient name applied to the solar race of Rajputs, colonies of whom are known to have immigrated into Afghanistan after their defeat by the Chandrabans, the lunar race in the great contest, the Mahabharat of early Indian records. Thus the Afghan may possibly be an Israelite absorbed into ancient Rajput tribes, and this has always appeared to me to be the most probable solution of the problem of his origin. Anyhow, the modern Afghan takes his stand, on the grounds of tradition, to be one of the chosen race, a descendant of Abraham...

We have reproduced all these quotations from the writings of well-known authors, and if considered together, they will convince the impartial reader that Afghans and Kashmiris, who are to be found in India, on the frontier and in its neighbourhood, are really the Beni Israel. In the second part of this book, God willing, I shall prove in greater detail that the ultimate object underlying

the long journey to India of Jesus, the Messiah, may peace be on him, was that he might discharge the duty of preaching to all the Israelite tribes, a fact to which he has alluded in the Gospels. It is not surprising, therefore, that he should have come to India and Kashmir. On the contrary, it would indeed be surprising if, without discharging his duties as prophet, he should have ascended to the heavens and taken his seat there. With this, we close this part of the discussion.

وَالسَّلَامُ عَلَى مَنْ اتَّبَعَ الْهُدَى

[And peace be on those who follow the guidance].

AUTHOR,

H U M B L Y,

Mirza Ghulam Ahmad^{sas}, the Promised Messiah,

Qadian, District Gurdaspur

APPENDIX

EXTRACTS FROM THE ORIGINAL BOOKS WHICH HAVE BEEN QUOTED BY THE AUTHOR IN 'JESUS IN INDIA.'

EXTRACT I

Lectures on the Origin and Growth of Religion as Illustrated by some Points in the History of **Indian Buddhism**, by T. W. Rhys Davids, (the Hibbert Lectures, 1881) (Williams & Norgate, London 1881)

Page 147. All this is of peculiar interest from the comparative point of view. It is an expression from the Buddhist standpoint, which excludes the theory of a Supreme Deity, of an idea very similar to that which is expressed in Christian writings when Christ is represented as the

manifestation of God to men, the Logos, the Word of God made flesh, the Bread of Life. And it is not a mere chance that heterodox followers of the two religions have afterwards used the Buddha and the Logos conceptions as bases of their emanation theories. It is only a fresh instance of the way in which similar ideas in similarly constituted minds come to be modified in very similar ways.

The Cakka-vatti Buddha was to the early Buddhists what the Messiah Logos was to the early Christians. In both cases the two ideas overlap one another, run into one another, supplement one another. In both cases the two combined cover as nearly the same ground as the different foundations of the two teachings will permit. And it is the Cakka-vatti Buddha circle of ideas in the one case, just as the Messiah Logos in the other, that has had the principal influence in determining the opinions of the early disciples as to the person of their Master. The method followed in the early Buddhist and early Christian biographies of their respective Masters was the same, and led to similar results; though the details are in no particular quite identical in the two cases.

EXTRACT 2

Buddhism, in its Connexion with Brāhmanism and Hindūism, and in its Contrast with Christianity, by Sir Monier Monier-Williams, K.C.I.E., Second Edition, (John Murray, London 1890)

Pages 134–135. He said of himself (Mahā-vagga 1.6,8),— ‘I am the all- subduer (sabbābhibhū); the all- wise; I have no stains; through myself I possess knowledge; I have no rival (patipuggalo); I am the chief Arhat— the highest teacher; I alone am the absolutely wise (Sambuddha); I am the Conqueror (Jina); all the fires of desire are quenched (sīti-bhūto) in me; I have Nirvāna (nibbuto).

Page 135 (footnote). In fact Gautama remained a Bodhi-sattva until he was thirty-four or thirty-five, when he attained perfect enlightenment and Buddhahood.

Page 126. 1. Kill not any living thing. 2. Steal not. 3. Commit not adultery. 4. Lie not. 5. Drink not strong drink...6. Eat no food except at stated times. 7. Use no wreaths, ornaments, or perfumes. 8. Use no high or broad bed, but only a mat on the ground. 9. Abstain from dancing, singing, music, and worldly spectacles. 10. Own no gold, or silver of any kind, and accept none. (Mahā-vagga 1.56). [This Buddhist Decalogue may be contrasted with the Mosaic Decalogue.]

Pages 45–47. The Buddha’s early disciples were not poor men; for the sixth to be admitted to the Saṅgha was a high-born youth named Yasa...In sending forth these sixty monks to proclaim his own gospel of deliverance, he addressed them thus:-

‘I am delivered from all fetters (p.127), human and divine. You too, O monks, are freed from the same fetters.

Go forth and wander everywhere, out of compassion for the world and for the welfare of gods and men. Go forth, one by one, in different directions. Preach the doctrine (Dharmam), salutary (kalyāna) in its beginning, middle, and end, in its spirit (artha) and in its letter (vyañjana). Proclaim a life of perfect restraint, chastity, and celibacy (brahmaçariyam). I will go also to preach this doctrine' (Mahā-vagga I. II. I).

When his monk-missionaries had departed, Gautama himself followed, though not till Māra (p. 41) had again tempted him. Quitting Benares he journeyed back to Uruvelā, near Gayā. There he first converted thirty rich young men and then one thousand orthodox Brāhmans, led by Kāśyapa and his two brothers, who maintained a sacred fire ('Brāhmanism,' p. 364). The fire-chamber was haunted by a fiery snake-demon; so Buddha asked to occupy the room for a night, fought the serpent and confined him in his own alms-bowl. Next he worked other miracles (said to have been 3500 in number)...

To them on a hill Gayāsīsa (Brahma-yoni), near Gayā, he preached his 'burning' fire-sermon (Mahā-v° I. 21): 'Everything, O monks, is burning (ādittam=ādīptam). The eye is burning; visible things are burning. The sensation produced by contact with visible things is burning—burning with fire of lust (desire), enmity and delusion (rāgagginā dosagginā mohagginā), with birth, decay (jarayā), death, grief, lamentation, pain, dejection (domanassehi), and despair (upāyāsehi). The ear is burning; sounds are burning; the nose is burning, odours are

burning; the tongue is burning, tastes are burning; the body is burning, objects of sense are burning. The mind is burning; thoughts are burning. All are burning with the fire of passions and lusts. Observing this, O monks, a wise and noble disciple becomes weary of (or disgusted with) the eye, weary of visible things, weary of the ear, weary of sounds, weary of odours, weary of tastes, weary of the body, weary of the mind. Becoming weary, he frees himself from passions and lusts. When free, he realizes that his object is accomplished, that he has lived a life of restraint and chastity (*brahmaçariyam*), that re-birth is ended.'

It is said that this fire-sermon—which is a key to the meaning of *Nirvāna*—was suggested by the sight of a conflagration. It was Gautama's custom to impress ideas on his hearers by pointing to visible objects. He compares all life to a flame; and the gist of the discourse is the duty of extinguishing the fire of lusts, and with it the fire of all existence, and importance of monkhood and celibacy for the attainment of this end.

Contrast in Christ's Sermon on the Mount the words addressed to the multitude (not to monks), 'Blessed are the pure in heart, for they shall see God.'

The Buddha and his followers next proceeded to Rājagriha.

EXTRACT 3

Buddhism: being a Sketch of the Life and Teachings of Gautama, the Buddha, by T. W. Rhys Davids, M.A. Ph.D. (Society for Promoting Christian Knowledge, London 1882)

Page 183. His mother was the best and the purest of the daughters of men.

In the footnote of page 183, Davids quotes St. Jerome:

St. Jerome says (contra Jovian. bk. I): 'It is handed down as a tradition among the Gymnosophists of India, that Buddha, the founder of their system, was brought forth by a virgin from her side.'

EXTRACT 4

The **Life of the Buddha** and the Early History of his Order, derived from Tibetan Works in the Bkash-Hgyur and Bstan-Hgyur, translated by W. Woodville Rockhill (Trübner & Co. London 1884)

Page 32. The rumour had reached Kapilavastu that the prince had died under the excess of his penances, and all the court was plunged in despair, and his wives fell fainting to the ground; but a little after came the news that he

had attained enlightenment, and great was the rejoicing everywhere.

Page 141. As soon as the Blessed One expired the mighty earth was shaken, thunderbolts did fall, and the gods in the sky did shriek with (or like) sound of drum (f.635^a). At that time the venerable Mahākāṣyapa was stopping in the Kalantakanivasa Bamboo grove at Rājagriha; and when the earth quaked he sought what might be the reason, and he saw that the Blessed One had utterly passed away...

EXTRACT 5

Buddha: His Life, His Doctrine, His Order by Dr. Hermann Oldenberg, Translated from the German by William Hoey, M.A., D.Lit. (Williams & Norgate, London 1882)

Page 142 (footnote): On the occasion of a prophecy of Buddha's regarding Metteyya, the next Buddha, who will in the far future appear upon the earth, it is said: "He will be the leader of a band of disciples, numbering hundreds of thousands, as I am now the leader of bands of disciples, numbering hundreds.—*Cakkavatti Suttanta*."

Page 419. Regarding the wife and child of Buddha the chief passage is "Mahāvagga," i, 54; Rāhula is frequently mentioned in the Sutta texts as Buddha's son, without any

prominent *rôle* being ascribed to him among the circles of disciples by the ancient tradition.

Page 103. He (Buddha) says: "Râhula is born to me, a fetter has been forged for me."

Page 103 (footnote). In the name Râhula there seems to be an allusion to Râhu, the sun and moon subduing (darkening) demon.

EXTRACT 6

Tibet, Tartary and Mongolia; their Social and Political Condition, and the Religion of Boodh, as there Existing, by Henry T. Prinsep Esq. Second Edition (Wm. H. Allen & Co. London 1852)

Pages 12-14. The earliest travels into Tibet Proper which have been transmitted to us, are those of the Jesuit fathers, Grueber and Dorville, who returned from China by that route in A.D. 1661, just four hundred years after Marco Polo's journey westward. They were the first Christians of Europe who are known to have penetrated into the populous parts of Tibet; for Marco Polo's journey was, as we have stated, to the north-west, by the sources of the Oxus. Father Grueber was much struck with the extraordinary similitude he found, as well in the doctrine, as in the rituals, of the Boodhists of Lassa to those of his own Romish faith. He noticed first, that the dress

of Lamas corresponded with that handed down to us in ancient paintings, as the dress of the Apostles. 2nd. That the discipline of the monasteries, and of the different orders of Lamas or priests, bore the same resemblance to that of the Romish church. 3rd. That the notion of an incarnation was common to both, so also the belief in paradise and purgatory. 4th. He remarked that they made suffrages, alms, prayers, and sacrifices for the dead, like the Roman Catholics. 5th. That they had convents, filled with monks and friars, to the number of 30,000, near Lassa, who all made the three vows of poverty, obedience, and chastity, like Roman monks, besides other vows. And 6th, that they had confessors, licensed by the superior Lamas, or bishops; and so empowered to receive confessions, and to impose penances, and give absolution. Besides all this, there was found the practice of using holy water, of singing service in alternation, of praying for the dead, and a perfect similarity in the costumes of the great and superior Lamas to those of the different orders of the Romish hierarchy. These early missionaries, further, were led to conclude, from what they saw and heard, that the ancient books of the Lamas contained traces of the Christian religion, which must, they thought, have been preached in Tibet in the time of the Apostles.

Then concerning the advent of a Saviour, the author H. T. Prinsep writes in the same book (Tibet, Tartary and Mongolia) on page 171:

The general expectation of the birth of a great prophet, Redeemer, or Saviour, which is alluded to even by Tacitus, as prevailing at the period when the founder of the Christian religion appeared, was, there can be no doubt, of Boodhistic origin, and not at all confined to Jews, or based only on the prophecies of their Scripture.

As a footnote on page 171 the author further wrote:

The advent of another Boodh a thousand years after Gotama, or Sakhya Muni, is distinctly prophesied in the Pitakattayan and Attha-katha. Gotama declares himself to be the twenty-fifth Boodh, and says, “Bagawa Metteyo is yet to come.” The name Metteyo bears an extraordinary resemblance to Messiah.

EXTRACT 7

A Record of **The Buddhist Religion** as practised in India and the Malay Archipelago (A.D. 671–695) by I-Tsing, Translated by J. Takakusu, B.A., Ph.D. (Oxford, Clarendon Press 1896)

Pages 223–224: It is indeed curious to find the name of MESSIAH in a Buddhist work, though the name comes in quite accidentally. The book is called ‘The New Catalogue of the Buddhist Books compiled in the Chêng Yüan Period’ (A.D. 785–804), in the new Japanese edition of the

Chinese Buddhist Books (Bodleian Library, Jap. 65 DD, 結六 P. 73; this book is not in Nanjio's Catalogue)....

Moreover, the Sanghârâma of the Sâkya and the monastery of Tâ-ch'in (Syria) differ much in their customs, and their religious practices are entirely opposed to each other. King-ching (Adam) ought to hand down the teaching of MESSIAH (Mi-shi-ho), and the Sâkyaputriya-Sramanas should propagate the Sûtras of the Buddha.

EXTRACT 8

The **Nineteenth Century**: A Monthly Review, edited by James Knowles, Vol. XXXVI, July-December 1894 (Sampson Low, Marston & Co. London 1894)

Page 517. But M. Notovitch, though he did not bring the manuscripts home, at all events saw them, and not pretending to a knowledge of Tibetan, had the Tibetan text translated by an interpreter, and has published seventy pages of it in French in his *Vie inconnue de Jésus-Christ*. He was evidently prepared for the discovery of a Life of Christ among the Buddhists. Similarities between Christianity and Buddhism have frequently been pointed out of late, and the idea that Christ was influenced by Buddhist doctrines has more than once been put forward by popular writers. The difficulty has hitherto been to discover any real historical channel through which Buddhism could have reached Palestine at the time of Christ. M. Notovitch

thinks that the manuscript which he found at Himis explains the matter in the simplest way. There is no doubt, as he says, a gap in the life of Christ, say from his fifteenth to his twenty-ninth year. During that very time the new Life found in Tibet asserts that Christ was in India, that he studied Sanskrit and Pâli, that he read the Vedas and the Buddhist Canon, and then returned through Persia to Palestine to preach the Gospel. If we understand M. Notovitch rightly, this Life of Christ was taken down from the mouths of some Jewish merchants who came to India immediately after the Crucifixion (P. 237). It was written down in Pâli, the sacred language of Southern Buddhism; the scrolls were afterwards brought from India to Nepaul and Makhada (*quære* Magadha) about 200 a.d. (P. 236), and from Nepaul to Tibet, and are at present carefully preserved at Lassa. Tibetan translations of the Pâli text are found, he says, in various Buddhist monasteries, and, among the rest, at Himis. It is these Tibetan manuscripts which were translated at Himis for M. Notovitch while he was laid up in the monastery with a broken leg, and it is from these manuscripts that he has taken his new Life of Jesus Christ and published it in French, with an account of his travels. This volume, which has already passed through several editions in France, is soon to be translated into English.

EXTRACT 9

The **Mystery of the Ages** contained in the Secret Doctrine of all Religions. by Marie, Countess of Caithness, Duchesse De Pomár (C. L. H. Wallace, Philanthropic Reform Publisher, Oxford Mansion, W. London 1887)

On Page 145. The author says about 'Buddhism': It is the Christianity of the East, and, as such, even in better conservation than is Christianity, the Buddhism of the West.

EXTRACT 10

Travels in the **Mogul Empire** A.D. 1656–1668 by François Bernier, Translated, on the basis of Irving Brock's version and annotated by Archibald Constable 1891, Second Edition, revised by Vincent A. Smith, M.A. (Oxford University Press 1916)

Page 430. There are, however, many signs of *Judaism* to be found in this country. On entering the Kingdom after crossing the *Pire-penjale* mountains, the inhabitants in the frontier villages struck me as resembling *Jews*. Their countenance and manner, and that indescribable peculiarity which enables a traveller to distinguish the inhabitants of different nations, all seemed to belong to that ancient people. You are not to ascribe what I say to mere fancy, the *Jewish* appearance of these villagers having been remarked

by our *Jesuit Father*, and by several other *Europeans*, long before I visited *Kachemire*.

EXTRACT 11

A Journey from Bengal to England, through the Northern Part of India, Kashmire, Afghanistan, and Perisa, and into Russia by the Caspian-Sea, by George Forster, vol. II (R. Faulder and Son, London 1808)

Page 20. On first seeing these people in their own country, I imagined, from their garb, the cast of countenance, which is long, and of a grave aspect, and the form of their beards, that I had come amongst a nation of Jews.

EXTRACT 12

The Races of Afghanistan, being a Brief Account of the Principal Nations Inhabiting that Country, by Surgeon-Major H. W. Bellew, C.S.I. (Thacker, Spink & Co. Calcutta, (1880) MDCCCLXXX)

Page 15. The traditions of this people refer them to Syria as the country of their residence at the time they were carried away into captivity by Bukhtunasar (Nebuchadnezzar), and planted as colonists in different parts of Persia and Media. From these positions they, at some subsequent period, emigrated eastward into the mountainous country

of Ghor, where they were called by the neighbouring peoples “Bani Afghan” and “Bani Israíl,” or children of Afghan, and children of Israel. In corroboration of this we have the testimony of the prophet Esdras to the effect that the ten tribes of Israel, who were carried into captivity, subsequently escaped and found refuge in the country of Arsareth, which is supposed to be identical with the Hazarah country of the present day, and of which Ghor forms a part. It is also stated in the *Tabacati Nasiri*—a historical work which contains, among other information, a detailed account of the conquest of this country by Changhiz Khan—that in the time of the native Shansabi dynasty there was a people called Bani Israíl living in that country, and that some of them were extensively engaged in trade with the countries around.

This people was settled in the Ghor country, to the east of Herat, at the time that Muhammad announced his mission as the Prophet of God—about 622 A.D. And it was there that Khalid-bin-Walíd, a chief of the Curesh tribe of Arabs, came to them with the tidings of the new faith, and an invitation to join the Prophet’s standard.

Page 16. ... the mission of Khalid was not without success, for he returned to the Prophet, accompanied by a deputation of six or seven representative men of the Afghan people and their followers amounting in all to seventy-six persons. The chief or leader of this party was named Kais or Kish.

The traditions of the people go on to the effect that

this Kais and his companions fought so well and successfully in the cause of the Prophet, that Muhammad, on dismissing them to their homes, presented them with handsome gifts, complimented them on their bravery, and giving them his blessing foretold a glorious career for their nation, and promised that the title of Malik (or king) should distinguish their chiefs for ever.... At the same time the Prophet, as a mark of special favour and distinction, was pleased to change the Hebrew name of Kais to the Arab one of Abdur Rashíd— “the servant of the true guide”— and, exhorting him to strive in the conversion of his people, conferred on him the title of “Pahtán,”—a term which the Afghan book-makers explain to be a Syrian word signifying the rudder of a ship, as the new proselyte was henceforth to be the guide of his people in the way they should go.

Page 17. At what period the Afghans of Ghor moved forward and settled in the Kandahar country, which is now their home, is not known. It appears, however, from the writings of the early Muhammadan historians, that in the first century of their era—the seventh-eighth of ours—the province of Sistan was occupied by an Indian people.

Page 19. Kais, they say, married a daughter of that Khalid-bin-Walíd who brought his people the first tidings of the Prophet and his doctrine, and by her he had three sons, whom he named respectively, Saraban, Batan, and Ghurghusht...

The Afghans Proper—the Bani Israíl, as they call themselves in special distinction to all other divisions of the nation—class themselves as the descendants of Saraban through his two sons, Sharjyún and Khrishyún.

Page 24. By Muhammadans of Asia Minor and the Western countries the Afghan is usually called Sulemání.

EXTRACT 13

The **Cyclopædia of India** and of Eastern and Southern Asia, by Surgeon General Edward Balfour, vol. I, Third Edition (Bernard Quaritch, London 1885)

page 31 (under the heading *Afghanistan*): Pukhtun is the national appellation of the Afghans proper; but Afghans and Pathans also designate themselves Ban-i-Israel, and some claim direct descent from Saul, king of Israel. Pukhtun is the individual, and Pukhtana the collective name of the Afghans. This word is described as of Hebrew (Ibrani) origin, though some of them say it has a Syrian (Suriani) source, and signifies delivered, set free. The term Afghan is also said to have the same signification. One tradition is that the mother of Afghan or Afghana, on his being born exclaimed, 'Afghana,' 'I am free,' and gave him this name; another tradition is that in the pangs of labour she exclaimed. 'Afghan, Afghan,' or 'Figban, Figban,' words which in the Persian mean woe! grief! alas! Afghan

is claimed as the designation only of the descendants of Kais.

The term Pathan is said to be from Pihtan, a titular appellation alleged to have been bestowed by Mahomed on an Afghan called Kais.

Their origin is involved in obscurity. But several writers consider them to be descendants of one of the ten tribes of Israel; and this is an opinion of some Afghans themselves. A few authors consider that this nation is not of Jewish origin, but that those who introduced the Mahomedan religion amongst them were converted Jews.

Page 34. Among the Yusufzai, no man sees his wife till the marriage ceremonies are completed; and with all the Bardurani there is great reserve between the time when the parties are betrothed and the marriage. Some of them live with their future father-in-law, and earn their bread by their services, as Jacob did Rachel, without ever seeing the object of their wishes.

Among the Afghans, as among the Jews, it is thought incumbent on the brother of the deceased to marry his widow, and it is a mortal affront to the brother for any other person to marry her without his consent.

EXTRACT 14

Narrative of a **Mission to Bokhara**, in the years 1843–1845, to ascertain the Fate of Colonel Stoddart and Captain Conolly, by the Rev. Joseph Wolff, D.D. LL.D., Vol. 1 and Vol.2, second edition, revised (John W. Parker, London {1845} M.DCCC.XLV.)

Vol. 1 page 7. From various conversations with Affghauns in Khorassaun and elsewhere, I learnt that some of them are proud of an origin from the children of Israel, but I doubt the truth of that partial tradition.

Vol. 1 page 13. All the Jews of Türkistaun assert that the Türkomauns are the descendants of Togarmah, one of the sons of Gomer, mentioned in Genesis x. 3.

Vol. 1 pages 14–16. The Jews in Bokhara are 10,000 in number. The chief rabbi assured me that Bokhara is the Habor, and Balkh the Halah, of the 2nd Kings, xvii.6; but that in the reign of Genghis Khan they lost all their written accounts. At Balkh the Mussulman mullahs assured me that it was built by a son of Adam, that its first name had been Hanakh, and afterwards Halah, though later writers called it Balakh, or Balkh. The Jews, both of Balkh and Samarcand, assert that Türkistaun is the land of Nod, and Balkh where Nod “once stood”.... The tradition is an old one at Bokhara, that some of the Ten Tribes are in China. I tried the Jews here on various points of Scriptural interpretation, particularly that important one in Isaiah vii.14

-- עלמה Virgin. They translated it as we Christians do, and they are in total ignorance of the important controversy between Jews and Christians on that point.

I obtained a passport from the King after this most interesting sojourn, and then crossed the Oxus, and arrived after a few days at Balkh; and from that city, where I also communed with the dispersed of Israel, I proceeded to Muzaur.... Some Affghauns claim a descent from Israel. According to them, Affghaun was the nephew of Asaph, the son of Berachia, who built the Temple of Solomon. The descendants of this Affghaun, being Jews, were carried into Babylon by Nebuchadnezzar, from whence they were removed to the mountain of Ghoree, in Affghanistaun, but in the time of Muhammed turned Muhammedans. They exhibit a book, *Majmooa Alansab*, or Collection of Genealogies, written in Persian.

Vol. 1 page 17. Hence I passed to Peshawr. Here I had also the singular book read to me of the origin of the Affghauns, the Poshtoo Book of Khan Jehaun Loote. The account in this book agrees with that given in the MSS., *Teemur Nameh* and *Ketaub Ansabee Muhakkek Toose*. I thought the general physiognomy not Jewish, but I was wonderfully struck with the resemblance that the Youssuf Szeye and the Khaibaree, two of their tribes, bear to the Jews. The Kaffre Seeah Poosh, if Affghauns, vary widely from the rest of their nation. Many travellers have thought them the descendants from Alexander's army, but they do not say so.

Vol. 1 page 18. I always thought that the Kaffre Seeah-Poosh were descendants of Israel; and some of the learned Jews of Samarcand are of my opinion.

Vol. 1 pages 19–20. Captain Riley, I was surprised to find, looked on the Affghauns as of Jewish descent.

Vol. 1 page 58. I spent six days with the children of Rechab (Beni Arhab)... With them were children of Israel of the tribe of Dan, who reside near Terim in Hatramawt, who expect, in common with the children of Rechab, the speedy arrival of the Messiah in the clouds of heaven.

Vol. 2 page 126. It is very remarkable that the Prophet Ezekiel, in the twenty-seventh chapter, fourteenth verse, gives an exact description of the trade carried on by the Türkomauns with the inhabitants of Bokhara, Khiva, and Khokand. The Prophet says: “They of the house of Togarmah (i.e. the Türkomauns) traded in thy fairs with horses and horsemen, and mules.” The Türkomauns to this day, like the Swiss Guards, are mercenaries, and let themselves out for a few tengas a day. It is also remarkable, that I frequently heard the Türkomauns call themselves Toghramah, and the Jews call them Togarmah.

Viewing the hosts of camels coming with merchandise from Cashmeer, Cabül, Khokand, Khetay, and Orenbourg, the passage of Isaiah ix.6, comes forcibly on the mind, where the Prophet says: “The multitude of camels shall cover thee, the dromedaries of Midian and

Ephah; all they from Sheba shall come: they shall bring gold and incense." Mentioning gold, I must not forget, that near Samarcand there are gold mines and turquoises.

Vol. 2 pages 226–227. A few words on the Chaldeans in the mountains of Kurdistaan. These Chaldeans, as the late lamented Dr. Grant well observed, are of Jewish origin, though I cannot go so far as to affirm that they are of the Ten Tribes, since they do not know their own genealogy. They are now mostly Christians... They resemble mostly the Protestants of Germany and England, for they have neither images nor monasteries, and their priests are married. The episcopal dignity, however, is hereditary, as well as that of the Patriarch, and at the time the mother of the patriarch becomes pregnant, she abstains from drinking wine and eating meat; and in case that a son is born, he is the patriarch, and if a daughter, she is obliged to observe eternal virginity.

EXTRACT 15

The **Lost Tribes** and the Saxons of the East and of the West, with new Views of Buddhism, and Translations of Rock-Records in India, by George Moore, M.D. (Longman, Green, Longman, and Roberts, London {1861} MDCCCLXI)

Page 143. We are attracted at once to a country of vast importance in the present aspect of the East, and the

more interesting to us, as we there find a people who profess to be the Beni-Israel, or descendants of the Ten Tribes, namely, Afghanistan and the adjacent countries.

Pages 145–146. The prominent reasons for thinking that certain classes of the people of Bokhara and Afghanistan are of Israelitish origin are these:— 1st. Their personal resemblance to the Hebrew family. Thus Dr. Wolff, the Jewish missionary, says: “I was wonderfully struck with the resemblance of the Youssoufszye [tribe of Joseph], and the Khybere, two of their tribes, to the Jews.” Moorcroft also says of the Khyberes, “They are tall, and of singularly Jewish cast of features.” 2nd. They have been named by themselves Beni-Israel, children of Israel, from time immemorial. 3rd. The names of their tribes are Israelitish, especially that of Joseph, which includes Ephraim and Manasseh. In the Book of Revelation the tribe of Joseph stands for Ephraim. (Rev. vii. 6, 8.) In Numbers xxxvi. 5, Moses speaks of Manasseh as “the tribe of the sons of Joseph;” so that it is clear that both Manasseh and Ephraim were known by the name of the tribe of Joseph. 4th. The Hebrew names of places and persons in Afghanistan are of far greater frequency than can be accounted for through Mahometan association; and, indeed, these names existed before the Afghans became Mahometans. 5th. All accounts agree that they inhabited the mountains of Ghore from a very remote antiquity. It is certain that the princes of Ghore belonged to the Afghan tribe of Sooree, and that their dynasty was allowed to be of very great antiquity even in the eleventh

century. "They seem early to have possessed the mountains of Solimaun or Solomon, comprehending all the southern mountains of Afghanistan." (Elphinstone.) 6th. Afghan is the name given to their nation by others, the name they give their nation is Pushtoon, and Drs. Carey and Marshman assert that the Pushtoon language has more Hebrew roots than any other.

Pages 147-148. The antiquity of the name of the country Cabul, or Cabool, is then established; and it is also shown that some peculiar people known as "The Tribes," and "The Noble Tribes," dwelt there at a very remote period. There is, therefore, good evidence that the present inhabitants of Cabul may be justified in asserting that from the earliest period of history they and their ancestors have occupied Cabul, and that from time immemorial they have been known as "The Tribes." That is to say, Israelitish tribes, such as they now assume themselves to be. According to Sir W. Jones, the best Persian authorities agree with them in their account of their origin; and resident and competent authorities, such as Sir John Malcolm, and the missionary Mr. Chamberlain, after full investigation, assure us that "many of the Afghans are undoubtedly of the seed of Abraham."

EXTRACT 16

The Works of Flavius Josephus; comprising the Antiquities of the Jews; a **History of the Jewish Wars**, and Life of Flavius Josephus; Written by Himself. Translated by William Whiston, A.M., Professor of mathematics in the University of Cambridge (Willoughby & Co. London 1840)

Page 336. ...the ten tribes are beyond Euphrates till now, and are an immense multitude, and not to be estimated by numbers.

EXTRACT 17

A personal narrative of a visit to **Ghuzni, Kabul, and Afghanistan**, and of a Residence at the Court of Dost Mohamed: with Notices of Runjit Sing, Khiva, and the Russian Expedition, by G. T. Vigne Esq. F.G.S. (Whittaker & Co. London 1840)

Pages 166–167. Moollah Khoda Dad, a person learned in the history of his countrymen, read to me, from the *Mujma-ul-Unsab* (collection of genealogies), the following short account of their origin. They say, that the eldest of Jacob's sons was Judah, whose eldest son was Osruk, who was the father of Oknur, the father of Moalib, the father of Farlai, the father of Kys, the father of Talut, the father of Ermiah, the father of Afghana, whence the name of Afghans. He was cotemporary with Nebuchadnezzar,

called himself Bin-i-Israel, and had forty sons, whose names there is no occasion to insert. His thirty-fourth descendant, in a direct line, after a period of two thousand years, was Kys. From Kys, who lived in the time of the prophet Mahomed, there have been sixty-six generations. Sulum, the eldest son of Afghana, who lived at Sham, left that place, and came to Ghura Mishkon, a country near Herat; and his descendants gradually extended themselves over the country now called Afghanistan.

EXTRACT 18

A Cyclopædia of Geography Descriptive and Physical, forming a New General Gazetteer of the World and Dictionary of Pronunciation, by James Bryce, M.A., F.G.S. (Richard Griffin and Co. London and Glasgow 1856)

page 11. The name Afghan is not used by the people themselves; they call themselves Pooshtoon, and in the plural Pooshtaûneh, from which, perhaps, comes the name Putan, or Patan, given to them in India. They trace their origin to Saul, King of Israel, calling themselves, Ben-i-Israel. According to Sir A. Burnes, their tradition is, that they were transplanted by the King of Babylon from the Holy Land to Ghoré, lying to the N.W. of Cabool, and lived as Jews till A.D. 682, when they were converted to Mahometanism by an Arab chief, Khaled-ibn-Abdalla, who had married a daughter of an Afghan chief. No

historical evidence has ever been adduced in support of this origin, and it is perhaps a mere invention, founded upon the facts mentioned in 2 Kings xviii.11. However this may be, all travellers agree that the people differ strikingly from the neighbouring nations; and have, among themselves, one common origin. They are said, by some, to resemble Jews very much in form and feature; and they are divided into several tribes, inhabiting separate territories, and remaining almost unmixed.

EXTRACT 19

History of Afghanistan, from the Earliest Period to the Outbreak of the War of 1878, by Colonel G. B. Malleon, C.S.I. (W.H. Allen & Co. London, 1878)

Page 39. I turn now to the people of Afghánistán, to the tribes who occupy the country, and who command the passes. The subject has been treated at great length by Mountstuart Elphinstone, by Ferrier—who quotes largely from Abdúllah Khán, of Herát,—by Bellew, and by many others.

Following Abdúllah Khán and other Afghán writers, Ferrier is disposed to believe that the Afgháns represent the lost ten tribes, and to claim for them descent from Saul, King of Israel. Amongst other writers concurring in this view may be mentioned the honoured name of Sir William Jones. On the other hand, Professor Dorn, of

Kharkov, who examined the subject at length, rejects this theory. Mountstuart Elphinstone classes it in the same category as the theory of the descent of the Romans from the Trojans. The objections to Abdúllah Khán's view have been recently expressed, fittingly and forcibly, by Professor Dowson, in a letter to the *Times*. "If," writes that gentleman, "it were worthy of consideration, it is still inconsistent with the notion that the Afgháns are descendants of the lost ten tribes. Saul was of the tribe of Benjamin, and that tribe was not one of the lost ten. There remains the question of feature. This, no doubt, has its weight, but cannot prevail against the more important question of language." Professor Dowson then proceeds to show that the Afghán language has no trace of Hebrew in it, and concludes by pronouncing the supposition that in the course of time the whole Afghán race could have changed their language as "too incredible."

EXTRACT 20

History of the Afghans by J. P. Ferrier, translated from the original unpublished manuscript by Captain William Jesse (John Murray, London, 1858)

Page 1. ... the majority of Eastern writers consider them to be the descendants of one of the ten tribes of Israel— and this is the opinion of the Afghans themselves.

Page 4. ... the Afghans, however, think that they have evidence of their Jewish origin in the following tradition. When Nadir Shah, marching to the conquest of India, arrived at Peshawur, the chiefs of the tribe of the Yoosoofzyes presented him with a Bible written in Hebrew, and several articles that had been used in their ancient worship which they had preserved; these articles were at once recognised by the Jews who followed the camp.

Page 6. Being incompetent to decide which is right, we shall adopt the opinion of Abdullah Khan of Herat as the one most deserving of credit, and we will precede it by giving his view of the manner in which the Afghans were brought to Afghanistan. The following is a translation of his manuscript:

“...Malek Thalut (Saul) king of the Jews had two sons, Afghan and Djalut—the first was the father of the Afghan nation and gave his name to it. After the reigns of David and Solomon, who succeeded Saul, anarchy divided the Jewish tribes, and this continued to the period at which Bouktun Nasr took Jerusalem, massacred 70,000 Jews, and after destroying that city led the surviving inhabitants captives to Babylon. Subsequently to this disaster the Afghan tribe, struck with terror, fled from Judea and settled in Arabia: here they remained some considerable time, but as pasturage and water were scarce, and both man and beast suffered extreme privation, some of the tribe determined to emigrate to Hindostan. The branch

of the Abdalees continued to reside in Arabia, and during the caliphate of Aboo Bekr their chiefs allied themselves to a powerful sheikh, by name Khaled ibn Velid, of the tribe of Korech.... at the period when the Arabs subjugated Persia the Abdalees left Arabia and settled in this new conquest, establishing themselves in the provinces of Fars and Kerman, and here they remained until Genghis Khan invaded those districts. The tyrannical proceedings of this conqueror weighed with such terrible effect on the population, that the Abdalees quitted Persia and, passing by the Mekrane, Scinde, and Mooltan, arrived in India; but the results of this new migration were not more fortunate, for they were scarcely settled here when their neighbours made war upon, and forced them to leave the plains and inhabit the rugged mountains of Suleiman, considered as the cradle of the tribe, and called by them Kooh-Khasseh. The whole Afghan nation was brought together by the arrival of the Abdalees in the Suleiman mountains, and then consisted of twenty-four tribes, of which, as it has been already observed, Afghan, the son of Saul, was the father: this prince had three sons, named Tsera-Bend, Argoutch, and Kerlen, and each of them was the father of eight sons, who gave their names to the twenty-four tribes.

“The following is the manner in which they are classed:

“SONS OF TSERA- BEND.	NAMES OF THE TRIBES.	SONS OF ARGOUTCH.	NAMES OF THE TRIBES.
Abdal	Abdalees.	Ghildj	Ghildjzyes.
Yoosoof	Yoosoofzyes.	Kauker	Kaukerees.
Baboor	Baboorees.	Djumourian	Djumourianees
Wezir	Wezirees.	Storian	Storianees.
Lohooan	Lohooanees.	Pen	Penees.
Beritch	Beritchees.	Kass	Kassees.
Khooguian	Khooguianeess.	Takan	Takanees.
Chiran	Chiranees.	Nassar	Nassarees.

“SONS OF KERLEN.	NAMES OF THE TRIBES.	SONS OF KERLEN.	NAMES OF THE TRIBES.
Khattak	Khattakees.	Zaz	Zazees.
Soor	Soorees.	Bab	Babees.
Afreed	Afreedeess.	Benguech	Benguechees.
Toor	Toorees.	Lendeh-poor	Lendeh-poores.”

EXTRACT 2 I

History of the Afghans translated from the Persian of Neamet Ullah, by Bernhard Dorn, Ph.D. FOR. M.R.A.S. M.T.C., Part 1 & 2 (J. Murray, London, 1829)

Part 1- page 23. Davud treated the two afflicted widows with the utmost kindness; and Heaven blessed them each with an accomplished son, born at the same hour; of whom the one was called Berkhia; the other, Ermia....

Each of them was blessed with an accomplished son. Berkhia called his Asif: Ermia's son was called Afghana.

Page 24. God blessed Asif with eighteen, and Afghana with forty sons; whose posterity, but more particularly that of the latter, continued increasing in such a degree, that no tribe of the Israelites equalled them.

Page 25. God permitted Bokhtnasser to subjugate the territories of Sham, to rase Jerusalem, and vanquish the Israelites, so as to carry their families into captivity and slavery, and drive all those who had faith in the Tora into exile;..... He reduced the whole of Sham to his subjection; carrying away the Israelites, whom he settled in the mountainous districts of Ghor, Ghazneen, Kabul, Candahar, Koh Firozeh,...

Page 37. Mestoufi, the author of the Tareekh Kozeida, and the author of the Mujmul Ansab, furnish the following

records. When the lustre of Mohammed's charming countenance had arisen, and Khaled had been ennobled by embracing the Mohammedan faith, a large number of Arabs and various people repaired to Medina, and were induced, by the splendour of the Mohammedan light, to embrace Islamism. At this time, Khaled sent a letter to the Afghans who had been settled in the mountainous countries about Ghor ever since the time of the expulsion of the Israelites by Bokhtnasser, and informed them of the appearance of the last of the Prophets. On this letter reaching them, several of their chiefs departed for Medina; the mightiest of whom, and of the Afghan people, was Kais, whose pedigree ascends in a series of thirty-seven degrees to Talut, of forty-five to Ibrahim, and of six hundred and three to Adam. The author of the *Mujmul Ansab* traces it as follows:- Pedigree of Abd Ullasheed Kais, who is known by the surname Pathan: Kais ben Isa, ben Salool, ben Otba, ben Naeem, ben Morra, ben Gelundur, ben Iskunder, ben Reman, ben Ain, ben Mehlool, ben Salem, ben Selah, ben Farood, ben Ghan, ben Fahlool, ben Karam, ben Amal, ben Hadifa, ben Minhal, ben Kais, ben Ailem, ben Ismuel, ben Harun, ben Kumrood, ben Abi, ben Zaleeb, ben Tullal, ben Levi, ben Amel, ben Tarej, ben Arzund, ben Mundool, ben Saleem, ben Afghana, ben Irmia, ben Sarool, called Melik (King) Talut, ben Kais, ben Otba...

Page 38. The Prophet lavished all sorts of blessings upon them; and having ascertained the name of each individual,

and remarked that Kais was an Hebrew name, whereas they themselves were Arabs, he gave Kais the name Abd Ulrasheed..... their attachment to the Faith would, in strength, be like the wood upon which they lay the keel when constructing a ship, which wood the seamen call Pathan: on this account he conferred upon Abd Ulrasheed the title of Pathan also...

The Prophet at length dismissed Abd Ulrasheed to return to Ghor and the adjacent Kohistan, there to propagate the new faith, and to direct the infidels to it.

Part 2- page 63 (Under word 'Suleimani'). Muhabbat Khan tells us, that they are called so by the Arabs in consequence of their belonging to the adherents and followers of King Solomon.

Pages 63–64. *Bani Afghanah, Bani Afghan*; that is, Children of Asif, Israel, Afghanah, or Afghan. These names are mentioned by Fareed Uddeen Ahmad, in his *Risalah Ansab Afaghinah*, where we find the following passage:—"When, in the course of time, Bokhtnassr the magician, who subdued the Bani Israel and the territories of Syria, and sacked Jerusalem, led the Children of Israel into captivity and slavery, and carried off with him several tribes of this people who were attached to the Law of Moses, and ordered them to adore him for God, and to abandon the creed of their fathers, they did not consent to this: upon which, he put two thousand of the wisest and most skilful of them to death, and ordered the rest to quit Syria and his dominions. Part of them, who had a chief,

were led by him out of Bokhtnassr's dominions, and conducted to the Kohistan of Ghor, where their descendants settled. Their number increased daily; and people called them Bani Israel, Bani Asif, and Bani Afghanah.

Page 64. Fareed Uddeen Ahmed, in the beginning of his discourse, says on this point: "Concerning the denomination, 'Afghan,' some have written, that they, after their expulsion, ever bearing in mind their wonted abode, uttered bewailings and lamentations (افغان *Afghan*), and were on that account called 'Afghan.'" See Sir J. Malcolm's *History of Persia*, Vol. I. p. 101, where the same derivation of this word is mentioned...

Farid Uddeen Ahmed mentions, that in standard works, as in the *Tareekh Afghani*, *Tareekh Ghori*, and others, it is asserted that the Afghans were, for the greater part, Israelites, and some Copts. See also *Abul Fazl*, P. ii. p. 178: "Some Afghans consider themselves to be of Egyptian extraction; asserting, that when the Children of Israel returned from Jerusalem to Egypt, this tribe emigrated to Hindoostan."

Page 65. The Afghans, according to almost all the Oriental historians, believe themselves to be descended from the Jews; an opinion that was even adopted, or considered probable, by some modern writers..... The use of Jewish names, which the Afghans employ, is undoubtedly attributable to their being Mussulmans.... The only proof that might be adduced in favour of their pretended Jewish

extraction, is the striking likeness of the Afghan features to the Jewish; which has been admitted, even by such as do not pay the least attention to their claim to a Jewish origin. Sir John Malcolm's words on this subject are: "Although their right to this proud descent (from the Jews) is very doubtful, it is evident, from their personal appearance, and many of their usages, that they are a distinct race from the Persians, Tartars, and Indians; and this alone seems to give some credibility to a statement which is contradicted by many strong facts, and of which no direct proof has been produced. If an inference could be drawn from the features of a nation resembling those of another, the Cashmirians would certainly, by their Jewish features, prove a Jewish origin, which not only Bernier, but Forster, and perhaps others, have remarked."

Pages 65–66. Now, although Forster does not approve of the opinion of Bernier, tracing the descent of the Cashmirians to the exiled Jewish tribes, yet he confesses, that, when among the Cashmirians, he thought himself to be amongst a nation of Jews.

EXTRACT 22

Dictionary of Geography, Descriptive, Physical, Statistical, And Historical, Forming a Complete General Gazetteer of the World, by Alex. Keith Johnston, F.R.S.E., F.R.G.S., F.G.S., Second

Edition, thoroughly revised and corrected. (Longman, Brown, Green, and Longmans, London {1855} MDCCLV)

Page 280 (under word *Cashmere*): The natives are of a tall robust frame of body, with manly features—the women full-formed and handsome, with aquiline nose and features, resembling the Jewish.

GLOSSARY

Abdāl Literally means ‘Substitutes.’ Sainly men who act on behalf of the Prophets in their absence. Such men would always inhabit the world and defend the truth of Islam against its enemies through manifest signs and arguments.

Aameen Let it be so. Arabic equivalent to amen.

Ahadith *See* Hadith.

Buddhsattva One who is on the path towards Buddhahood.

Dajjāl A term in Arabic that literally means, ‘the great deceiver.’ In Islamic terminology ‘Dajjāl’ refers to those satanic forces that would be unleashed in the Latter Days to oppose the Promised Messiah^{as} and al-Imam al-Mahdi. A similar prophecy in the Christian faith about the appearance of the Antichrist refers to the same phenomenon, and we have therefore used

the terms ‘Dajjāl’ and ‘Antichrist’ as synonyms.

Fatamite Descendants of Fatimah^{ra} the daughter of the Holy Prophet^{sas}, wife of Hazrat Ali^{ra} [Note that the dictionary definition is almost always about the dynasty].

Ḥadīth A saying of the Holy Prophet Muhammad^{sas}. The plural is *ahadith*.

Ḥazrat A term of respect used to show honour and reverence for a person of established righteousness and piety. The literal meaning is: His/Her Holiness, Worship, Eminence, etc. It is also used for God in the superlative sense.

Hijrah Migration. Refers to the exodus from Makkah to Madinah by the Holy Prophet Muhammad^{sas} in the year 623 CE, which marks the beginning of the lunar calendar of Islam.

Holy Prophet^{sas} A title used exclusively for the Founder of Islam, Ḥaẓrat Muḥammad^{sas}.

Holy Quran The final and perfect Scripture revealed by Allah for the guidance of all mankind for all times to come. It was revealed word by word to the Holy Prophet Muḥammad^{sas} over a period of twenty-three years.

Jamā'at Community. Although the word Jamā'at may refer to any community, in this book Jamā'at generally refers to the Worldwide Ahmadiyya Muslim Jamā'at.

Kalimah The declaration of the Islamic faith: *Lā ilāha illallāh Muḥammadur-Rasūlullāh*, 'There is no one worthy of worship except Allah; Muḥammad is the Messenger of Allah.'

Khalīfah Caliph is derived from the Arabic word *khalīfah*, which herein means 'successor.' *Khulafā'* is the plural of *Khalīfah*. In many divine revelations someone commissioned by God Almighty is referred to as His *Khalīfah*. In Islamic terminology, the title '*Khalīfa-e-Rāshid*' [righteous *Khalīfah*] is applied to each of the first four *Khulafā'* who continued the mission of the Holy Prophet Muḥammad^{sas} after his demise.

Ahmadi Muslims refer to each successor of the Promised Messiah^{as} as Khalīfatul Masīḥ

Mahdi Literally means 'Guided.' Imam Mahdi 'Guided Leader,' is a title given to the Reformer of the Latter Days prophesied by the Holy Prophet Muḥammad^{sas}; see also **About the Author** on page vii.

Maulawī A Muslim religious cleric

Muhammad^{sas} Founder of Islam. see Holy Prophet^{sas}.

Quran see Holy Quran.

Quraish The leading tribe in Makkah during the time of the Holy Prophet Muḥammad^{sas}. He himself was from the Banū Hāshim clan of the Quraish tribe.

Rūḥullāh and Kalimatullāh Meaning, 'the Spirit of Allah,' and 'the Word of Allah,' as explained by the Promised Messiah^{as}:

'When love of Allah, the Exalted, leads a man progressively towards truth and righteousness and he gives up his selfish and carnal desires, he reaches the ultimate stage of the purification of his soul. This is when he comes out of the dark abyss of his ego and its passions; and his body, which is the throne of the soul, is fully cleansed of all carnal dust and smoke and he

becomes like a drop of crystal clear water. At this stage, in the sight of Allah, he is the pure soul that has emerged after the carnal self has melted away, and has, in complete obedience to his Lord, acquired a resemblance with the angels. It is at this stage that he deserves to be called *Rūḥullāh* or *Kalimatullāh*.’ (*The Heavenly Sign*, p. 19, published by Islam International Publications Ltd, 2005)

Shariah Religious law of Islam. The term is also used in the general sense of any revealed law.

Shirk Associating partners with Allah.

Sūrah A chapter of the Holy Quran.

Tauḥīd The Oneness of God—the fundamental Islamic belief that there is none worthy of worship except Allah.

Vedas The most ancient Hindu scriptures, written in Sanskrit and containing hymns, philosophy, and guidance on ritual for the priests of the Vedic religion. There are four Vedas—*Rigveda*, *Samaveda*, *Yajurveda*, and *Atharvaveda*.

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